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LIFE INSURANCE CORPORATION OF INDIA

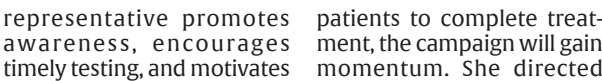
Har Pal Aapke Saath

LIC/R/1/2025-26/23/ENG

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

She urged all public representatives to expand this network in their respective areas, saying a Nikshay Mitra provides not only nutritional support but also dignity, confidence, and the reassurance to patients that society stands with them.

She said TB is now a curable disease and that with timely diagnosis and completion of treatment, patients can recover completely. She stressed that people must understand TB is nothing to be ashamed of. She said Members of Parliament, MLAs, and councillors are closest to the people, and if every public



officials to ensure the campaign reaches every ward, assembly constituency, and local area so that more citizens become part of the movement.

The programme included a special awareness video on tuberculosis screened by the Health Department and a detailed presentation by the Delhi State Health Mission on the achievements, current status, and future roadmap of the campaign.

The Chief Minister visited awareness stalls at the event, including one on the Nikshay Mitra initiative, and held discussions with offi-

All participants, including public representatives, officials, and attendees, took a collective pledge to raise awareness about tuberculosis in their respective areas, support timely testing and treatment, encourage more people to become Nikshay Mitras, and actively work toward a TB-Free Delhi.

Health Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh said the objective of the workshop is to enable public representatives to become effective partners in the TB elimination

campaign in their areas. Delhi, with its high population density and significant migrant population from states with varying TB burdens, presents particular challenges for detection and treatment completion. The Nikshay Mitra scheme, which pairs TB patients with volunteer supporters who provide nutritional and emotional support throughout their treatment course, addresses one of the key reasons for treatment dropout: the economic and social burden that a prolonged course of medication places on patients and their families.

solutions in their respective assemblies seeking withdrawal of the E20 policy, following a similar resolution passed in the Punjab Assembly. He said if required, the party would launch a larger public movement against the policy.

Delhi BJP President Harsh Malhotra said the march played out exactly as he had publicly predicted the previous day. "Exactly as I had predicted yesterday, Arvind Kejriwal today claimed that he had been stopped by the police and staged a nearly half-hour protest outside his office,"

Malhotra said. He said Kejriwal's only objective is politics and that the former Chief Minister is fully aware that ethanol-blended petrol is the need of the hour. He accused Kejriwal of staging the march simply to remain in the headlines, with an eye on AAP's prospects in the 2027 Punjab assembly elections.

Malhotra also challenged Kejriwal to produce verified evidence of vehicle damage. Despite repeated demands, Kejriwal has been unable to produce even 100 vehicles accompanied by a certified automobile engineer's report confirming that E20 petrol caused damage to them, Malhotra said. He said vehicle owners across India understand that ethanol-blended petrol is the fuel of the future and will not be subsidised by Kejriwal.

The E20 policy mandates blending 20 per cent ethanol with petrol as part of India's push to reduce oil imports and promote domestic ethanol production. Critics argue the blended fuel causes engine performance issues in older vehicles not designed for high-ethanol fuel and that consumers are not being offered a choice between blended and pure petrol at pumps.

New Delhi: Delhi-based transport bodies held a protest at Rajghat on Tuesday demanding the withdrawal of ethanol-blended petrol.

Earlier, the call had been given by the Delhi Taxi and Tourist Transporters and Tour Operators Association and others to hold a protest march to Parliament from Jantar Mantar. "But as no permission was given by Delhi Police we decided to go to Rajghat and offer our prayers to Mahatma Gandhi. To maintain peace and order, we appealed to all transporters to exercise restraint and follow the path of truth and non-violence and adopt the spirit of 'Gandhigiri'," Sanjay Samrat, president, Delhi Taxi and Tourist Transporters and Tour Operators Association said.

If the Association's demands are not addressed seriously, we will launch a nationwide public awareness campaign and organise a large peaceful demonstration at Jantar Mantar in the near future, he added.

Delhi Education and Sports Minister Ashish Sood on Tuesday met World Junior Girls Squash Champion Anahat Singh and Olympic bronze medalist and Commonwealth Games silver medalist boxer Lovlina Borgohain. The Minister pledged full Government support to develop grassroots squash facilities across the capital and build robust boxing training infrastructure, as both athletes discussed ways to expand their respective sports among Delhi's youth.

Lovlina Borgohain, originally from Assam, has made Delhi her residence. She won an Olympic bronze medal at Tokyo 2020 and recently won a silver medal at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games. During her interaction with Sood, she expressed a strong desire to nurture boxing talent in Delhi and requested government support to build proper training facilities in the city.

Sood assured her of all required assistance and said the Delhi government will engage with active and veteran sports personalities to deliberate on modernising sports infrastructure, enhancing training centres, and creating a

broader sports culture throughout Delhi.

The meetings reflect a push by the Delhi government to use India's top sporting achievers as both advocates and potential stakeholders in the development of sports culture and infrastructure in the capital. The approach of engaging champions from specific disciplines to shape policy and facility development for those disciplines brings in practical expertise from athletes who understand the training and infrastructure requirements firsthand.

Sood congratulated both athletes for their achievements on the international stage and wished them continued success.

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
 New Delhi

Delhi Education and Sports Minister Ashish Sood on Tuesday met World Junior Girls Squash Champion Anahat Singh and Olympic bronze medalist and Commonwealth Games silver medalist boxer Lovlina Borgohain. The Minister pledged full Government support to develop grassroots squash facilities across the capital and build robust boxing training infrastructure, as both athletes discussed ways to expand their respective sports among Delhi's youth.

Anahat Singh, a Delhi athlete who recently won the World Junior Girls Squash Championship, has also represented India at the Asian Games and Commonwealth Games.

During her meeting with Sood, she discussed strategies to make squash more popular and widely accessible to young people across the national Capital. Sood assured complete backing from the Delhi Government to develop grassroots facilities and expand squash programmes, giving young talent in Delhi a platform to compete globally.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform all concerned that Late Smt. Daljit Gupta W/o Late Sh. Bishan Swarnjit Gupta R/o A-33, Sector-36/36 Noida, Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar (U.P.) was the 50% undivided shareholder in Residential Lease Hold Property No. A-33, Sector-36, Noida, Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar (U.P.) consisting of front portion of the said property (lower ground floor, which is having big room, ground floor consists of one lobby, one bedroom one kitchen and one bathroom, one basement and one garage/room on the ground floor. She was executed her last and irrevocable WILL of the said portion of the said property duly registered in Sub-Registrar office of Patiala, registered in Waska No. 695 577, Dated Bahi 3, 30/01/2008, 326 dated 03/12/2008 in my favour. i.e. Mr. Sukhjit Singh Bhullar S/o Sukhdev Singh Bhullar R/o 15A, Ghumna Colony, Near 22 No. Bypass, Patiala (Punjab). I wish to get transfer of the said portion of the said property in my favour through the above registered WILL after her demise on 22/04/2020. If anyone has/have any objection towards the above transfer of the said portion of the said property, he/she/they will inform with sufficient proof in the respective Residential Plots Department of Noida Authority within 30 days from the date of this Publication.

(Sukhjit Singh Bhullar)

from being blended and pure petrol at pumps.

PUBLIC NOTICE (For Section 8 Company License Application under Companies Act, 2013) Notice is hereby given pursuant to Rule 19 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014 read with Section 8 of the Companies Act, 2013 that an application has been made to the Registrar of Companies, (Delhi/ROC jurisdiction), for grant of license to incorporate a Company under Section 8 of the Companies Act, 2013 in the name and style of "Lingaya's Vidyaapeeth Foundation", upon conversion of existing Society namely "Lingaya's Society", having its registered office at 16-A, Central Drive, DLF Farms, Chhatrapur, New Delhi 110074. The object of the proposed Section 8 Company is to promote objects such as education, social welfare, charitable activities, environmental protection, skill development, or other similar objectives not involving profit distribution to its members. Any person, firm, company, institution or authority having any objection or suggestion in respect of the proposed incorporation/conversion, send the same in writing along with supporting documents and grounds of objection to the Registrar of Companies, 4th Floor, IFCI Tower, 51, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019, within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice. A copy to the Company at its registered office address mentioned above. For and on behalf of Lingaya's Society Registration Number: S-30358 16-A, Central Drive, DLF Farms, Chhatrapur, New Delhi 110074 Date: 30th July 2026 Place: New Delhi
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OFFICE OF MUNICIPAL CORPORATION KORBA
e-Procurement Tender Notice

Main Portal: <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> KORBA

NIT No: 537./2026 Dated: 30.07.2026

SN.	System Tender No.	Name of Work/ Description of Work	Probable Amount of Contract
1.	196483 (1st Call)	CONSTRUCTION OF BOX CRICKET AT ZONE-2 IN STADIUM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, KORBA (C.G.)	Rs. 158.58 Lakh

The details can be viewed directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 30.07.2026 at **15.30** Hours. (IST) onwards.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
Municipal Corporation,
Korba (C.G.)

enhancing sports infrastructure, and creating a continued success.

GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, PWD
NALBARI ROAD CIRCLE, NALBARI

No. SENL/NIT/N/2020-21/

PRESS NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Superintending Engineer P.W.D Nalbari Road Circle, Nalbari on behalf of Governor of Assam invite bids for I(One) package for Construction of Road under SOPD -G for the year 2025-26 in Nalbari District of Assam amounting to Rs. 195.03 L (approx) including GST etc. from approved & eligible contractor registered with PWRD, Assam. Details may be seen from 10-08-2026 to 25-08-2026 at website- <http://assamtenders.gov.in>.

Amendment /Addendum to the SBD, if any, and further notifications shall appear in this website and also at the office of the undersigned during office hours. The contractor /bidder must be registered with the Electronic Tendering System (ETS) of PWRD, Assam website www.assamtenders.gov.in.

N.B. The Tender amount has been considered inclusive of (GST (12%), L/Cess (1%) etc.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer, PWD
Nalbari Road Circle, Nalbari

DIPR/CF/PIO/1118/5-Aug-26

FORM NO. INC-26

Pursuant to Rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014) Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the Company from one state to another

BEFORE THE CENTRAL GOVERNMENT THROUGH REGIONAL DIRECTOR, NORTHERN REGION-II, MINISTRY OF CORPORATE AFFAIRS

On the matter of the Sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 and Clause (a) of Sub-rule (5) of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014

AND

In the matter of
Foundacres Buildwell Private Limited
(CIN:U0109HR2019PT0800272)
having its Registered Office at E-303, Tower-E, Lotus Homes, Sector-111, Palam Vihar (Gurgaon), Gurgaon- 122017 Haryana

-Petitioner

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make application to the Central Government through the Regional Director under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in the terms of the Special Resolution passed at the Extra Ordinary General Meeting held on 31st July, 2020 to enable the Company to change its Registered Office from "State of Haryana to the State of Maharashtra".

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the Registered Office of the Company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or sent by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the 3rd Floor, Corporate Bhawan, Plot No.4-D-8, Sector-27B, PIN-160019, Chandigarh within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its registered Office at the address mentioned above.

For and on behalf of the Applicant -
FOUNDACRES BUILDWELL PRIVATE LIMITED
SD-
KAMAL KISHORE JAIN
Director
DIN No.:0006284

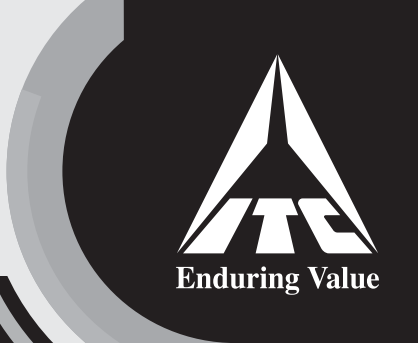
Place: New Delhi
Date: 04/08/2026



ITC: Partnering India in its Defining Decade

Excerpts from the Address by
Shri Sanjiv Puri, Chairman & Managing Director, ITC Limited

115th Annual General Meeting, ITC Limited | 23 July 2026



We meet today at a time of deep significance — for the world, for India, and for enterprises that aspire to create enduring value. The prolonged uncertainty arising from the West Asia crisis has severely impacted the global economy, threatening energy security and trade. Indeed, the multitude of events in the recent past only reinforce the fact that **global volatility is no more sporadic; it is now systemic**. Last year, in my address, I had described this as an era of **TURN** — a world constantly confronted by **Turbulence, Uncertainty and Rapid change**, calling for **Novel strategies** to reimagine our tomorrows. Today, that reality stands even more pronounced, as a deeper structural shift reshapes the future of nations, societies and enterprises.

What makes this juncture a perfect storm of exceptional complexity and consequence is the confluence of multiple forces at scale. On the one hand, global progress is challenged by the catastrophic climate emergency, widening inequality and advances in disruptive technologies like AI. On the other hand, decades of hyper-globalisation have given way to fragmented multi-polarisation — creating a world that is still deeply connected, but less trusting; still trading yet marred by weaponisation of supply chains; still global, but increasingly nationalistic. These tectonic shifts are being felt across everyday lives — through volatile commodity prices, inflationary pressures, disruptions in trade and the rising vulnerability of food, energy and supply chains.

It is said that crisis challenges the status quo like no other and spurs innovation to forge new pathways for growth, competitiveness and resilience. We stand today at such an inflection point with an unparalleled opportunity to make a meaningful difference to all our shared tomorrows.

It gives us immense pride, therefore, that India's resolute fortitude in accelerating the journey to a competitive, resilient and inclusive nation has earned it widespread trust, respect and admiration.

India's Ascent: A Beacon of Hope and Progress

Against this backdrop, the Hon'ble Prime Minister's powerful clarion call for an **Aatmanirbhar** and a **Viksit Bharat** assumes even greater significance. It has inspired multidimensional interventions enabling India to emerge as the fastest-growing major economy in the world. The far-reaching measures announced in successive Budgets have provided strong foundations to unleash growth. India's ascent is not merely about outpacing other large economies. **It has demonstrated that a nation of continental scale, democratic depth and extraordinary diversity can drive momentum with stability, pursue reform with inclusion, and convert aspiration into resilient growth.**

The India story is indeed an inspiring example of how the Government is creating an all-pervasive Bharat Capability Stack through exemplary foresight and foundational action to reinforce competitiveness for today, resilience for tomorrow and strategic readiness for the decades ahead.

Role of Business: Responsible Competitiveness

It is my deep conviction that businesses, as a crucial organ of society, serve a larger transformational purpose by contributing meaningfully to **national competitiveness, sustainable and inclusive development**.

This philosophy is reflected in your Company's ethos of **Responsible Competitiveness**, which has guided our thought, strategy and action over the years and inspires our commitment to be **a national value multiplier**. To my mind, businesses make a lasting contribution to the nation when they frame their growth agenda around three imperatives.

First, as engines of national competitiveness, it is mission critical for Indian enterprises to be **future-ready and globally competitive**. This calls for trusted Indian brands that anchor domestic ecosystems and retain value in the country; investments in state-of-the-art national assets that support India's ambition to become a global hub for manufacturing, services and exports; a deeper focus on cutting-edge innovation and R&D as well as capabilities for AI-led transformation. **The Hon'ble Prime Minister's vision of Build More, Produce More and Export More raises our collective aspirations to even bolder heights to craft products and services of world-class quality and trust, that earn their rightful place in households and markets across the world.**

Taking this tenet further, the **second imperative** is for businesses to evolve as architects of **national resilience and anti-fragility**. While resilience sharpens the capacity to bounce back amidst adversity, anti-fragility goes beyond, to convert adversity into future opportunities. Strengthening resilience calls for locally anchored value chains, stronger MSME partnerships, diversified and trusted sourcing, import substitution, climate stewardship and robust digital adoption. However, the winners of tomorrow must also thrive amidst adversity, nurture new competencies, accelerate innovation and spur new engines of growth. Resilience is no longer the dividend of efficiency nor is anti-fragility a distant objective, they are the very foundation of our right to grow. **When enterprises embed resilience and embrace anti-fragility, they fortify the nation's foundation and position it to rise stronger with every adversity.**

Third, businesses must advance a paradigm of Compassionate Capitalism. Competitiveness gives enterprises the power to win, anti-fragility the right to win the future and purpose the legitimacy to win. Businesses exist to serve both an economic and social purpose. The enormous climate risks, livelihood challenges, inequality and regulations **make it a crucial responsibility of businesses to embed sustainability and inclusion as an integral component of strategy.** This belief lies at the core of your Company's approach.

A few years ago, your Company laid the foundations of the **ITC Next strategy** to drive scale, accelerated growth and profitability and make the enterprise even more future-ready. Guided by the Company's credo of **"Nation First, Sab Saath Badhein"**, our north-star is to create growing value for all our stakeholders — by building national competitiveness that is globally benchmarked, resilience that is locally anchored, and growth that is anti-fragile, inclusive and sustainable.

ITC: Ushering in NextGen Agri, Strengthening Rural India

I begin with agriculture — the lifeline of our economy and the foundation of rural India. India possesses vast arable land, diverse agro-climatic zones and leadership in several commodities. Yet, low productivity, fragmented holdings, limited value addition, climate vulnerability and inefficient market access continue to constrain its potential. This points to a defining opportunity to **transform Indian agriculture from volume-led production to value-led competitiveness**, not only to fortify food security but to raise farmer incomes, deepen rural capability and enhance exports.

The Government has spearheaded several commendable measures to support growth of the agri-food sector. Higher farmer incomes can trigger a virtuous cycle of consumption, investment, employment and rural prosperity. This requires a structural shift to shape **NextGeneration Agriculture** — from fragmented productivity to integrated competitiveness, from undifferentiated commodities to high-value agriculture, and from vulnerable farming systems to climate-smart, technology-enabled rural ecosystems.

With over a century of engagement with agriculture, 94% of your Company's businesses are linked to agri-crops or plantations, generating substantial livelihoods. ITC nurtures **21 value chains across 23 States to source nearly 6 million tonnes of agri-produce**. In this address, I will focus on ITC's Agri Business, which is now the country's largest private sector agri-enterprise, **doubling segment revenue in just over 5 years to nearly ₹20,300 crore** in FY26. The **ITC Next strategy** is today transforming the Agri Business, while ushering in NextGeneration farming and rural empowerment.

At the core of this transformation is the **ITCMAARS** phytal ecosystem, designed to empower FPOs with digital technologies, hyper-personalised advisories, quality inputs, market linkages, scientific agronomy and climate-smart practices to improve farm competitiveness and resilience. In a short span, ITCMAARS has onboarded **over 2.6 million farmers** across 11 States, with the ambition to benefit 10 million farmers by 2030. Initial estimates indicate **crop yield gains of 15-20% and improvement in net returns by 25-30%.**

Building on a recent horticulture pilot, anchored by FPOs, for the supply of high-quality fruits and vegetables, ITC plans to develop 4 additional hybrid Open-to-Sky and Controlled Environment Agriculture clusters to create a reliable, traceable supply chain for fresh produce. Progressively, **ITCMAARS is introducing precision-led agriculture and advanced agri-tech solutions, like IoT-enabled weather tracking, remote-sensing, drone-based services, to promote smart farming.**

A vital component of your Company's agri strategy is to promote **Value-Added Agriculture** to enable farmers scale the next horizon of profitable growth. This portfolio, which has grown at a CAGR of 33% over five years, today encompasses **certified organic crops, processed agri-products, such as food-safe spices, horticulture, premium coffee, aquaculture and attribute-specific commodities, like high-starch maize and high-gluten wheat.**

Taking this further, ITCMAARS will drive a Farming as a Service (FaaS) ecosystem to 'Grow the Buy', where **crop value chains are customised to meet specific buyer needs**. Certifications, traceability and responsible sourcing establish **trust systems at scale**, linking Indian farmers to domestic and global export markets. ITC's Spices Business, for example, is today the country's leading exporter of organic spices, supported by certified cultivation, backward integration and **one of Asia's largest spices processing facilities at Guntur.**

In an era of climate stress and rising food security imperatives, production of **high-quality, resilient seeds and hybrids** is vital to enhancing productivity, improving quality, increasing climate resilience, strengthening nutritional security and raising farmer incomes. Your Company's wholly owned subsidiary **Technico, a global leader in pre-basic potato seeds, is investing in the world's largest state-of-the-art aeroponic facility** with 60 hi-tech controlled-environment greenhouses, taking the combined capacity to 100 million TECHNITUBER's.

Fostering an effective **science-to-farm ecosystem**, ITC's LSTC is leveraging advanced breeding technologies, molecular genetics and digital tools to develop higher-yielding, climate-resilient, hybrid and disease-resistant varieties across crops such as tobacco, wheat, potato, eucalyptus and subabul. **These have led to yields improving by 15-50%.**

Your Company is making appreciable progress in high-value, future-facing categories, such as **Biological Extracts**, with the commencement of a US FDA-compliant, export-oriented, **pharmacopoeia-standard nicotine derivative** processing facility, serving customers in Europe, USA and South Korea. In addition, ITC's **medicinal and aromatic plant ecosystem** is developing high-active varieties and proprietary formulations, besides manufacturing high-purity extracts for domestic and global markets together with farmer training in best practices.

As we look ahead, ITC will continue to work towards shaping a more competitive, resilient and inclusive Agri Business, which is not only **creating new growth drivers but also contributing to enriching rural India, raising farmer incomes, fortifying food and livelihood security, and establishing globally trusted value chains.**

ITC: Proudly Indian Brands — Creating and Retaining Value in India

In a growing consumption-led economy, strong domestic brands assume strategic importance because they channel consumer aspiration into national value. Brands are vital **repositories of trust, quality, innovation and intellectual property**. When successful Indian brands win consumer preference at scale, they **retain larger value within the country**.

That is why '**Vocal for Local**' is not merely a sentiment; **it is a strategy to reinforce domestic capability, create and nurture brands that are born in India but made for the world with impeccable quality and trust that can delight consumers globally.**

Your Company's aspiration to be India's No. 1 FMCG player is anchored on this larger vision. Today, ITC's portfolio of over 30 world-class FMCG brands represents annual consumer spends of **nearly ₹37,000 crore** and reaches around **280 million households** while being exported to over **70 countries**. It is indeed difficult to find parallels globally of an enterprise that has launched so many large, successful and trusted home-grown brands in a relatively short period.

ITC's brands enrich everyday moments in Indian homes — from **Sunfeast** biscuits in the morning, to breakfast choices of **Aashirvaad Besan chillas** and **Yoga Bar** cereals, to **Fiama** bathing experiences, **Mangaldeep** devotional moments and **Classmate's** joy of learning, from baby and pet-safe clean homes with **Nimley** to meals with **24 Mantra Organic**, **Aashirvaad** staples and **Sunrise** spices, to fun times with **Bingol**, **ITC Master Chef** and **Prasuma** snacks, mini meals with **YIPpee!** and ending the day with **Fabelle** for luxurious indulgence and **Pranah** for relaxation.

The Indian FMCG market is poised for significant expansion, with your Company's addressable market estimated at around ₹8 trillion by 2035, pointing to the immense headroom to grow. The consumer landscape in India is also evolving rapidly. The rise of Aspirational Bharat, premiumisation, Gen Z and Gen Alpha consumers, expanding digital access and the growth of quick commerce are reshaping categories, channels and expectations. Today's '**maximiser consumer**' simultaneously seeks taste and nutrition, convenience and trust, indulgence and wellness, value as well as premium experiences.

In line with the **ITC Next strategy**, your Company is making rapid progress in not only scaling its core power brands but developing a future-ready portfolio that is constantly alive to evolving consumer needs. A critical foundation is ITC's **AI-led consumer insight ecosystem**, that drives **targeted micro-segmentation** to help craft a pipeline of differentiated

offerings — be it by life stages, lifestyle, channel, occasion, shelf-life requirement and health need, among others. This vibrant portfolio has been enriched with new acquisitions in areas of promise that are already clocking an ARR of around ₹1,350 crore, effectively synergising the entrepreneurial energy of start-ups with ITC's scale and institutional strengths. These differentiated products reach millions of homes through your Company's smart omni-channel network with unique multidimensional capabilities across ambient, chilled, frozen and perishable supply chains.

India today faces the twin challenges of adequate nutrition and rising lifestyle-related health concerns. Aligned to ITC's '**Help India Eat Better**' Mission, a **Good-for-You** portfolio is being built to address **deficiencies in protein, fibre, micronutrients and gut health**. These include the **Yoga Bar protein range** for Gen Z, **Sunfeast Breakfast protein-rich shakes** for early jobbers and **Aashirvaad Protein Atta** for the entire family. The **Right Shift** range for the **40-plus cohort** is fortified with fibre, protein and micronutrients. **24 Mantra Organic** provides trusted organic products, while **Aashirvaad Millet Flour, Multigrain Flour, Sunfeast Farmlite biscuits, and Yoga Bar** high-fibre breakfast cereals serve the growing need for better fibre intake and gut health.

Leveraging emerging spaces such as wellness and naturals, your Company's Personal Care portfolio reflects the convergence of nature, and science. **Nimley** brings the goodness of Neem into homecare, while **Savlon** continues to expand its trusted hygiene equity across personal wash, germ protection, surface disinfection and medicated skincare. The acquisition of **Mother Sparsh** marks ITC's strategic presence in premium natural baby care, rooted in traditional Indian knowledge for new-age mothers seeking specialised solutions. Building on **Fiama's** industry-first **gel bar technology**, the new **Japanese Hokkaido Milk range**, which is being patented, reflects sensorial innovation that promises non-sticky moisturised skin.

Innovation is at the heart of your Company's future-ready portfolio, which is powered by **ITC's Life Sciences and Technology Centre**, with over 400 world-class scientists. **What sets the Centre apart is not just its deep research capabilities and future-ready platforms, but its focus on end-to-end value chains, from seed to fork and tree to paper, enabling your Company to craft winning products of impeccable quality.**

We recognise that **business innovation is as crucial as product innovation**. Consumers increasingly seek fresh cooked food solutions where freshness, speed, quality and trust converge. Responding to this, your Company launched the **Fresh Food Business**, leveraging ITC's institutional strengths in trusted brands, food sciences, cuisine expertise and digital capabilities. With over 70 cloud kitchens across five cities, the business has grown over 100% in the last three years through a delectable portfolio comprising **Aashirvaad Soul Creations, ITC Master Chef Creations, Sunfeast Baked Creations and Sansho** from ITC Master Chef, which have consistently received top consumer rankings.

Your Company's growing standing in FMCG, powered by the trust of millions of consumers, gives us the confidence to dream boldly — of a future where an ITC product adorns every household in India and makes its mark across continents. ITC's world-class Indian brands will continue to be a significant enduring strength, creating larger value for the enterprise and its stakeholders.

ITC: Powering Make in India for a Viksit Bharat

Your Company's **Bharat Built Manufacturing architecture** has created world-class national assets across **FMCG, Paperboards & Packaging and export-oriented value-added Agri Processing**. Today, ITC's manufacturing ecosystem spans **over 300 factories**, including 45 owned plants, engaging with more than **9,500 MSMEs**. These large investments in modern facilities provide strong levers of competitiveness, resilience and local value-chain development.

In the true spirit of **Make in India**, nearly **90% of ITC's value addition takes place within the country**. The agri and food processing industry has high employment-to-capital intensity. Therefore, your Company's 170 factories in this sector **are a powerful economic multiplier, deepening inclusive farm-to-consumer value chains and linking farmers to domestic and global markets.**

Your Company's confidence in the India story is reflected in its proposed medium-term capex of ₹20,000 crore for the Group in areas that have a multiplier impact. Close on the heels of 8 recently commissioned facilities, 6 new projects are in the pipeline. Your Company's leadership as **India's largest integrated paperboards and paper business** will be reinforced by the forthcoming acquisition of Century Pulp & Paper, raising capacity by over 50% to 1.5 million metric tonnes. The newly established **state-of-the-art Moulded Fibre Products** facility is pioneering complex engineered compostable solutions for single-use plastic substitution for both domestic and global markets. As each of your Company's businesses scales up in line with the ITC Next strategy, its manufacturing ecosystem is poised to expand further, contributing to India's aspiration to be a global manufacturing powerhouse.

Your Company's distributed manufacturing network is also a **vibrant hub of innovation, quality, sustainability and safety besides providing structural competitiveness**. An AI-first digital backbone in ITC's manufacturing facilities enhances efficiency, cost optimisation and responsiveness. Several units now meet nearly 100% of their electricity needs from renewable sources, are Platinum-rated green buildings or have achieved global AWS standards.

In line with ITC's deep commitment to an **Aatmanirbhar Bharat**, your Company is also placing sharper thrust on indigenisation and **to build structural competitiveness**. Your Company pioneered the **Bharat Fibre chain for its Paperboards business through massive afforestation, substituting imports and saving foreign exchange while creating a green cover, substantial rural livelihoods and larger value in India**. Today, this initiative has greened **nearly 1.5 million acres, generating over 270 million person-days of employment**.

ITC also established the **first-of-its-kind Bleached Chemi-Thermo Mechanical Pulp Plant** at Bhadrachalam, creating domestic capability in specialised pulp, and is now investing in a second BCTMP mill. Additionally, investments have also been made in domestic capsule manufacturing capacity and a Décor Paper plant to substitute imports. These interventions will significantly enhance cost competitiveness while also enabling foreign exchange savings exceeding **₹17,500 crore over the next decade**.

For us at ITC, this is the larger meaning of **Bharat Built Manufacturing** in action — **to build globally competitive domestic manufacturing assets**, substitute imports, enrich the environment and support sustainable livelihoods.

ITC: Supporting Climate Action & Inclusive Growth

I now turn to two defining imperatives of our times — **climate resilience and livelihood generation** — both vital for a sustainable, inclusive and competitive future. For India, climate risks are acute, severely impacting agri-food security, livelihoods, productivity and infrastructure.

While the Government has spearheaded world-leading efforts, the consequences of the climate crisis demand far more urgent, collective and sustained action at scale — globally, nationally and locally.

To my mind, enterprises can take transformational measures to combat climate change and also foster inclusive development. ITC's comprehensive approach addresses climate risks through large-scale programmes aimed at decarbonisation, adaptation, nature-based solutions and circularity, while also implementing a mosaic of solutions for rural empowerment.

What differentiates ITC's sustainability journey is a triad of achievements. First, **Longevity**, that is reflected in decades of sustained environmental impact. Second, **Scale**, which is demonstrated through the massive creation of ecological capital and support to millions of livelihoods. Third, **Integration**, through a distinctive model where sustainability and inclusivity are core pillars of strategy, governance and programmes.

ITC is the only company in the world to be carbon positive, water positive and solid waste recycling positive for around 2 decades now. ITC's businesses support nearly 9 million sustainable livelihoods.

Decarbonisation remains an important element of our climate action. Over the years, your Company has made significant investments in areas like renewable energy, green infrastructure and mobility. It is a matter of immense satisfaction that ITC has **surpassed several of its ambitious 2030 Sustainability 2.0 targets**, even as our businesses have expanded considerably. We are now committed to achieving **Net Zero Operations by 2050**, entailing a reduction in GHG by over 85% in the next 25 years.

While Decarbonisation has gained significant traction globally, **Adaptation** measures have not drawn the attention they deserve. The world, after breaching the 1.5°C threshold last year, is headed towards 2.8°C warming in this century if stronger pathways are not pursued. This is clearly alarming and calls for decisive and urgent action.

Recognising this, ITC has implemented impactful **Adaptation and Nature-based Solutions** for ecosystem restoration that strengthens climate resilience, enhances farm productivity, water availability, green cover and biodiversity while supporting rural livelihoods. ITC's **Climate Smart Agriculture**, which now spans nearly **32 lakh acres** across 17 States, benefits over **12 lakh farmers**. It is premised on focused programmes that **build strong capabilities through skilling, technology adoption and development of institutional linkages**. We propose to cover **40 lakh acres under this initiative by 2030**. Impact studies have shown that CSA practices in rice and wheat have reduced costs **by over 20%, improved yields by around 10% and enhanced net returns by over 23%** compared to conventional practices.

Your Company has built deep capabilities in water stewardship, afforestation and biodiversity conservation. ITC's **large-scale water management interventions** follow a three-pronged approach — community-led watershed programmes, demand-side agricultural water management and revival of river sub-basins. Demand-side initiatives, focussing on **"more crop per drop"**, cover over 20 lakh acres, creating annual water-saving potential of **up to 50% across 15 crops, aggregating to 1.5 billion cubic metres**.

Supply-side watershed projects cumulatively span **nearly 20 lakh acres**, helping around **90% of farmers** in catchments to cultivate through the year. Four river sub-basins have been made water positive, with work under way on the fifth. Such water stewardship interventions have improved gross cropped area by as much as 12%, cropping intensity and groundwater levels by up to 14 and 15% whilst delivering larger benefits for communities.

Biodiversity conservation is a key priority area for sustaining natural ecosystems, strengthening agri-food security, supporting rural livelihoods and building long-term resilience.

Your Company's programme focuses on restoring ecosystem services that support agriculture. This is expected to cover **nearly 10 lakh acres by 2030**.

Your Company's **Social Investments Programme** spans **275 districts in 20 States**, cumulatively benefiting over **10 million people**, including **6 million women** while amplifying

impact with 98 public-private-people partnerships. While the scale and outcomes are deeply satisfying, what inspires us to do more are the human stories behind the numbers.

It is heartening to **witness farmers with better incomes, women with greater economic agency, children with stronger learning foundations and youth with improved employability**. This larger purpose to make a meaningful difference defines the core of our social endeavours.

India's ancient wisdom enshrined in **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam** reminds us that the world is one family, and the responsibility to protect our only home — the planet as well as its people — rests on all of us. We believe that our '**dharma**' of **Responsible Competitiveness** and the spirit of '**Aparigraha**' to **mindfully use resources** as well as '**Abhyudaya**' which is **premised on simultaneous economic and societal progress**, are timeless principles that will continue to inspire us in creating enduring value for all stakeholders.

In Conclusion

As India advances towards becoming a developed nation, ITC will remain steadfast in its commitment to serve with purpose, innovate with responsibility, grow with the nation and multiply value for our country. **Our heart and soul have always belonged to India. This has been our legacy. It will remain our promise.**

It is a privilege for ITC to be part of this momentous journey — powered by an inspiring Vision, guided by unshakeable Values, and energised by renewed Vitality.

As I conclude, I would like to reaffirm my belief that your Company's greatest and most enduring asset is its people. It is their dedication, ingenuity and unwavering commitment that give wings to our ambition, resilience to our efforts and purpose to our progress. Their dedication gives us the courage to dream boldly and shape ITC as an exemplary institution of a new India with **passion, performance and purpose**.

On behalf of the Board and myself, I thank all our stakeholders for their continued trust, support and encouragement.

Together, let us partner India and help build a future worthy of the aspirations of this great nation.



IN FOCUS



Kanwariyas carry the water of river Ganga as they take out a Kanwar yatra procession to offer prayers to Lord Shiva along the National Highway 48 during the holy month of sawan in Gurugram, Haryana PTI

IGIA expands domestic routes

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi International Airport has expanded its domestic network to 90 destinations with the launch of direct scheduled flights to Daman, operated by Alliance Air. The launch makes it the only airport in India to offer direct connectivity to 32 of the country's 36 States and Union Territories, covering 27 States and five Union Territories, DIAL CEO Pradeep Panicker announced on Tuesday.

The airport currently handles more than 1,050 daily domestic flight movements and over five million domestic passengers every month, including approximately one million domestic-to-domestic transfer passengers. The 90 destination count is the highest



among all airports in India and excludes seasonal winter destinations of Khajuraho and Jaisalmer, which are included in the broader network count.

Panicker said the launch of the Daman route is a significant milestone.

"Reaching 90 domestic destinations and becoming the only airport in the country to provide direct connectivity to 32 of India's 36 States and Union Territories reflects our continued commitment to enhancing accessibility,

supporting regional economic growth and providing passengers with a wider range of travel options," he said.

The addition of Daman gives the airport direct connectivity to the Union Territory of Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu. The route improves access for tourists drawn to Daman's beaches and Portuguese heritage and for business travellers visiting one of western India's established manufacturing centres, known for pharmaceuticals, chemicals, plastics, textiles, and engineering industries.

As a transfer hub, Delhi Airport's connectivity means passengers from across India and overseas can access Daman through onward connections at Delhi rather than requiring a separate hub.

Indian vessel sinks after Red Sea attack

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

An Indian-flagged merchant vessel with 13 Indian nationals aboard came under attack off the coast of Yemen on Tuesday, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said. All the Indians have been rescued, it said.

New Delhi condemned the attack and said targeting of commercial shipping in the region must stop.

"We condemn the attack on the Indian-flagged commercial vessel, MSV Faize Noore Oliya that sank in the Red Sea, off the coast of Yemen on August 4," the MEA said.

"All 13 Indian nationals have been rescued. Our

Embassy in Riyadh is closely monitoring the situation and proactively coordinating with the Yemeni authorities for the safety and security of the crew," it added.

The MEA thanked the Yemeni authorities for their support in rescuing the Indians. "The continuing incidents of attacks on commercial shipping in the region are deeply worrisome," it said. "The targeting of commercial shipping in the region must end, and free and unimpeded navigation and commerce through the international waterways in the region, in keeping with international law, must be restored at the earliest," the MEA said in a statement.

Turbulence injures 14 on AI Phuket-Delhi flight

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

An Air India (AI) flight from Phuket to Delhi ended with several passengers requiring medical attention after it encountered severe turbulence during cruise on Tuesday. Air India flight AI 2379 experienced sudden drop in altitude, nearly 300 feet, causing minor injuries to a few passengers and crew members. A total of 14 people onboard, including 10 passengers and 4 crew members, are said to have suffered injuries in the incident. They have been shifted to Medanta Hospital in Gurugram and India Spinal Injury Centre in Vasant Kunj.

"There was a sudden drop in the plane's altitude. I hit my head on the roof and then fell down," one passenger recalled. Air India said the aircraft landed safely and there were no serious



Representative image

WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

injuries. "A small number of passengers and crew members with minor injuries requiring medical assessment have been taken to a medical facility at the airport for precautionary examination and care by Air India's airport team and medical personnel," the airline said in a statement. There has been

no indication of structural damage to the aircraft or any emergency involving the flight itself.

As information emerged through the day, different figures surfaced regarding those injured. Initial reports suggested that eight to twelve passengers and crew sought medical attention after

landing. Fortis Hospital in Vasant Kunj later confirmed that seven passengers had been admitted for observation and further evaluation.

As of Tuesday evening, none of those admitted had been reported to be in critical condition, providing reassurance that the injuries were not considered life-threatening.

Air India is expected to review flight data and weather conditions encountered during the flight as part of its standard post-incident procedures. Depending on the final medical assessment of those injured, the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) may also examine the incident under established reporting norms.

The Phuket-Delhi sector is one of the busiest international leisure routes for Indian travellers.

MEA distances Govt from Hasina event

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on Tuesday stated that the Government of India has no connection with a media programme in New Delhi that is expected to feature former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina. The ministry emphasized that the event is being organised independently by a private organisation and does not represent the views or position of the Indian Government.

Speaking at the MEA's regular media briefing, spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal clarified that the Centre has neither participated in the planning of the event nor endorsed any statements that may be made during the interaction.

"The event in question is being organised by a private media entity. The Government of India has no involvement in it and does not endorse any opinions that may be expressed during the programme," Jaiswal said.

The clarification follows reports that Sheikh Hasina is scheduled to address an event hosted by the Foreign Correspondents' Club of South Asia in



MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal PTI

New Delhi on August 5 through a virtual platform. Bangladesh has reportedly conveyed its concerns to India, arguing that such an appearance could have implications for the recent improvement in bilateral relations between the two countries.

The matter was discussed during a meeting in Dhaka between Bangladesh's Foreign Affairs Adviser Humayun Kabir and India's newly appointed High Commissioner to Bangladesh, Dinesh

Trivedi, as both sides reviewed issues concerning bilateral ties.

During the briefing, Jaiswal also confirmed that India had extended a formal invitation to Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman for a bilateral visit after he assumed office in February 2026.

He further said Rahman has been invited to participate in the outreach session of the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi in his capacity as the current Chair of BIMSTEC. According to the MEA, inviting leaders of regional organisations to the outreach segment is a standard practice followed by the BRICS grouping. Officials in Bangladesh have confirmed receipt of the invitation, adding that the proposal has been forwarded to the Prime Minister's Office for a decision. They noted that Bangladesh's participation would also align with its current leadership role in BIMSTEC, ahead of the organisation's 30th anniversary celebrations and the summit scheduled to be hosted in Dhaka in 2027.

The 18th BRICS Summit is scheduled to be held in New Delhi on September 12 and 13, 2026.

WhatsApp tests new age verification methods to comply with DPDP Act

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

WhatsApp is testing new ways for users to confirm their age while keeping their privacy in mind. This is to get ready for new Indian laws like the Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDP).

The company said that age information will stay private and won't be shared with other users. Taking part in the age check is optional, and people can keep using WhatsApp

without giving this information.

"To comply with upcoming laws in India like the Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDP), we are testing privacy-protective ways for people to confirm their age. This doesn't change how WhatsApp works or your experience. We understand that information about someone's age is private and it won't be shared with other WhatsApp users," a WhatsApp spokesperson said.

WhatsApp has asked some users for their date of birth

because of new legal rules in India. This has led people to think the platform is getting ready for future age checks.

Early Tuesday, IT Secretary S Krishnan said the move "might be from the context of the DPDP Act, where it is age-related."

"But we will have to check with them... because we are approaching the deadline..." Krishnan had said.

When asked about the ministry's next steps on user-name notices, Krishnan said the issue is not just about



WhatsApp but affects all messaging apps. He explained that both the risk of impersonation from username features and privacy concerns need to be considered.

If the IT ministry decides to set common rules for all messaging platforms, Krishnan said, "We are looking at what they had to say, the feedback that they've given, and we will take a final call."

The username feature lets users chat on the platform without sharing their phone numbers. Last month, the

government sent a notice to WhatsApp, which is owned by Meta, saying the new username feature could lead to more online fraud, phishing, digital arrest scams, and impersonation. It asked WhatsApp to pause the feature until consultations are concluded. WhatsApp currently has nearly 500 million users in India. Explain why action shouldn't be initiated under the IT Act and rules over WhatsApp's proposed feature that may increase cybercrimes. It also reminded Meta

that WhatsApp, as a significant social media intermediary, is bound by due diligence obligations under the IT Act and rules. WhatsApp has replied to the Government notice and confirmed it will not launch the feature in India until the discussions are complete.

After sending the notice to WhatsApp, the IT ministry also sent notices to Telegram and Signal. They asked these platforms how they handle fraud and impersonation risks linked to their username features.

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SC gives RBI four weeks to frame SOP on cyber...

It also asked them to take steps to adopt the e-Zero FIR mechanism, in consultation with the Indian Cyber Crime Co-ordination Centre (I4C). "The I4C shall ensure necessary follow-up and provide the requisite assistance to the States for implementation of these directions," the Bench added. "The concerned authorities shall take appropriate steps to ensure the expeditious disposal of matters relating to the freezing of bank accounts arising out of cyber-enabled financial frauds," it further directed.

The bench directed the Inter-Departmental Committee to issue necessary directions, advisories and instructions to all States, UTs, ministries and Government departments to undertake and promote awareness programmes relating to cybercrimes, including digital arrest scams.

"The Inter-Departmental Committee shall consult with banks and intermediaries regarding technological measures that may be adopted to prevent digital arrest scams, assist in the recovery of defrauded amounts, facilitate investigation of digital arrest cases; and ensure cooperation and compliance with all applicable statutory obligations and legal requirements..." The Inter-Departmental Committee is directed to examine and discuss the proposal for a shared liability and victim compensation framework," it said.

At the outset, the bench referred to earlier directions and said that they were issued to secure a coordinated response from the concerned ministries in relation to digital arrest scams.

"Those directions concerned, inter alia, investigation by the CBI, mule accounts, misuse of SIM cards and SIM boxes, cooperation by intermediaries, grievance redressal and restoration of defrauded money, and institutional coordination," it said.

Panel turns heat on big tech

Investment fraud made up over 75 per cent of these losses, totalling about ₹16,800 crore.

The committee pointed out that a lack of transparency could mean platforms are not doing enough to check problems. One platform said it banned over 72 lakh Indian accounts in one

month but did not explain why. Another platform put 92 per cent of user complaints under Other issue category. The committee also looked at how platforms may enable fraud. Hyderabad City Police data showed that from 2024 to mid-2026, there were 2,367 cybercrime cases linked to Meta platforms. Almost 90 per cent involved WhatsApp, and nearly two-thirds were about fake investment schemes. Three fake trading apps led to reported losses of about ₹48.87 lakh. Dubey asked whether National Cybercrime Reporting Portal (NCRP) complaints should go straight to platforms; what the fastest response time for scam ads could be; whether failed SEBI checks should stop trading app promotions; how repeat advertisers are blocked; and why platforms do not share fraud detection numbers.

The committee called the temporary removal of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's official Facebook post about the NEET exam a serious failure, not just a technical mistake. Dubey asked for a full record of what happened from the report to the post's restoration, public explanations for account actions, and publication of user reports with the actions taken. He also wanted to know what protections are in place for emergency Government messages and if stronger laws are needed to prevent such problems. Liability concerns grew around Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM). Dubey referred to a BBC Eye investigation that claimed Instagram ran paid ads leading users to CSAM channels. He said that if this is true, it shows a failure in the ad review system. The committee asked how these ads passed internal checks, how many were found in India and worldwide, what disciplinary actions were taken, what technology improvements were made, and what steps will prevent this from happening again.

The committee invoked Section 79(3)(b) of the IT Act, under which intermediary immunity does not apply when a computer resource controlled by the platform is used to commit an unlawful act, and asked whether the Ministry of Home Affairs or I4C had detected the activity before the BBC report. Section 69A blocking powers were also referenced, with the observation that action reportedly followed only after public exposure.

The committee also looked at new AI rules. The updated IT Rules, starting 10 February 2026, require platforms to watch AI-generated content,

but there is still no special way to report deceptive material.

The chairman asked for details about visible labels, how official fact-checks are shown to users who see false information, protections against deepfake investment scams, how harmful ads are caught before they go live, and if platforms will allow outside audits of their AI moderation systems. The committee asked platforms to give specific, evidence-based answers and clear promises to improve due diligence, reporting, and oversight. They requested written replies to any unanswered questions within ten days, and said the proceedings will stay confidential.

From Netflix glamour to global scrutiny: Inside...

Police records show that Sanpal faces at least nine criminal cases in Jabalpur, at stations such as Omti, Madan Mahal, Lordganj, and Kotwali. One of the 2022 FIRs, FIR 170/2022 (Madan Mahal), includes charges under the Public Gambling (MP) Act and related IPC sections for abetment and conspiracy linked to an IPL betting operation. Police reports say that arrested associates named Sanpal as the leader, and cash was seized.

FIR 356/2022 (Lordganj) charges Sanpal with cheating for allegedly using Aadhaar and PAN cards without permission to open shell company accounts for illegal transactions.

FIR 338/2022 (Madan Mahal) lists charges of cheating, forgery, and conspiracy related to cheque theft and a larger criminal operation. Authorities say an illegal online cricket and IPL betting network was run from Dubai, using digital platforms and local agents. Investigators report that funds moved through shell companies and hawala channels, with transactions estimated at over ₹1,000 crore. Raids, including one at RK Tower in Jabalpur, led to the seizure of about ₹21.55 lakh in cash, company seals, cheque books, and betting records. Several associates were arrested, but Sanpal was not detained.

In August 2022, Jabalpur Superintendent of Police Siddharth Bahuguna asked the Bureau of Immigration to issue an LOC against Sanpal, calling him a flight risk who runs betting exchanges from outside India. The LOC is still

active and has come up in Delhi High Court proceedings. Sanpal's passport records show he left Mumbai for the last time in March 2020 and later received a self-sponsored UAE Golden Visa in 2021. Court records list him as "farar" (absconding) in some cases, but he has secured bail in eight of the nine cases, and the ninth is bailable. He has not been convicted or declared a proclaimed offender. Sanpal denies the allegations and has challenged media reports.

In 2026, the Delhi High Court stopped some publications from calling him a "fraudster" or "Satta King" while investigations continue. Institutions and virtual asset service providers are to freeze the funds, accounts, investments, digital wallets, and safe deposit boxes of Sanpal, Tabinda, ANAX Capital Asset Management Company, ANAX Capital Financial Markets LLC, ANAX Holding FZCO, and SSB Bazaar General Trading LLC. The freeze will last for 30 days at first and could be extended. Institutions must check if the funds are legitimate. No criminal charges have been announced in the UAE, and the reason for the investigation has not been made public.

Family members have also been named in Indian cases. Reports say Soniya Sanpal, described as either a wife or relative, has been declared a proclaimed offender in one case, with claims that large sums were moved through a shell company and a small reward was offered for information. Tabinda is also included in the UAE freeze order. Despite the FIRs, SIT investigation, and active LOC, Indian central agencies have not filed a separate money-laundering case against Sanpal. The ongoing cases, LOC, and asset freeze continue to keep Sanpal under legal scrutiny.

Udhayanidhi arrested, released on bail as TN...

Provisions of the Tamil Nadu Prohibition of Harassment of Women Act have also been invoked, sources added. DMK workers resorted to flash strikes and demonstrations across the State strongly condemning the arrest.

TVK escalated its protest against Udhayanidhi's alleged offensive remark by filing complaints with the local police and the National Commission for Women. A police complaint was lodged at the Thanjavur East Police Station by S Bairavi, TVK's

Central District Women's Wing organiser for Thanjavur.

The complaint alleged that when the crowd chanted "Trisha, Trisha" during the Leader of the Opposition's speech on the Cauvery issue on August 3, he responded with an obscene, double-meaning remark.

The complainant accused him and DMK IT wing office-bearers of intentionally degrading women, causing "mental agony" to the actor and women in general, and deliberately circulating a 2-minute, 39-second video of the incident on the social media platform X to cause public unrest. Simultaneously, TVK national spokesperson Pazha Selvakumar lodged a formal complaint with the NCW in New Delhi.

The party urged the NCW to issue a notice seeking an explanation and demand an unconditional public apology from Udhayanidhi.

CRPF officer shoots dead 2 colleagues before...

Another CRPF personnel ASI/Mane Govind Sriplu was injured in the incident and taken to a private hospital, she said.

Later, the injured was referred to Gauhati Medical College and Hospital, the DSP said.

Senior CRPF and police officers rushed to the camp, and an inquiry into the incident was ordered, she added. Explaining the sequence of events, Nagaon Senior Superintendent of Police Partha Protim Das said that ASI Premabaram, who hailed from Andhra Pradesh, was found without his assigned weapon while he was discharging duty at the main gate of the CRPF Camp this morning.

"He subsequently took an INSAS rifle from the Guard Room and proceeded towards the rear side of the Quarter Guard, where he opened fire on Baghel, who succumbed to his injuries," Das told PTI. Premabaram then fired at Yadav, who had come for document verification from Lucknow and the officer also died on the spot, the Assam Police SSP said.

"The ASI also fired at Sriplu, causing serious injuries to him. After firing, Premabaram entered the B/171 Barrack and shot himself, resulting in his death," Das said.

The police are investigating the case along with the CRPF, he added.

ECI extends SIR, door-to-door voter verification till August 17

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Tuesday revised the SIR (Special Intensive Revision) dates in Delhi, with the door-to-door verification exercise by booth-level officers (BLOs) extended till August 17 and the publication of electoral rolls rescheduled for October 27.

This is the second extension for the revision of voter rolls in the Capital this month. The door-to-door verification exercise currently underway was earlier scheduled to conclude on August 8.

According to the poll panel, the draft electoral rolls will now be published on August

24, instead of August 17. After publication of the draft rolls, the voters will be able to file their claims and objections from August 24 to September 23, as per the revised schedule. Earlier, the claims and objection filing period was August 17 to September 16.

The claims and objections filed by the voters will have to be disposed of by the poll officials between August 24 and October 22.

The final voter lists will be published on October 27, instead of October 19 as scheduled earlier. Currently, the BLOs in Delhi have distributed enumeration forms to almost all the 1.45 crore voters in the city, while over 62 per cent of the filled-up

forms were digitised.

As per the details shared by the EC, Enumeration forms for Delhi's SIR of electoral rolls have been distributed to 1,45,08,587 of the city's 1,45,10,298 registered electors, achieving 99.99 percent coverage as of 8 pm on Tuesday. All 12 of Delhi's 13 districts reached 100 per cent distribution, and 91,74,992 forms were digitised, representing 63.23 per cent of the total electorate.

The only district yet to achieve 100 per cent distribution is North West, which stands at 99.87 per cent with 12,75,414 forms distributed out of 12,77,126 electors. All other 12 districts have achieved complete distribu-



tion. On digitisation, Outer North leads at 73.33 per cent, followed by South West at 71.33 per cent and West at 70.13 per cent. The lowest digitisation rates are in South East at 50.60 per cent and the East at 57.10 per cent, indicat-

ing that the backend data entry work is proceeding at different speeds across districts even as physical distribution is nearly complete.

Before this extension, the last date for the door-to-door verification exercise by BLOs

was August 8. The Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), in a press statement, said that the fresh extension was aimed at giving some more time to voters for submitting their filled-up enumeration forms.

The process of digitisation of enumeration forms submitted by the voters has been a little slower in Delhi due to multiple reasons. The Delhi CEO office has requested the voters who have still not submitted their enumeration forms to do so at the earliest.

According to the poll officials, the names of around 20 per cent voters may be deleted in the draft publication due to multiple reasons, especially on account of

people moving to new locations from their registered addresses.

The BLOs have claimed that many voters have yet to return the forms provided to them. Errors in details provided by the voters, technical issues, difficulty in finding voter details previously recorded, etc., have also been cited as factors delaying the digitisation of enumeration forms.

Some other BLOs complained that the "biggest hurdle" now is that many voters have not returned the enumeration forms after filling them up because of difficulty in finding details from the 2002 SIR. There are many who came to Delhi and

became voters after 2002 and have to trace their details in the SIR of their home state, which is even more complicated, they said.

The BLOs also said that many people took multiple enumeration forms on behalf of their family members and did not return them after completing them. All such forms will be finally marked as "uncollectable", further adding to the workload.

Some BLOs also claimed that technical issues were encountered in operating the BLO-Net app used for the digitisation process. "Verification exercise was slowed by technical problems with the app in the initial weeks," they claimed.

Government directs schools to introduce daily 30-minute reading session, library activities

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

To inculcate a habit of reading among students, the Delhi Government has directed its schools to introduce a daily 30-minute reading session, structured library-based activities, book talks, storytelling and reading tasks throughout the academic year. In a circular, the Directorate of Education recommended 20 activities that may be conducted at different intervals during the academic year, including daily reading time, weekly library periods and read-aloud sessions, monthly book talks, storytelling competitions and book review writing.

The DoE said schools should promote a culture of reading in line with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020. It asked schools to ensure effective use of library resources, make age-appropriate books easily accessible and encourage students to develop reading habits through planned activities.

The guidelines require schools to earmark a dedicated 30-minute reading



period daily for primary classes, set up reading corners in every classroom with at least 20 age-appropriate books, and keep libraries open during recess.

Allocate 10-15 minutes every day for uninterrupted silent reading. Students may read any age-appropriate book of their choice to develop a regular reading habit and improve comprehension.

It has directed schools to set up a small collection of books in every classroom for easy access. Students should be encouraged to borrow, exchange, and read books during free periods or designated reading time.

Teachers or senior students read stories, poems, or articles aloud using proper expression and pronuncia-

tion. Interactive discussions may follow to improve listening and comprehension skills. Students present a brief introduction to a book they have read, highlighting the story, characters, and why others should read it. This develops communication skills and encourages peer learning.

Teachers have been asked to engage with students during the reading period, conduct 10-minute book discussions twice a week and organise at least one reading assembly every month.

It also suggested quarterly reading challenges and book exhibitions, annual reading festivals, book donation drives and the identification of "Reading Ambassadors" to encourage peer learning.

Schools have also been asked to maintain class reading registers, organise a parent reading workshop every quarter and encourage families to spend 10 minutes daily for reading together at home. Conduct a dedicated library period every week where students explore books, develop library skills, and engage in independent reading rather than only issuing and returning books.

School librarians have been directed to display new arrivals prominently, issue at least two books per student every week, maintain updated reading records and identify students who are reluctant readers so that they can be guided individually. Every student maintains a record of books read, including the title, author, date completed, and a brief reflection. This helps monitor reading progress throughout the year.

The circular further said implementation of the directions would be reviewed during school inspections and monthly meetings and asked all heads of schools to ensure strict compliance to inculcate reading habits and better use of school libraries.

Delhi University allows two colleges to admit UG students through merit-based physical mode

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi University has granted special permission to two of its colleges — Aditi Mahavidyalaya and Bhagini Nivedita College — to admit undergraduate students through merit-based admissions in physical mode to fill seats that have remained vacant despite multiple rounds of the CUET-based admission process.

The colleges had approached the university after repeated admission rounds under the Common Seat Allocation System (CSAS) failed to generate adequate enrolment. They had proposed considering a combination of CUET performance and Class 12 marks to fill the remaining seats. Authorities from the two colleges attributed the persistent vacancies to their location and the limited applicant pool for women-only institutions.

The move marks a departure from the university's Common University Entrance Test (CUET)-based admission system, under which admissions to undergraduate programmes are conducted through the Common Seat



Allocation System (CSAS).

DU Registrar Vikas Gupta confirmed that both colleges had been granted permission to admit students through CUET scores as well as merit-based selection. Bhagini Nivedita College, in a notice dated August 1, invited applications for merit-based admissions in physical mode for several undergraduate programmes, including BCom, BA, BSc and other courses.

The notice said admissions would be made strictly on the basis of Class 12 marks and availability of seats, with applications to be submitted by August 5. Document verification and fee payment are scheduled for August 6 and 7. Bhagini Nivedita College is located in Kair Village, on Najafgarh-Dhansa Road.

Aditi Mahavidyalaya, situated in Bawana, said around 40 per cent of its seats have remained vacant in recent years under the CUET admission process.

College authorities said many students from nearby rural areas, particularly girls, do not register for CUET because of concerns about studying far from home, resulting in several eligible candidates being left out despite strong Class 12 performance.

The college maintained that CUET would continue to remain the primary mode of admission and that the merit-based process was intended only to fill vacant seats after the regular admission rounds.

The development highlights the challenges faced by some

DU colleges in attracting students through the university-wide CUET and CSAS admission framework.

While the system is designed to bring uniformity to undergraduate admissions, continued vacancies at colleges located away from the city's main academic hubs have prompted institutions to seek greater flexibility in filling their sanctioned seats.

The decision has drawn criticism from the Indian National Teachers Congress (INTEC), which has urged the university to adopt a uniform policy for filling vacant undergraduate seats across all colleges instead of extending the facility to only two institutions. INTEC has written to the vice-chancellor seeking a common and transparent mechanism for such admissions.

DU has been admitting students to various undergraduate programmes offered across its 67 affiliated colleges through the CUET-based admission process conducted by the National Testing Agency since the 2022-23 academic session. So far, two rounds of admissions for the 2026-27 session have already concluded.

Assembly's sixth session to begin on August 7

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Assembly will begin its Sixth Session of the Eighth Legislative Assembly at 11 am on Friday, August 7, 2026, in the Assembly Hall at the Old Secretariat.

The House is scheduled to sit on August 7, 10, and 11. Speaker Vijender Gupta announced on Tuesday.

The Speaker further added that a Quick Response Team of the Central Reserve Police Force has already been deployed at the premises, and hydraulic road blockers are being installed at all entry gates ahead of the session.

The session was summoned following an order from the Lieutenant Governor, with the formal notification issued on July 31. Each sitting will continue until the listed business for the day is concluded and



may be extended depending on the volume of business before the House.

On procedures, Gupta said all notices required under the Rules must be submitted digitally through the NeVA Portal, with assistance available to members through the Notice Branch and the NeVA Sewa Kendra. Members wishing to raise matters under Rule 280 must

submit their notices by 5 pm on the working day preceding the concerned sitting. Gupta appealed to all members to follow prescribed procedures and cooperate in ensuring productive proceedings across the three-day session.

The Speaker expressed confidence that the session would provide members with a meaningful opportu-

nity to raise matters of public importance and participate in constructive deliberations on issues concerning the people of Delhi.

He said informed debate, adherence to legislative procedure, and responsible conduct were essential to preserving the dignity of the House and strengthening public confidence in democratic institutions.

On security, Gupta said comprehensive arrangements are being put in place to maintain a secure and efficiently managed environment within the Assembly premises. Hydraulic road blockers are being installed at all entry gates, and access-control points are being reinforced. Entry to the premises will be regulated through Gate No 1 while the remaining gates will remain restricted to streamline movement and strengthen perimeter control.

The CRPF Quick Response Team has been deployed to ensure an immediate and effective response to any emergency. Measures covering threat perception, intelligence inputs, deployment strategies, surveillance systems, communication networks, contingency planning, visitor management, frisking procedures, traffic regulation, and emergency preparedness, including medical, fire, and evacuation mechanisms, are all being strengthened. All concerned agencies are working in close coordination.

The three sitting days of August 7, 10, and 11 provide a compact but significant window for the government to advance its legislative agenda while the opposition is expected to use the session to press the BJP on monsoon preparedness, the E20 fuel controversy, and other governance issues.

City records 137 clean air days till Aug 4

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi has recorded 137 clean air days till August 4 this year, as against 130 during the corresponding period last year, the city government said on Tuesday, attributing the improvement to sustained planning and scientific interventions. Delhi has recorded five consecutive days of 'satisfactory' air quality until Tuesday, with the Air Quality Index (AQI) remaining within the range of 51 to 100, the government said in a statement.

The capital recorded an AQI of 64 on Tuesday. Pollution hotspot Vivek Vihar recorded an AQI of 43, which falls in the 'good' category (0-50).

According to the statement, Delhi has recorded 137 clean air days so far this year. This is seven more than the number of clean air days recorded during the same period last year. In 2016, Delhi logged only



110 clean air days, the statement said.

Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the improvement was a result of sustained planning and scientific interventions, among other things.

"The steady improvement in Delhi's air quality reflects the outcome of sustained planning, scientific interventions and round-the-clock efforts by multiple government agencies, as well as sustainable and environment-friendly practices adopted by

citizens," the statement quoted Sirsa as saying. He said the government will continue to strengthen enforcement, dust mitigation measures, biomining of legacy waste, pollution hotspot management and continuous monitoring to further improve air quality. The minister urged citizens to support the government's efforts by avoiding open waste burning, maintaining vehicles properly, reducing unnecessary vehicle use and planting more trees.

"The fight against pollution cannot be won by the government alone. Every citizen has an important role to play," Sirsa said.

According to the statement, the government's anti-pollution drive continued across the capital over the past 24 hours, during which around 2,243 metric tonnes of construction and demolition (C&D) waste were lifted and scientifically disposed of.

DDA's Dwarka Golf Course draws over 850 membership applications in 11 days

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Development Authority's (DDA) Golf Course in Dwarka has received more than 850 applications in just 11 days of the opening of its memberships. The lifetime membership registration for the golf course, opened on the directions of Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, has received registrations exceeding the available slots offered within just 11 days of commencement of the registration process.

"Of the 856 applications received so far, 636 applications have been received under the Non-Government Category against 600 memberships available, making the category oversubscribed. The Government Category has also received an encouraging response, with 220 applications received against 250 memberships, and is close to full subscription.

As the registration window will



remain open for two months from 21 July 2026, both categories are likely to be oversubscribed by the close of the registration period," DDA said in a statement. DDA is offering a total of 850 lifetime memberships, comprising 600 memberships under the non-government category and 250 memberships under the government category. In addition, applicants may also opt for 3-year and 5-year tenure memberships, providing greater flexibility to golfers with different requirements.

The lifetime membership fee is ₹3.50 lakh for the government category and ₹7.50 lakh for the non-government one, the statement said,

adding that three-year membership is available at ₹1.20 lakh and ₹2.50 lakh for the government and the non-government category, respectively, while the five-year membership fee is ₹1.80 lakh and ₹4.50 lakh. The registration window will remain open for two months from 21 July 2026. Both categories are likely to be oversubscribed by the close of the registration period, the DDA said.

Interested applicants can continue to apply online by paying a non-refundable registration fee of ₹2,500. Following scrutiny of applications, successful applicants will be required to deposit the applicable membership fee online within 30 days of issuance of the offer of membership.

In categories where the number of eligible applications exceeds the memberships available, allotment will be carried out through a fully computerised draw of lots after the registration period closes, ensuring a transparent, fair and impartial selection process.

Ramleela productions integrates AI, 3D mapping and digital effects to create immersive audience experiences

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

While grandiose sets, elaborate costumes and larger-than-life performances have regaled Ramleela audiences in the capital since time immemorial, a tech-led reinvention of the popular form — with the import of AI, 3-D visual effects and digital backdrops — now promises an unique immersive experience for viewers.

Some of the capital's most renowned Ramleelas are looking to integrate artificial intelligence (AI) into different aspects of the productions this year, from visual effects and set design to script and narration, organisers said.

The Luv Kush Ram Leela Committee — known for its grand annual Ramleela performance near the Red Fort — is preparing for what organisers



described as its most technologically advanced production till date.

The 11-day Ramleela will be staged from October 11 to 21, with Dussehra on October 20. More than 160 artistes from film, television and theatre are expected to participate in this year's production. "This will be the biggest technological leap in the history of our

Ramleela productions," Luv Kush Ram Leela Committee president Arjun Kumar said.

"AI and 3-D mapping technology are not only being used for rendering images on the LED-screen backdrop but also to create elaborate three-dimensional sets and visual effects to provide an immersive experience for audiences," he said.

Kumar claimed the Luv Kush

Ram Leela Committee is erecting "the country's largest four-storey stage", with the installation of a massive LED screen.

One of the key sequences of the Ramleela will begin with Lord Hanuman appearing seated atop the giant screen. AI-generated visuals will then make him appear to fly down from the perch before the actor portraying Lord Hanuman emerges mid-air and continues the sequence, creating the illusion of a single continuous movement.

Similar technology will be used during battle scenes and other important episodes from the Ramayana to add greater depth, movement and scale. Two giant cranes will be deployed for aerial sequences, including scenes depicting Lord Hanuman carrying Lord Ram and Lakshman on his shoulders above the stage.

By-election results: An alarming signal

DR AN DWIVEDI

The by-elections in three States have concluded, and the results are now before the public. The outcomes in the Datia Assembly constituency of Madhya Pradesh and the Bankipur Assembly constituency of Bihar were not unexpected. The BJP suffered decisive defeats in both seats, with the Congress winning Datia and Prashant Kishor emerging victorious in Bankipur.

In Gujarat, however, BJP candidate Satendrabhai Patel retained the Manjalpur Assembly seat. The electoral mood in Madhya Pradesh and Bihar had already indicated an adverse trend for the BJP, and those indications were ultimately reflected in the results.

Political observers suggest

that the party had sensed this undercurrent even before polling. In a democracy, a by-election is not merely a contest to fill a vacant seat; it also serves as a barometer of changing public sentiment.

Viewed in that context, the outcomes in Bihar and Madhya Pradesh should be seen as a warning sign, reflecting the electorate's current political mood. The verdict, in the author's view, amounts to a rejection of the policies pursued by the Governments led by Samrat Chaudhary in Bihar and Mohan Yadav in Madhya Pradesh.

The results raise questions about accountability, both within the Governments and the party organisation. By-election candidates generally seek votes on the basis of the performance and policies



BJP National President Nitin Nabin arrives for the NDA's Mangal Milan meeting in New Delhi on Tuesday

PTI

of the ruling Government.

For many first-time candidates, the Government's

record is often their principal

electoral asset. If that strategy failed to persuade voters

in these constituencies, the reasons deserve careful examination.

The significance of these by-elections lies in the fact that the BJP is in power in all three States. While it retained Gujarat, defeats in Bihar and Madhya Pradesh carry political significance even if they do not threaten the stability of the Governments. Such outcomes often send broader political messages.

The political backdrop to these elections is also important. In recent months, discontent among young people over employment, education and competitive examinations has been increasingly visible. Ignoring voter dissatisfaction for a prolonged period can prove costly for any political party.

At the same time, the BJP's strategy of promoting new

leadership in several States appears to have generated resentment among some senior leaders and party workers. The author cites the example of Narottam Mishra in Madhya Pradesh, who publicly expressed his disappointment after being denied the party ticket from Datia, a constituency he had represented multiple times.

Given his influence in the region, the decision is viewed as having contributed to the Congress victory. It would be premature to draw conclusions about the national political implications of these by-election results. Nevertheless, the verdict serves as an important political signal and underscores the need for introspection.

The author is Editor of
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UAE seeks more documents for fugitive Hussain Shattaf's extradition, says MEA

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

India's bid to extradite fugitive murder accused Hussain Shattaf from the United Arab Emirates (UAE) has moved into a fresh procedural phase, with UAE authorities requesting additional documentation, the Ministry of External Affairs confirmed on Tuesday.

Speaking at the weekly media briefing, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said the extradition request has already been formally submitted and is under examination by the UAE side. "The specific extradition request was sent to the UAE side. They have asked for some additional documentation in this regard, and we are working on the matter," he stated. On the broader question of pending extradition requests between the two countries, Jaiswal said he would need to check and respond later.

Shattaf is wanted for the 2006 murder of retired Merchant Navy Captain Manmohan Singh Viridi in Lonavala, Maharashtra.

According to the Viridi family, he also faces charges of forgery, criminal breach of trust, and obtaining a passport on false particulars. He is alleged to have fled India after the crime and used a forged marriage certificate to secure residency in the UAE illegally.

Nearly two decades after the killing, the case has

gained renewed attention as the victim's family has intensified its appeals for Government intervention. They say justice has remained elusive because the prime accused has not been brought back to stand trial.

Following the MEA's latest statement, family members voiced cautious optimism. "We have great faith in our Government and our country. I am sure the Government is doing its best to secure the extradition of my brother's murderer from the UAE," said Captain Manjit Singh Viridi (Retd.), brother of the deceased and the original complainant.

Earlier this week, the family submitted a fresh representation to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, urging him to intervene and expedite the process. In the letter to the Prime Minister's Office, Capt. Viridi noted that the prolonged delay has effectively stalled the murder trial and denied the family closure after almost 20 years.

While the MEA's confirmation shows active diplomatic engagement with the UAE, the request for further documents indicates that procedural requirements under the bilateral extradition framework are still being fulfilled. For the Viridi family, however, the latest development has revived hope that one of India's longest-pending extradition cases may finally advance toward resolution.

Lashkar commander admits over 30 operatives killed in Pak

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH ■ New Delhi

A top member of the Pakistan-based terrorist group Lashkar-e-Tayyiba (LeT) has openly admitted that the group has suffered heavy losses. Rizwan Hanif, who is a senior commander and deputy chief of LeT's Pakistan-occupied Jammu and Kashmir (PoJK) wing, said that "unknown gunmen" have killed over 30 group members in Pakistan and PoJK in the last three to four years.

The video, reportedly filmed in May 2026 and recently appearing on social media, shows Hanif speaking to supporters and mentioning places like Peshawar, Karachi, Rawalpindi, Muzaffarabad, and Rawalakot. Hanif said, "Over the past three to four years, more than 30 of our people have been killed by Indian

intelligence agents," and described this as an "unknown gunman model." Indian security agencies have confirmed the video is real and that Hanif is a wanted LeT terrorist involved in recruiting, cross-border infiltration, and working with proxy groups.

LeT carried out the 2008 Mumbai attacks, which killed 166 people, and has been linked to other major incidents in India. The United Nations has sanctioned the group for its ties to al-Qaeda and the Taliban. Pakistan has repeatedly said that LeT was banned and shut down years ago. But Hanif's statement on video challenges this claim, offering a rare public admission that the group is still active and facing problems.

Hanif did more than report the deaths. He called those killed martyrs and claimed their only "crime" was their



Representative image

AP

faith. He also used harsh and offensive language against other religions. His speech shows how these groups keep trying to radicalise their followers, even as they lose members. Experts have noticed a trend of similar unclaimed killings of militants linked to LeT, Jaish-e-Mohammed, and other groups in Pakistan in recent

years. Unknown shooters often carry out these attacks, and no group takes responsibility.

India has strongly denied any role in these incidents. Officials have rejected similar claims before, saying that Pakistan's internal violence is due to its own security problems, such as rising militancy and protests in PoJK,

Balochistan, and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa. The video's release comes at a time of wider unrest in these areas, raising questions about whether these groups can still operate freely.

Hanif's admission stands out because it is so rare. Terror groups usually hide their losses and try to appear unbeatable. By blaming "Indian agents," Hanif might be trying to motivate his followers, avoid blame, or put pressure on Pakistani officials. Still, his claim also shows that these groups are active in Pakistan, even though they are officially banned. They continue to recruit and lose members in cities far from any war zone. This has bigger consequences. For years, the "unknown gunmen" issue has led to rumours and conspiracy theories on both sides of the border.

While no independent evi-

dence has substantiated foreign orchestration of every incident, there is no independent proof that foreign groups are behind every attack. Still, the overall impact on militant leaders is clear. Some people linked to major attacks have also been killed, making the remaining members feel under threat.

As the video spreads, it is a strong reminder that groups like LeT are still a danger and are under pressure from within. Pakistan's claim that these groups no longer exist is now directly challenged by one of their own leaders. It is unclear if this admission will lead to more accountability, more fear among members, or just more propaganda. The "unknown gunmen," whoever they may be, have forced a rare moment of candour from a group more accustomed to denial and defiance.

Tech trail: How India is shrinking the world for fugitive criminals

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH ■ New Delhi

Since 2019, India has brought back 274 fugitive criminals from 36 countries. In 2018, Prime Minister Modi introduced the Fugitive Economic Offenders Act to help with these efforts. Under Home Minister Amit Shah's guidance, India now uses a coordinated approach that relies on intelligence and technology to find fugitives and bring them back.

Before 2014, India maintained extradition treaties with 37 countries but lacked dedicated laws for economic fugitives or asset seizure. From 2004 to 2013, the country averaged four successful extraditions annually, with 110 requests pending. Key challenges included incomplete documentation, procedural delays, legal barriers such as double jeopardy and dual criminality, and poor inter-agency coordination.

The Government has since prioritised extradition, focusing on international cooperation, agency coordination, and diplomatic engagement. Addressing fugitive offenders is considered essential for safeguarding sovereignty, the economy, law and order, and national security.

Foreign courts frequently reject extradition requests because of incomplete paperwork and procedural delays. Legal obstacles, including double jeopardy and dual criminality, led to further denials. Poor



Union Home Minister Amit Shah

coordination between departments hindered information sharing, fugitive tracking, and the issuance of Red Corner Notices.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah described a strategy based on global outreach, coordination, and diplomacy. Fugitive offenders are seen as threats to sovereignty, economic stability, law and order, and national security. The NIA (Amendment) Act and UAPA (Amendment) Act were passed in 2019. Since 2020, efforts to bring fugitives back have increased, now targeting not just banned organisations but also individual terrorists, handlers, funding networks, and support systems abroad.

Recent changes have strength-

ened India's capacity to pursue fugitives and dismantle their networks. Three new criminal laws include provisions for fugitive offenders. Sections 355 and 356 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) now permit trials in absentia, allowing judicial proceedings to continue without the accused present.

India hosted the 90th Interpol General Assembly in 2022. In January 2025, the Government launched BHARATPOL to enhance coordination and information sharing among the CBI, State Police Headquarters, and District Police Headquarters. Over 1,400 State and Central agency units are now connected, reducing response

times and improving the efficiency of investigations and extradition processes.

Enforcement of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) has intensified, resulting in the seizure of assets worth ₹17,874 crore from fugitive criminals between 2019 and 2026. The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) established a Special Global Operations Centre for real-time collaboration with international police via Interpol. Interpol Contact Officers have been appointed in every State and Central agency to strengthen coordination with foreign counterparts.

India has increased the number of Interpol Red Corner Notices issued in recent years: 40 in 2022, 100 in 2023, 107 in 2024, 112 in 2025, and 182 so far in 2026. Operation Trishul was launched to locate absconding criminals using satellite data, surveillance, and digital footprint analysis. Technology and profile mapping have enabled agencies to identify fugitives who changed identities abroad. Video conferencing has accelerated extradition proceedings. In the last three years, Red Corner Notices have been issued for 401 fugitives.

Extradition requests are now standardised and include written assurances tailored to each country's legal requirements. Returned fugitives include individuals wanted for terrorism,

organised crime, financial offences, drug crimes, murder, rape, and offences under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act.

India's extradition efforts address cases related to terrorism, pro-Khalistan extremism, links between gangsters and terrorists, drug trafficking, cyber fraud, and counterfeit currency. The extradition of Tahawwur Hussain Rana from the United States demonstrates ongoing legal and diplomatic engagement in complex terror cases. In Jammu and Kashmir, fugitives abroad have supported terrorism, narco-terrorism, and cross-border networks. Sustained legal, diplomatic, and follow-up measures enable the return of fugitive offenders.

Within India, these efforts involve coordination among the Intelligence Bureau, Central Bureau of Investigation, Research and Analysis Wing, National Investigation Agency, Enforcement Directorate, Ministry of External Affairs, Narcotics Control Bureau, Directorate General of Goods and Services Tax Intelligence, and State Police forces. The establishment of a Standing Focus Group under the Multi Agency Centre (MAC) of the Intelligence Bureau in January 2026 marks a significant step in strengthening India's fugitive management system.

Mamata calls for mass movement against BJP

SAUGAR SENGUPTA ■ Kolkata

Apparently emboldened by the by-election results in Patna and Madhya Pradesh, Trinamool Congress supremo Mamata Banerjee on Tuesday called for a mass movement against the BJP in Bengal, particularly referring to the recent "disrespectful" remarks made against Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose by some senior politicians and frequent arrests of TMC workers.

Releasing a strong video in which she alleged large-scale intimidation of TMC workers by way of false cases and incarceration and forced occupation of panchayats, the former Chief Minister said that the present Government was inflicting "untold oppression in various forms."

Calling out for a mass movement, Banerjee said how the BJP had turned Sonar Bangla (golden Bengal) into "prison" even as she asked, "Where has the peace and cultural harmony gone today for which Bengal was famous?" She said, "They have turned Bengal into a mega prison."

Apparently referring to recent remarks by two Rajya Sabha MPs from Bengal, she said how some people who had no idea of Bengal's culture and politics had started publicly humiliating national icons like Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose. "Netaji and Rabindranath Tagore have suddenly gone out of the country... they are being insulted, and some

people are poking fun at them... some even are calling him (Netaji) a traitor, which is unacceptable... we are ashamed to hear what they are saying ... they are disrespecting Netaji in his own place," Banerjee said, adding how Bengali was fast disappearing from Bengal.

Referring to how the police were being "misused" for political purposes, she said, "I always respected the police, but this police is different... they are intimidating... they are asking me (MPs and MLAs) to either join the other group or go to jail... is this the job of police?"

Saying that the BJP was capturing the local panchayats by using force and intimidating the members, she urged the public and party workers to come together and build a strong mass movement against these actions. "They have registered thousands of false cases on our workers and are forcing the panchayat and municipality members to join them... it is not democracy and should be protested against," she said.

She also alleged that the Accredited Social Health Activist (ASHA) workers were also being humiliated and attacked at various places.

Referring to her own "victimisation," she said, "they have even stopped royalty on my books on which I rely for my living." Banerjee's remarks gain significance amid rising political tensions in Delhi and the BJP's defeat in two out of three Assembly by-elections.

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH ■ New Delhi

The Ministry of Home Affairs' (MHA) Internal Security Division held a meeting with law enforcement agencies on Tuesday to assess the possible involvement of non-governmental organisations (NGOs) in recent protests in the national Capital and other regions.

According to sources, the meeting focused on whether any NGOs helped organise, fund, or promote demonstrations led by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP). The CJP protests, which took place in June and July 2026, highlighted alleged problems in competitive exams like NEET. Protesters demanded the Union Education Minister's resignation, compensation for affected students' families,

and broader education reforms. These events received significant media coverage.

The movement began with young people organising through social media, inspired by court comments and worries about unemployment and exam fairness. It grew into sit-ins at Jantar Mantar in Delhi, marches to Parliament, clashes with security forces, internet shutdowns ordered by the MHA, and a larger police presence. The protests ended in late July after the Government agreed to key demands and the minister resigned, but some tensions and complaints about incomplete changes continued.

Groups, student organisations, activists, and some farmers' bodies expressed support at various stages.



Notable individuals, such as educationist and activist Sonam Wangchuk, participated through actions like a

hunger strike. Although the mobilisation was digitally coordinated by youth, authorities routinely review

the role of external organisations in large-scale protests that may disrupt public order or align with sensitive legislative periods.

This review is part of the MHA's wider approach to monitoring civil society groups, especially under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA). Over the past ten years, thousands of FCRA registrations have been cancelled or have expired because of worries about transparency, misuse of funds, or activities seen as harmful to national interest or public order.

Critics say these reviews might mix up genuine dissent with foreign-influenced disruption, which could limit civil society activities. Supporters argue that, because of complex security issues, it is important to look at all parts of long-

running protests, including funding, organisational help, and online activity, to keep public order and protect institutions.

In 2026, new rules brought more checks on foreign-funded groups, their leaders, operations, and assets. Some NGOs and minority groups have criticised these changes, saying they make it harder to do real advocacy and welfare work.

These meetings usually bring together people from central and state police, intelligence agencies, and other enforcement groups. They aim to collect information from the ground, study how groups are mobilising, and suggest actions like more surveillance, reviewing regulations, or taking preventive measures, sources said.

Lok Sabha passes Appropriation Bill

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Lok Sabha proceedings were adjourned for the day on Tuesday after the passage of the Appropriation Bill, 2026 amid Opposition protest over alleged theft of donation at the Ram Temple and other issues.

Soon after the House assembled at 2 pm after an earlier adjournment, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman introduce a Bill to replace an Ordinance which scrapped income tax with regard to foreign investment in Government securities.

Opposition members, who had given notices to speak against introduction of the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, chose not to do so despite their names being called by the Chair.

The Bill seeks to amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, the



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman speaking in the RS during the Monsoon session of Parliament in New Delhi PFI

Income-tax Act, 2025, and the Finance Act, 2027.

Amid the uproar, the Lok Sabha passed the Appropriation (No 3) Bill, 2026 by voice vote.

The Bill seeks to provide for the authorisation of appropriation of moneys out of the Consolidated Fund of India to meet the amounts spent on certain

services during the financial year ended on March 31, 2023, in excess of the amounts granted for those services and for that year. Earlier, when the Lok Sabha met for the day, Speaker Om Birla urged members to allow the Question Hour to function and appealed for their cooperation.

Opposition members con-

tinued raising slogans, including "Home Minister, answer us", amid their protest over the police action on student protesters during their march to Parliament on July 20.

Birla said he had appealed to leaders of all parties at the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) meeting to ensure the smooth functioning of

Parliament. Describing Parliament as the highest forum of democracy, he said it should be used to discuss and pass laws for the country and was not a platform for slogan-shouting or displaying placards.

So far, five Bills have been passed by the Lok Sabha during the current Monsoon Session. Of these, the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026 and the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026 have been approved by both Houses.

The Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026, the Appropriation (No.3) Bill, 2026 and the Supreme Court Judges (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026, which seeks to increase the sanctioned strength of the apex court from 34 to 38 judges, are awaiting consideration in the Rajya Sabha.

Congress functionary robbed, stabbed to death in Chhattisgarh



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Durg

A Congress functionary was stabbed to death by unidentified persons while allegedly resisting a robbery in Chhattisgarh's Durg district, police said on Tuesday.

The incident took place around 2 am on Monday near Chikhli village on the Durg-Dhamdha road, an official said. He said that the victim, Prakash Singh Kashyap (45), a treasurer of the Congress's local unit, was travelling to his house in Tumkala village with two of his associates on a motorcycle when four assailants intercepted them.

They threatened the trio with a knife and robbed Kashyap of his mobile phone and ₹4,000 in cash, the official said.

Fadnavis slams Congress for Gungi Gudiya jibe at Sunetra

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Mumbai

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis on Tuesday took a swipe at the Congress, accusing it of stooping low only to grab headlines after the Opposition party branded Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar a *gungi gudiya* (mute doll).

Talking to reporters, Fadnavis said Maharashtra's political culture did not approve of attempts to gain publicity through low-level comments.

"Some people are working only to get into news. They seem to believe in the idiom that 'even if you become infamous, at least your name is in the headlines'. This is not Maharashtra's political culture," he insisted. Fadnavis was replying to queries on the Maharashtra Congress branding Sunetra Pawar,



Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis

NCP president and the state's first woman deputy CM, a *gungi gudiya* (mute doll).

The NCP is a BJP ally and a constituent of the ruling Mahayuti coalition.

"Sunetra Pawar, how many more days will she remain a 'gungi gudiya'?" the Congress stated in a post where it also uploaded a video of a press conference attended by her and party colleague Dhananjay Munde.

In the video, Munde is seen interrupting a journalist's question. Pawar did not respond to the question but left the venue once Munde announced the interaction as over.

In response to another question, the CM said the Maharashtra Public Service Commission (MPSC) itself had sought a police investigation into allegations surrounding its examination process.

On allegations of irregularities in the MPSC examination process, Fadnavis rejected claims of a scam.

Union Govt tightens checks on GLP-1 weight-loss drug ads

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Centre has directed drug regulators across States and Union Territories to tighten surveillance over the supply chain and promotion of GLP-1 weight-loss drugs amid concerns over surrogate advertising and misleading awareness campaigns.

In a written reply in the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday, Minister of State for Health Anupriya Patel said the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) has approved



glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) receptor agonists only for the treatment of Type 2 diabetes in adults and for chronic weight management in adults with specified medical conditions.

She said these medicines can be dispensed only on the prescription of endocrinologists or internal medicine specialists, and the approved product information carries warnings to prevent inappropriate use and minimise risks associated with unsupervised consumption.

Responding to a question on whether advertisements for weight-loss drugs under the guise of "awareness" were crossing the line and whether GLP-1 drugs were being promoted through surrogate marketing, Patel said CDSCO had issued an adviso-

ry on March 10, 2026, to manufacturers, importers and marketing authorisation holders. The advisory directed them to strictly comply with the Drugs and Cosmetics Act and ensure that manufacture, sale and distribution conform only to approved indications and conditions of permission.

It specifically prohibits surrogate advertisements and any form of direct or indirect promotion, including disease-awareness campaigns and digital outreach, that may mislead consumers or encourage the use of

these prescription medicines without medical supervision, she said.

Patel said CDSCO subsequently issued another advisory on March 27, 2026, to all State and UT drug controllers, asking them to strengthen regulatory monitoring of the entire supply chain of GLP-1-based weight-loss drugs. The advisory also called for strict adherence to approved indications and product labelling, ensuring that manufacture, import, distribution and sale take place only through authorised channels.

IYC demands Amit Shah's resignation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Indian Youth Congress (IYC) National President Uday Bhanu Chib led a protest march in Rampur on Tuesday, demanding the resignation of Amit Shah, under the *Chhatron Ki Goonj* program.

Speaking on the occasion, IYC National President Uday Bhanu Chib stated that Home Minister Amit Shah must appear in the Lok Sabha and answer for the brutality inflicted upon students; this demand is not merely that of the opposition but of the entire nation. He must answer why such cruelty was



Uday Bhanu Chib leads protest march in Rampur PIONEER PHOTO

unleashed against students.

Since the use of pellet guns and lethal force against students occurred under the

Home Minister's orders, accountability must be fixed; conversely, if it happened without his knowledge, it

raises serious questions regarding the country's internal security apparatus.

Uday Bhanu Chib further affirmed that they would ensure justice for the nation's students and continue fighting for their cause.

Echoing the sentiments of the Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi, he emphasised that those who attacked the students must be punished, accountability must be established. IYC National Secretary Vishal Chaudhary, Western Uttar Pradesh State President Paras Shukla, and numerous Youth Congress workers participated in the march.

Govt launches action plan to protect clouded leopard

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India has launched the Clouded Leopard Conservation Action Plan (CAP) to reaffirm its commitment to the conservation of one of Asia's most elusive wild cats, Environment Ministry officials said on Tuesday.

The announcement was made to mark the International Clouded Leopard Day, celebrated on August 4 every year.

The action plan provides a comprehensive framework for securing habitats,



restoring forest connectivity, strengthening scientific monitoring and empowering local communities for conservation of the species.

The clouded leopard is among the most evolutionarily distinct and among the least studied felids in Asia.

Assam flood toll rises to 87, nearly 1.3 lakh still affected

TONY DAS ■ Guwahati

The toll in Assam's flood rose to 87 with two more fatalities, and nearly 1.3 lakh people were still affected by the deluge even though water was receding from most of the inundated areas across the State, officials said on Tuesday.

However, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has predicted extremely heavy rain with thunderstorms in Arunachal Pradesh and Meghalaya for the next few days, which could affect several Assam districts bordering the two States.

Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma visited many flood-affected areas and rehabilitation centres in Upper Assam on Tuesday. "By meeting with the flood-affected families, I and our team are continuously monitoring the process of relief, compensation, and rehabilitation. At the same time, the work of draining water from the flood-affected areas is also proceeding rapidly," said Sarma, urging people to donate to CM's Relief Fund. Union Health Minister JP Nadda also reached Guwahati to monitor the situation.

"The weather pattern suggests that thunderstorms with lightning and extremely heavy rainfall (orange and red warnings) are expected at most places of East Khasi Hills, West Jaintia Hills and East Jaintia Hills of Meghalaya and Papumpare, Kurung Kumey, East Kameng, East Siang, Lohit and Changlang districts of Arunachal Pradesh. This may impact the neighbouring districts of Assam," the



CM Himanta Biswa Sarma visits flood affected districts PIONEER PHOTO

weather office said.

A yellow warning (watch) has also been issued by IMD for most parts of Nagaland, which could impact Charaideo, Sivasagar, Jorhat and Golaghat districts of Assam, it said. According to the Assam State Disaster Management Authority (ASDMA) bulletin issued on Monday night, two deaths were reported from Sivasagar district in the last 24 hours. With these fatalities, the toll in this year's flood reached 87.

"Although reports of overnight rain were received from most of the flood-hit Upper Assam districts, water levels continued to recede from the inundated villages, giving some respite to the villagers," an ASDMA official said.

Altogether 1,28,000 people remained affected by the deluge across six districts, with Sivasagar being the worst-hit with over 55,000 impacted, followed by

Charaideo (nearly 35,000) and Jorhat (more than 20,000).

The ASDMA said the administration has been operating 55 relief camps and relief distribution centres in five districts, currently taking care of 11,250 affected people.

Multiple agencies, including medical and veterinary teams, have been deployed in different flood-relief operations in the affected areas.

A crop area of 14,230.15 hectares remained submerged. Due to widespread flooding, almost 55,000 animals have been washed away, while another 35,000 have been affected.

Damage to various infrastructure, including embankments, houses, roads, schools and other public properties, was also reported from various parts, the ASDMA bulletin added. At present, the Dhansiri river at Numaligarh is flowing above the danger level, it added.

Ex-Bihar governor DY Patil passes away

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Former governor of Tripura, Bihar, and West Bengal, Dnyandeo Yashwant Patil passed away on Tuesday at Kolhapur in western Maharashtra after a prolonged illness. He was 90.

A leading 'education baron' of Maharashtra, DY Patil founded and managed several education and sports institutions. The DY Patil Stadium in Navi Mumbai, venue of many international cricket matches, is named after him. The DY Patil Group he founded in 1983 operates over 160 educational institutions, deemed universities and prominent sports and medical infrastructure in Navi Mumbai, Pune, and Kolhapur.

Patil passed away at his residence in Kolhapur on Tuesday morning, family sources said. He is survived by his sons, former State minister and Congress leader Satej Patil, Sanjay Patil, Ajinkya Patil, and daughter Nandita Palshetkar, a gynaecologist.

Patil was a member of the State Legislative Assembly from 1967 to 1978 before turning his focus to the education sector. The DY Patil



University founded by him offers courses in medicine, engineering and many other disciplines.

Patil was mayor of Kolhapur from 1957 to 1962, and was elected as an MLA from the Panhala constituency in 1967 and 1972.

Born on October 22, 1935 in Ambap, a village in Kolhapur district, Patil established the first private engineering college in Navi Mumbai.

In recognition of his contributions to education and social service, he was honoured with the prestigious civilian award, the Padma Shri, in 1991.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi expressed grief over the passing away of his former party colleague.

Only 50% of India's STPs meet 2015 norms: Par panel

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Only 50 per cent of 1,044 sewage treatment plants (STPs) comply with the discharge standards notified in 2015 and merely 15 per cent meet the stricter standards prescribed in 2019, according to a parliamentary committee's report tabled in the Lok Sabha on Tuesday.

The report referred to the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs' (MoHUA) submission before the Standing Committee on Housing and Urban Affairs chaired by Magunta Sreenivasulu Reddy during its sitting held on March 24 this year.

Reddy presented in the Lok Sabha the Tenth Report of the Committee on the subject "Review of Sewerage and Septage Coverage in cities with special reference to interventions under AMRUT & AMRUT 2.0" pertaining to the Department of Urban Development, MoHUA.

Responding to the Committee's query on the low compliance levels,



the ministry said it had commissioned a third-party survey to carry out a ground-level assessment of sewage treatment plants across the country.

According to the MoHUA, the survey team visited 1,044 STPs with a total installed capacity of around 27,974 million litres per day (MLD). The operational capacity of these plants was around 24,000 MLD.

According to the panel's report, the ministry said samples of treated water were collected to examine whether the plants were meeting the prescribed parameters relating to biochemical oxygen demand (BOD), chemical oxygen demand (COD) and faecal contamination.

"The team visited 1,044 plants... What we found was very interesting. Only 50 per cent of the STPs were complying with the CPCB (Central Pollution Control Board) standards of 2015. And if we see the NGT standards, it was only 15 per cent.

"The NGT standards are very stringent standards. It is like even better than drinking water," the ministry told the Committee.

It said the standards prescribed by the National Green Tribunal (NGT) were "very stringent" and complying with them would substantially increase the cost of treatment.

The ministry told the panel that it was redefining the standards in line with the CPCB norms, describing them as more practical to implement.

It also informed the Committee that unless the water is going into the river, the ministry wants further treatment, adding that adopting the NGT standards across the board would be "very, very high" in cost.

The ministry further told the Committee that a panel has been constituted under the Central Public Health and Engineering Organisation (CPHEO), comprising experts and stakeholders, for revision of the standards.

In the report, the parliamentary panel said that in view of the growing sanitation challenges arising from rapid urban expansion into peri-urban and informal settlements including slums and the risk of fragmented planning and unequal access to sanitation services, the ministry should ensure their systematic integration into urban sanitation planning through GIS-based mapping, time-bound inclusive sanitation action plans and model guidelines for extending appropriate sewerage and onsite sanitation services, support

Chhattisgarh UCC panel invites public suggestions till October 15

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Raipur

A committee set up to draft a Uniform Civil Code (UCC) framework for Chhattisgarh has sought suggestions and opinions from citizens, social groups, and political parties by October 15, officials said Tuesday.

Headed by Justice (retired) Ranjana Prakash Desai, the five-member panel is tasked with examining existing personal laws to bring all citizens under a common civil framework governing marriage, divorce, maintenance, inheritance, adoption, and succession across the State, a Government release said.

The committee has appealed to Government and non-government organisations, social groups, religious institutions, communities and political parties to submit their views and representations by October 15, a Government statement said.

The panel has been studying the need for a UCC in Chhattisgarh and preparing its framework with the objective of bringing all citizens under a common legal framework



instead of religion-based personal laws, the statement said.

Citizens have been invited to share their views on what the proposed law should contain, and they can submit their suggestions through email at ucc-chhattisgarh@cg.gov.in, the dedicated web portal, or by post to the office of the Uniform Civil Code Committee at the New Circuit House in Raipur, the release said.



Editor's

TAKE

Cauvery water: Old dispute, new warriors

Every August, as the southwest monsoon falters, the Cauvery once again becomes less a river than a courtroom argument. This year is no different

Cauvery water disputes have become a perennial dispute. At the beginning of this month, Tamil Nadu pleaded before the Supreme Court that Karnataka is again withholding its share of the Cauvery's waters. CM Vijay's government told the court that Karnataka has ignored the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee's July 28 order to release 3,500 cusecs a day at Biligundlu through August 12. A day earlier, Karnataka Chief Minister DK Shivakumar had convened an all-party meeting in Bengaluru, uniting the Congress and the BJP behind a familiar plea: the state is in the grip of a poor monsoon and cannot spare water that its own farmers need.

Same river, same season, same impasse; only the names across the table have changed. The dispute is older than the republic itself. Two colonial-era pacts, in 1892 and 1924, apportioned the Cauvery between Madras and the princely state of Mysore; the 1924 pact lapsed in 1974, and Karnataka's push to expand irrigation reignited the quarrel. Tamil Nadu's plea led to the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal in 1990, whose final award in 2007, after seventeen years, gave Tamil Nadu a far larger share than its 1991 interim order had. Both states appealed, and in February 2018 the Supreme Court recalibrated the numbers: 284.75 thousand million cubic feet for Karnataka, including extra water for Bengaluru's drinking needs, and 404.25 TMC for Tamil Nadu.

To implement this, it ordered the creation of the Cauvery Water Management Authority and its technical arm, the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee, meant to turn an annual political brawl into hydrology and formula. It has not worked out that way. Every deficient monsoon still triggers the same sequence: a CWRG order, Karnataka's reluctance, citing its own distress, and Tamil Nadu's return to the apex court. Layered onto this is Karnataka's long-pending Mekedatu balancing reservoir, which it says will store surplus monsoon flow for dry years without affecting Tamil Nadu's entitlement, and which Tamil Nadu calls an upper riparian's ploy to control the tap.

Hearing Karnataka's plea last November, the Supreme Court called Tamil Nadu's objection premature. The Cauvery Water Management Authority already has the legal architecture to arbitrate on hydrology rather than politics; what it lacks is an automatic, real-time enforcement mechanism that does not require Tamil Nadu to plead before the Supreme Court every August. Publicly verifiable, real-time flow data would settle the perennial argument over how much water actually exists before it ever reaches a courtroom. Mekedatu's fate, too, should be settled where the Supreme Court has already sent it: before the CWMA and the Central Water Commission on engineering merit, not through parallel litigation and competing all-party theatre on both banks of the border.

Karnataka and Tamil Nadu have new Chief Ministers facing an old grievance for the first time. They would serve their states, and the basin's tens of millions, better by trusting the institutions already built for this purpose than by reaching, yet again, for the Supreme Court's number.

A strong Bharat demands stronger institutions

Recent agitations involving farmers and students appear to follow a similar pattern: local grievances rapidly escalate into nationwide movements, amplified by social media and, at times, influenced by domestic and international actors seeking to shape public opinion. As the ruling party has consistently demonstrated a strong ability to win elections, sections of the opposition may increasingly rely on mass mobilisation to challenge the government between electoral cycles, knowing full well that they cannot challenge the current government at the ballot box. However, the government must avoid complacency by responding to genuine public concerns, while the opposition should exercise restraint, ensuring democratic dissent does not spiral into unrest that ultimately harms the nation and all political stakeholders, including the people fanning the fire



PRASHANT TEWARI

India stands at a defining moment in its democratic journey. It is the world's largest democracy, one of the fastest-growing major economies, and an emerging global power. Yet the true strength of a nation is not measured only by GDP growth, expressways, airports, or digital infrastructure. It is measured by the quality of its institutions and the confidence that ordinary citizens place in them. Today, that confidence is under increasing strain. These challenges are not failures of one government or one political party. They are symptoms of institutional weaknesses that have accumulated over decades and have survived successive administrations of every political persuasion. As Abraham Lincoln wisely observed, "When public institutions fail to deliver efficient services, public frustration inevitably rises."

India's police system requires urgent modernization. Across the country, police personnel serve with courage under difficult conditions, yet they often work with inadequate manpower, outdated investigative methods, excessive workloads, limited forensic support, and insufficient technological integration. Citizens frequently perceive investigations as slow, corrupt, and legal processes as cumbersome. Genuine police reforms must focus on professionalism, operational independence, scientific investigation, accountability, and community policing for citizens to view the police as protectors rather than merely law enforcers. Moreover, the lack of reforms has led to police stations in India turning in extortion hubs.

The judiciary remains another pillar requiring comprehensive reform. Justice delayed has become one of India's greatest institutional challenges. Millions of pending cases undermine confidence in the rule of law, delay economic activity, discourage investment, and impose enormous emotional and financial costs on ordinary litigants. Judicial reforms should include significantly increasing judicial capacity, adopting artificial intelligence for case management, strengthening digital courts, simplifying procedures, expanding mediation, and ensuring that justice is both affordable and timely. As William Gladstone famously remarked, "Justice delayed is justice denied." The courts in India have lately become an effective tool to serve the elites; the common man is left high and dry.

Urban governance presents equally serious concerns. India's cities generate economic growth but struggle with pollution, waste management, congestion, flooding, water shortages, unauthorized construction, and inadequate civic infrastructure. Municipal bodies frequently operate with fragmented authority, weak finances, and limited professional capacity. The issue is not simply funding; it is institutional efficiency, accountability, and measurable outcomes. Surely, citizens deserve clean streets, safe drinking water, efficient public transport, and transparent local governance, contrary to what they are getting across the country.

Healthcare represents perhaps the greatest daily concern for ordinary families. Despite remarkable advances in medical science, access to quality healthcare remains highly unequal. Public hospitals in many regions continue to face shortages of doctors, nurses, medicines, equipment, and infrastructure. A medical emergency should never become a financial catastrophe for a family. Investing in primary healthcare, preventive medicine, digital health systems, medical education, and rural healthcare infrastructure must become a national priority.

Education too requires structural transformation. Expanding enrolment alone cannot define success if learning outcomes remain weak. Schools and universities must produce critical thinkers, innovators, entrepreneurs, scientists, and skilled professionals rather than merely examination candidates. India's demographic dividend can become its greatest strength only if education equips young people with practical skills, digital literacy, ethical values, and adapt-



ability in an AI-driven economy. The recent Gen Z agitation should be an eye-opener for the ruling class; it exposes the disconnect between the government and its young citizens,

No discussion on institutional reform can ignore agriculture. Nearly half of India's population continues to depend directly or indirectly on agriculture, yet millions of farmers remain economically vulnerable. Fragmented landholdings, climate uncertainty, rising input costs, inadequate irrigation, price volatility, post-harvest losses, and limited value addition continue to constrain farm incomes. The objective of agricultural policy should move beyond ensuring production to ensuring prosperity. Farmers require modern technology, market access, storage facilities, affordable credit, insurance, research support, and integrated supply chains that allow them to participate meaningfully in India's economic growth.

The rise of social media has fundamentally transformed the relationship between governments and citizens. Public opinion now forms and spreads within hours, turning local grievances into national or even global debates. The Arab Spring demonstrated the disruptive power of digital platforms, while countries such as Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Nepal, and Pakistan have witnessed major political upheavals influenced by rapid information flows and mass mobilization. Several European democracies have also experienced swift political shifts shaped by online discourse. In this digital age, governments must embrace greater transparency, responsiveness, and accountability, as citizens increasingly expect not just policy announcements but tangible, measurable, and timely governance outcomes.

India's young population further amplifies the urgency of reform. Aspirations have risen dramatically. Young Indians seek quality education, meaningful employment, efficient governance, and equal opportunity. When expectations repeatedly encounter institutional inefficiency, frustration naturally increases. Governments must recognize that economic growth alone cannot sustain public confidence unless institutions function fairly, efficiently, and transparently. Mahatma Gandhi reminded us that "The true

measure of any society can be found in how it treats its most vulnerable members." Institutional reform is therefore not an administrative exercise; it is a moral obligation.

Artificial intelligence, digital governance, blockchain, predictive analytics, and data-driven administration present unprecedented opportunities to modernize governance. Governments should deploy these technologies to improve judicial efficiency, detect corruption, streamline public services, strengthen healthcare delivery, enhance agricultural productivity, and improve policy implementation. Technology should become an instrument of accountability rather than merely a symbol of modernization.

The choice before India is clear. Political debates will continue, elections will come and go, and governments will change. But unless India undertakes bold institutional reforms in policing, the judiciary, healthcare, education, agriculture, municipal governance, and public administration, public dissatisfaction will continue to grow irrespective of which party occupies office. Strong institutions, not strong personalities, ultimately determine the success of a democracy. India needs reforms more than swanky airports, ports, railway stations, road network, administrative buildings,

Time, however, is running out fast for governments and citizens alike, for political parties and voters, for the ruling establishment and the opposition. Across India, public patience is wearing thin, and the electorate is increasingly willing to embrace credible alternatives when they emerge. Recent electoral outcomes from Tamil Nadu, where established political equations have evolved over time, to the Bankipur Assembly constituency in Bihar, where a new political force upset a long-standing BJP stronghold- demonstrate that no party can take public support for granted. In a vibrant democracy, performance, governance, and institutional credibility- not historical legacy or political dominance will ultimately determine who earns the people's trust. Reform, therefore, is no longer a matter of choice; it is an imperative for India's democratic and developmental future.

The writer is a public policy expert and columnist

PIC TALK



'Kanwariyas' take out a 'Kanwar Yatra' procession with an idol of Lord Shiva during the holy month of 'Sawan' in Haridwar, Uttarakhand.

PHOTO: PTI

DIGITAL EXPERIENCE



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PRASHANT KISHOR DELIVERS JAN SURAAJ'S FIRST ELECTORAL WIN

The Jan Suraj Party's maiden electoral victory in the Bankipur Assembly by-election, with Prashant Kishor emerging victorious, marks a significant development in Bihar's evolving political landscape.

Prashant Kishor has truly pulled off a masterstroke. He fought the election with remarkable strategy and determination, raising high expectations among the people of Bankipur. His victory reflects not only his personal credibility but also the growing appeal of the Jan Suraj Party as a viable political alternative in the state.

The by-election result also points to a broader political trend, signalling a gradual decline in the BJP's electoral fortunes. The outcome was not entirely unexpected, and similar results may be witnessed in future by-elections if the current political

momentum continues. It appears that the BJP's electoral slide has already begun.

Prashant Kishor secured 63,203 votes to defeat BJP candidate Neeraj Kumar Sinha, who polled 44,250 votes. RJD candidate Rekha Gupta finished a distant third with 14,085 votes. Kishor's victory margin of 18,953 votes is particularly significant as it marks the first electoral success for the Jan Suraj Party since its formation.

This landmark win provides a major boost to the party's political ambitions and strengthens its position as an emerging force in Bihar politics. It also demonstrates that voters are increasingly willing to support new political alternatives that promise credible leadership and meaningful governance.

BHAGWAN THADANI | MUMBAI

Please send your letter to the info@dailypioneer.com. In not more than 250 words. We appreciate your feedback.

For the success of an anti-drug campaign

Appropos the editorial, 'A Drug-Free India Begins with Its Youth', India's "Nasha Mukti Yuva, Viksit Bharat Sankalp Abhiyan" is a welcome initiative. The real challenge now is to translate public awareness into sustained policy action.

Awareness must be backed by life-skills education, mental health support, active parental involvement, access to sports, and effective de-addiction and rehabilitation services in every district. To dismantle the drug supply chain, the focus must extend beyond petty peddlers to include financial networks, hawala operators, organised crime syndicates, synthetic drug manufacturers and digital trafficking channels. Under a zero-tolerance policy, swift and exemplary action against the few "black sheep" who facilitate drug trafficking is essential to strengthen public trust and uphold the credibility of the vast majority of honest officers.

The campaign's success should not be measured merely by rallies or pledges, but by a sustained decline in first-time drug users, successful rehabilitation, and the dismantling of the drug mafia's financial ecosystem. Every consignment seized is important, but every young life saved from addiction is an even greater national achievement.

BRIJ B GOYAL | LUDHIANA

Safety must come before speed

Data recently presented by the Civil Aviation Ministry in the Rajya Sabha reveals an alarming reality about air travel in India. A total of 352 major technical defects were reported in flight operations this year. What is particularly concerning is that 334 of these defects occurred in domestic services, while international flights accounted for only 18. This stark disparity raises serious questions about the maintenance standards and operational practices of domestic airlines. In the race for quick turnarounds, packed schedules and cost-cutting, airlines appear to be compromising essential safety protocols. Technical faults such as engine problems, navigation system failures and hydraulic defects are not minor inconveniences-they can pose grave risks to passenger safety.

Air travel should inspire confidence, not anxiety. The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) must immediately strengthen oversight through rigorous audits, surprise inspections and strict penalties for safety violations. Every aircraft should undergo comprehensive technical checks before being cleared for take-off.

Passengers paying for domestic flights deserve reliable engineering, uncompromised maintenance and complete peace of mind every time they board an aircraft. Safety must remain the aviation sector's highest priority.

N SADHASIVA REDDY | BENGALURU

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Listening to young voices

Appropos "CJP: Resilience, Resistance and India's Youth" (August 4, 2026), the article rightly highlights the growing willingness of young people to question public institutions when they believe fairness has been compromised. Such civic engagement is healthy for any democracy, provided it remains peaceful, disciplined and grounded in facts rather than slogans. The larger issue, however, extends beyond one examination or one protest. Public confidence can be restored only when institutions demonstrate transparency before controversies arise. Examination agencies should adopt independent audits, publish detailed timelines, strengthen digital security and communicate promptly whenever irregularities are reported. Equally important, governments should engage student representatives through structured consultations rather than responding only after public pressure builds.

Youth movements must act responsibly by resisting political appropriation, remaining inclusive and pursuing reforms through informed debate. Lasting change comes from making institutions more accountable.

India has one of the world's youngest populations. Their energy is a democratic asset. If governments, universities and civil society respond with openness, this moment can strengthen public trust and institutional credibility.

A. MYILSAMI | COIMBATORE

Football's soul is not for sale!

The controversy surrounding FIFA President Gianni Infantino's latest plans is not merely about finance or governance – it is about whether football will remain a shared cultural inheritance or become just another global commodity. The battle now is not over who controls the game, but over whether the sport can survive the relentless march of money



KUSHAN MITRA

Those opening lines matter because they capture why football still cuts so deep. It is not just entertainment. It is identity, memory, class, geography and emotion all bundled into ninety minutes. It creates unlikely alliances, dissolves ideological borders, and turns strangers into a temporary family. I may disagree with both Zohran Mamdani and Piers Morgan and I'm sure both of them dislike each other as well. But we all love Arsenal Football Club and celebrated wildly when the North London club won its first title in twenty-two years a few months ago.

That is exactly why the recent actions of FIFA president Gianni Infantino have landed so hard with so many people. When the guardians of the game begin to behave as though football is merely a financial asset to be sliced, packaged and monetised, they do not just make a bad decision. They threaten the soul of the sport itself.

Infantino's reported push to create a new FIFA commercial subsidiary and potentially sell stakes to private investors has been widely read as a money-first move that could hand outsized influence over the World Cup to outside interests. The backlash has been fierce because the World Cup is not just another property. It is football's crown jewel, its most universal stage, the singular event that still manages to make the planet feel briefly connected. To suggest that it can be leveraged like a private equity product is to invite outrage not only from purists, but from anyone who believes sport should retain some moral distinction from ordinary commerce.

The deeper problem is not simply the proposal itself, but the pattern around it. Infantino has increasingly become a symbol of a football hierarchy that seems more comfortable talking about growth, revenue and control than about trust, integrity and stewardship. That is why this moment feels bigger than one controversial plan. It reflects a broader fear that football's governing class has drifted too far from the people who give the game its meaning. Supporters may accept commercial reality, but they do not want to feel like tenants in a sport they emotionally own.

There is also something especially corrosive about the language of "development" being used to justify such moves. FIFA often speaks in the name of smaller nations, grassroots expansion and global opportunity. Yes, the world saw Cabo Verde on the global stage a couple of months ago and boy, did they make the world notice them, just look at the superstar that their goalkeeper Vozinha has become.

Yet when power is centralised and financial engineering becomes the dominant instinct, the result looks less like uplift and more like extraction. It is hard to square the rhetoric of inclusion with structures that appear to concentrate power at the top while asking everyone else to applaud the efficiency.

That is why the phrase "selling the soul of football" does not sound melodramatic here. It sounds precise. Football survives because people believe it belongs to everyone: the child juggling a ball in a narrow lane, the worker watching a match after a long shift, the fan waking before dawn to follow a club thousands of miles away. Once that emotional compact is treated as secondary to dealmaking, the game loses something that no broadcast contract can restore.

And football is not dealing with this in isolation. Sport more broadly is under strain from corruption, opaque governance and the blurring of lines between competition and commerce. The modern sporting landscape is full of conflicts that erode trust: administrators who act like power brokers, institutions that seem too close to politics, and commercial structures that sometimes appear to matter more than the sport itself. Corruption does not always arrive as an outright scandal. Sometimes it arrives as a culture, a habit of doing things in ways that may be legal but are still deeply damaging to faith in the game.

The rise of sports betting adds another layer of concern. In America, gambling has moved from the

Sport has always been one of the purest ways human beings test themselves, and football has long been the most tribal of all its languages. But when power, money and vanity begin to crowd out meaning, the game starts to feel less like a shared ritual and more like a cartel.



FOOTBALL SURVIVES BECAUSE PEOPLE BELIEVE IT BELONGS TO EVERYONE: THE CHILD JUGGLING A BALL IN A NARROW LANE, THE WORKER WATCHING A MATCH AFTER A LONG SHIFT, THE FAN WAKING BEFORE DAWN TO FOLLOW A CLUB THOUSANDS OF MILES AWAY. ONCE THAT EMOTIONAL COMPACT IS TREATED AS SECONDARY TO DEALMAKING, THE GAME LOSES SOMETHING THAT NO BROADCAST CONTRACT CAN RESTORE

The writer is Director and the Printer & Publisher of *The Pioneer*

margins into the mainstream, and with that shift has come a new kind of sport consumption, one where every pass, foul and substitution is immediately reducible to odds, spreads and profit. Betting is no longer a side market. It is becoming part of the spectacle itself. That may be profitable, but it also changes the relationship between fan and game. The supporter stops being just a supporter and starts becoming a participant in a machine built around extraction.

This is where Kylian Mbappé's recent remarks land with real force. He has been outspoken in refusing to lend his image to sports betting and junk food promotions, arguing in effect that athletes should not casually help normalise products that can harm vulnerable people. That is not a minor marketing quibble. It is a moral position. In an era where elite sport is increasingly saturated with gambling tie-ins, food sponsorships and commercial clutter, Mbappé's stance feels unusually clear-eyed. It reminds us that the face of a game need not become the billboard for everything around it.

His criticism also matters because footballers today are more than players. They are cultural symbols, especially for younger audiences who absorb their choices as much as their performances. When a figure like Mbappé rejects certain endorsements, he is making a statement that the athlete's responsibility does not end at the boundary or touchline. He is suggesting that sport should not surrender all its authority to whatever pays the most.

And yet, despite all this, there is a reason to end on hope rather than despair. The backlash to Infantino has not been isolated or timid. It has brought together journalists, fan communities, football associations and institutional voices that might otherwise disagree on nearly everything else. In that sense, the scandal has done one useful thing: it has reminded people what they are defending. Not a logo, not a revenue stream, not a chairman's ambition, but the idea that sport should remain credible, shared and fair.

That shared resistance matters. It shows that the public still notices when the line is crossed. It shows that football has not been completely absorbed by the logic of money. And it suggests that a global sports cleanup is not only desirable, but possible. Better governance, stricter transparency, clearer sponsorship boundaries and a renewed respect for athletes and supporters would not solve every problem. But they would begin to restore the basic trust without which sport becomes just another business.

In the end, maybe that is the real silver lining. This controversy has united people who usually stand apart. It has forced sports bodies and fans to confront the same uncomfortable truth: if sport is allowed to become entirely commercial, it ceases to be sacred in the first place. The fight now is not against progress or modernity. It is for the preservation of the one thing that makes sport worth loving – its ability to belong to everyone.

Understanding the law beyond the controversy



ASHOK KUMAR

to explain what the law actually says, what powers have been conferred upon the police, what safeguards exist against misuse, and why, in exceptional circumstances, the use of force becomes both lawful and necessary. India is a constitutional democracy where every citizen enjoys the fundamental right to peacefully assemble and express dissent.

Peaceful protest is an essential feature of democratic governance. However, this right is neither absolute nor unconditional. Once a gathering turns violent or threatens public order, its legal character changes entirely. Earlier, an unlawful assembly was defined under Section 141 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC). The same concept is now covered under Section 189 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023. An unlawful assembly consists of five or more persons sharing a common unlawful object, such as resisting lawful authority, obstructing the implementation of law, committing an offence, damaging property, forcibly taking possession of property, or compelling someone to do an act not required by law. A gathering that begins peacefully can subsequently become unlawful if it resorts to violence, attacks public servants, indulges in arson, damages public property, or endangers public safety. At that stage, the law places a clear responsibility upon the police to restore order. The Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita also prescribes punishment under Sections 189, 190 and 191 for members of unlawful assemblies.

The next logical question is: what are the police expected to do when such an assembly refuses to disperse? The answer lies in the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023, particularly Sections 148 to 151, which have replaced Sections 129 to 131 of the erstwhile Code of Criminal Procedure. The law provides a graded mechanism. A police officer not below the rank of Sub-Inspector may order an unlawful assembly, or even an assembly likely to disturb public peace, to disperse. If the crowd refuses to comply, the police may disperse it by using civil force, including arrest, wherever necessary. Most importantly, the law requires that only the minimum force necessary be used. Modern democratic policing follows the principle of graded response. Crowd control ordinarily begins with persuasion, public announcements and repeated warnings. If these measures fail, the police may employ water cannons, tear smoke and other non-lethal methods. If violence escalates further, a controlled lathi-charge may become necessary. Only when these measures prove inadequate and the mob continues to pose a serious threat to life or property may specialised anti-riot equipment, such as rubber projectiles, plastic pellets or pump-action anti-riot guns, be considered.

Their objective is not to inflict fatal injuries but to disperse violent crowds while minimising the risk of loss of life. Their use nevertheless requires trained personnel, strict supervision and adherence to established standard operating procedures. Only where civil force proves insufficient does the law permit requisitioning assistance from the armed forces, and even then, such deployment is regulated and ordinarily takes place under the direction of the Executive Magistrate or a police officer vested with the powers of an Executive Magistrate under the commissionerate system.

Pellet-based anti-riot systems have been part of India's crowd-control mechanism for over two decades. They gained prominence during prolonged stone-pelting incidents in Jammu and Kashmir. Their operational purpose has always been to disperse violent mobs before circumstances compel the use of live ammunition. In practical policing, they are regarded as an intermediate option between conventional crowd-control measures and lethal force. Every use-of-force decision involves difficult choices. Officers often have only seconds to decide whether to permit a violent mob to torch buses, attack public institutions, assault police personnel or destroy public property, or to intervene using lawful force. During my policing career, I witnessed several incidents where violent mobs resorted to arson, vandalised government property, attacked police personnel and endangered innocent citizens. In such situations, failure to act would itself amount to dereliction of duty. The State has a constitutional obligation to protect the life, liberty and property of every citizen, including those who are not part of the protest. Another legal safeguard that is often overlooked is that the prosecution of police officers for actions taken in the discharge of their official duties requires prior sanction from the Government under Section 151 of the BNSS. This safeguard does not provide immunity for unlawful acts; rather, it protects officers from frivolous or motivated prosecution arising from bona fide operational decisions taken under difficult circumstances.

Equally important is the human dimension of policing. Every police officer deployed during riots is also a citizen and a public servant performing a constitutional duty. Violence against police personnel cannot be justified merely because it occurs during a protest. Assaulting police officers, damaging police vehicles or attempting to overrun security barricades is ultimately an attack on the authority of the State and the rule of law.

None of this should be interpreted as a licence for indiscriminate use of force. Democratic policing demands restraint, professionalism and accountability. Every allegation of excessive force deserves an impartial investigation, and any officer found to have exceeded the limits prescribed by law must be held accountable. At the same time, police personnel acting within the authority conferred by law should not be judged solely through the prism of public emotion. The principle, therefore, is straightforward. The police are legally empowered to use force against an unlawful and violent assembly. Such authority includes graduated measures like lathi-charge, tear smoke, water cannons and, where operationally justified, specialised anti-riot weapons, including pellet-based systems. In the rarest situations involving imminent threats to life, even firearms may lawfully be used, subject to strict legal safeguards. In a democracy, however, force must always remain proportionate, necessary and the last resort. The ultimate objective of policing is not to overpower citizens, but to restore peace, protect lives and uphold the rule of law with the least possible use of force.



The writer is a former DGP

Bangladesh: India's strategic dilemma



PARUL CHANDRA

tumultuous events, India-Bangladesh ties have suffered a severe setback, with both sides still struggling to rebuild a once-robust partnership. A lingering trust deficit now clouds relations as the two neighbours attempt to reset ties under Bangladesh's new Prime Minister, Tarique Rahman. Rahman, who assumed leadership of the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) following the death of his mother, former Prime Minister Khaleda Zia, took office in February. His party, seen as anti-India, swept the polls.

While the sharp friction that characterised New Delhi-Dhaka ties under Bangladesh's interim government led by Chief Adviser Muhammad Yunus has eased, relations remain uneasy. Stable on the surface, the partnership continues to be tested by underlying strain.

For now, India is banking on the upcoming BRICS Summit in New Delhi this September to host Bangladeshi Prime Minister Tarique Rahman and initiate a much-needed reset in bilateral ties.

Although Bangladesh is not a BRICS member, it aspires to join the grouping, and Rahman has been invited to the summit's Outreach Session. New Delhi hopes his participation will pave the way for a crucial meeting on the sidelines with Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Adding to New Delhi's chagrin, Rahman prioritised a visit to China, India's primary geostrategic adversary. Rahman's trip to Beijing was a clear strategic setback for Delhi.

During his four-day visit in June, Rahman was assiduously courted by Beijing as the two sides signed 17 pacts. The visit elevated bilateral ties from a "comprehensive strategic cooperative partnership" to a "China-Bangladesh community with a shared future". Additionally, Dhaka and Beijing agreed to institute regular strategic discussions and launch a 2+2 dialogue covering foreign policy and security.

Worryingly for India, Beijing has pledged support for Bangladesh's Teesta River restoration project. To prevent Chinese inroads along this strategic river basin, New Delhi needs to finally deliver the long-stalled Teesta water-sharing treaty-a task made far simpler now that a BJP government leads West Bengal.

Equally troubling for India is the agreement between Dhaka and Beijing to expand Mongla Port, alongside the decision to grant a Chinese firm the right to develop its adjacent economic zone. India was originally slated to develop this zone, but the project did not materialise and ultimately fell through. As a result, India will have to grapple with a growing Chinese footprint in the Bay of Bengal, which poses significant security risks in its imme-



diate maritime neighbourhood.

The Rahman government's embrace of Beijing poses a clear challenge to New Delhi's strategic interests. China's expanding footprint in India's immediate neighbourhood, the Indian Ocean Region, and the broader Indo-Pacific directly threatens Indian security. While the new government in Dhaka has framed its foreign policy around "Bangladesh First" and multi-alignment, it remains to be seen whether it will truly adhere to these principles.

New Delhi's substantial leverage over Dhaka vanished with Sheikh Hasina's departure. Although Hasina cultivated strong relations with Beijing, she was always sensitive to India's regional security concerns-a principle New Delhi will undoubtedly highlight if the Modi-Rahman meeting takes place. The BNP government may not be as sensitive to India's concerns. A meeting at the prime ministerial level, therefore, is a necessity for India to be able to voice its concerns at the highest level.

For Rahman, a visit to New Delhi poses significant domestic risk as he has to navigate deep-seated anti-India sentiments at home.

Rahman, therefore, is treading carefully. He would also be looking for substantive outcomes from his India visit to quell any criticism he may face on the domestic front. A major sticking point in bilateral ties at present is Sheikh Hasina's continued presence in India. The Awami League leader has been tried in absentia in Bangladesh by a special tribunal and sentenced to death for alleged crimes against humanity. Dhaka has put in a formal request with New Delhi seeking her extradition.

The former Prime Minister's political rhetoric while in exile here has also angered Dhaka. If India wants to safeguard its long-term interests and foster cordial relations with Bangladesh, it must firmly advise Hasina to refrain from engaging in political rhetoric from Indian soil.

Another major strain on bilateral relations has been the BJP's sustained campaign against illegal immigration from Bangladesh, marked by harsh political rhetoric-including Home Minister Amit Shah's controversial characterisation of illegal migrants as "termites" in 2018. This anti-immigrant rhetoric reached a fever pitch during recent state assembly elections in West Bengal and Assam, casting a long shadow over neighbourly ties. Moving forward, both nations must prioritise more effective border management and establish a robust, formal mechanism to address the contentious issue of cross-border migration.

If India wishes to establish strong ties with

Bangladesh, it will have to make extraordinary diplomatic efforts to keep Bangladesh within its sphere of influence. For instance, the 1996 Ganges Water Sharing Treaty is up for renewal before it expires in December. Dhaka has already signalled that cordial relations will depend on extending the pact. With China eagerly waiting to occupy any strategic space that India might cede in the neighbourhood, India also needs to walk the talk and strengthen its economic, trade and investment linkages with Bangladesh. The new government in Bangladesh is grappling with numerous economic challenges-from inflation and acute energy shortages to rising youth unemployment and sluggish FDI. India should capitalise on this moment by offering meaningful economic support.

Addressing Bangladesh's long-standing concern over the sizeable trade deficit is equally critical. To that end, both nations should prioritise and expedite negotiations for the proposed Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA). While Beijing may currently appear to hold the advantage in the contest for influence, India has the advantage of geographical proximity. This geographical edge will continue to work in New Delhi's favour-provided its diplomatic approach is driven by mutual benefit rather than an overbearing posture. This would also allow the BNP government to address its domestic constituency's anti-India sentiments while reaping the benefits of robust ties with India.

The writer is a political analyst specialising in strategic affairs



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 Order Order

Delhi court refuses bail to child trafficking accused



A Delhi court has denied bail to a man accused of being part of an inter-State child trafficking racket, saying that trafficking of infants is a “heinous scourge” that assaults the moral conscience of civilised society.

Additional Sessions Judge Hargurvarinder Singh Jaggi was hearing the bail application filed by Raj Kumar, who was accused in a case registered in connection with the alleged trafficking of a newborn girl born to an unmarried rape survivor.

In an order dated August 3, the court said, “Child trafficking is a heinous scourge and an onslaught on the moral conscience of civilised society. This court must record its deepest concern regarding the menace of child trafficking and the commodification of infants.

“Children are the most vulnerable and precious members of our collective society, and their lives, liberty and dignity cannot be subjected to a commercial market.”

According to the prosecution, the case surfaced after information was received from the Special Police Unit for Women and Children regarding the illegal adoption and trafficking of a baby girl born to an 18-year-old rape survivor at Safdarjung Hospital in November 2023.

A hospital housekeeping assistant allegedly persuaded the victim’s family to give away the child in exchange for money, following which ₹50,000 was transferred to the victim’s uncle through UPI-

(PTI)

Contempt case: Kejriwal, AAP leaders gets 4 weeks to respond



The Delhi High Court on Tuesday gave four weeks to AAP leaders Arvind Kejriwal, Manish Sisodia, Sanjay Singh and others to respond to a criminal contempt case initiated against them for their “vilifying” social media posts against Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma.

The senior counsel for Kejriwal told a bench of Justices Navin Chawla and Ravinder Dudeja that he was yet to receive the material that formed the basis of the contempt case. A similar submission was also made by the lawyers appearing for other parties.

The bench asked the registry to supply the material to the respondents and said, “Reply by respondents be filed in four weeks.” The court also gave four weeks to AAP leader Gopal Rai and journalist Saurav Das to file their replies in a petition seeking contempt action against them for allegedly being part of an “orchestrated social media campaign” against Justice Swarana Sharma.

The court listed the matter for hearing on September 21. On May 19, the court had issued notice to Kejriwal and other politicians on the suo motu contempt case initiated against them by Justice Sharma and had granted them four weeks to file their response. It had then appointed senior advocate Rajdipa Behura as amicus curiae. Justice Sharma had on May 14 initiated criminal contempt proceedings against Kejriwal, Sisodia, Singh and other AAP leaders, including Durgesh Pathak, Saurabh Bharadwaj and Vinay Mishra, over their “vilifying” social media posts against her in relation to the excise policy case.

(PTI)

NGT directs action against mining firm for illegal road in Haryana’s Aravalli forest area

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The National Green Tribunal (NGT) has directed authorities in Haryana to take action against a private mining company for illegally carving out a road through the protected Aravalli forest area.

The green body was hearing a plea alleging that the project proponent M/s Maa Santoshi Khanij Udhog was granted Environmental Clearance (EC) in 2020 for carrying out mining operations at village Musnota, Tehsil Narnaul, District Mahendragarh of the state, but in violation of rules, it had made an illegal temporary road to access its mines.

According to the plea, heavy vehicles transporting minerals were using the said



road, damaging the Aravalli plantation area and violating environmental norms.

A bench of NGT Chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava and expert member Afroz Ahmad noted that the tribunal had, earlier, formed a joint committee, which had submitted reports, saying that the temporary road was located in



SC hearing sought on CBSE’s 3-language rule for class 9

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court was on Tuesday urged to list for urgent hearing the pleas challenging the CBSE’s policy mandating the study of three languages, including two native Indian languages, for Class 9 students.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, appearing for one of the petitioners, requested a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana that the pleas be heard either on Wednesday or Thursday as students are left in the lurch and the academic session has already started.

The counsel contended there are neither enough teachers nor books to implement the CBSE policy. “We will see,” the CJ said.

The apex court had earlier sought responses from the Centre, NCERT and the CBSE on two fresh pleas challenging the education board’s policy. It had listed the pleas for hearing on July 29.

The Centre, CBSE and the NCERT, in their separate affidavits, had strongly defended the implementation of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020’s three-



language framework, saying it is essential for promoting “multilingualism and national integration”.

They had sought the dismissal of pleas filed against the three-language policy adopted in CBSE-affiliated schools across the country.

In an earlier hearing, a senior lawyer had alleged that the CBSE was implementing unlawful circulars which are against the RTE (Right to Education) Act.

“They are imposing languages without alternatives,” he had said.

Prior to this, the top court had asked Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati to submit a report on the logistical preparedness of the CBSE to implement the decision.

Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi, appearing for petitioner Yashica Bhandari Jain and others, submitted that a nationwide circular has been issued by the CBSE, which states that the students have to study three languages from the next academic year.

According to a circular issued by the CBSE, the study of three languages, including at least two native Indian languages, has been made compulsory for Class 9 students beginning July 1.

The move is part of the CBSE’s alignment of its scheme of studies with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and the National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE) 2023. “In order to adequately address the competencies

envisaged at the Secondary Stage, these textbooks will be supplemented with one appropriate local or state literary material, selected by schools, such as short stories, poems, or nonfiction works,” the board had said.

It added that detailed guidelines regarding the selection and pedagogical use of supplementary literary material would be issued by June 15.

According to the circular issued on May 15, students opting for a foreign language may do so only as the third language after studying two native Indian languages, or as an additional fourth language.

“With effect from July 1, 2026, for Class IX, the study of three languages (R1, R2, R3) shall be compulsory, with at least two languages being native Indian languages,” the circular said.

The board said till the dedicated R3 textbooks are available, Class 9 students shall use the Class 6 R3 textbooks (2026-27 edition) of the chosen language.

The CBSE said to keep the focus on learning and reduce any undue pressure on students, no board examination shall be conducted for R3 at the Class 10 level.

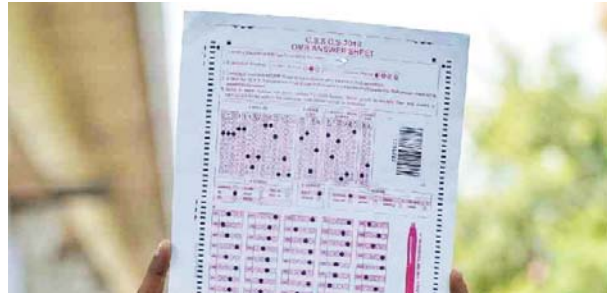
Six NEET-UG candidates move SC over alleged discrepancies in OMR sheets

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Six NEET-UG candidates approached the Supreme Court on Tuesday alleging discrepancies between the answers they had marked in their OMR sheets during the examination and the copies of those sheets made available by the National Testing Agency (NTA).

The plea was mentioned before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, seeking an early hearing before the commencement of the counselling process.

The lawyer told a bench comprising Chief Justice Kant and justices Joymalya



Bagchi and V Mohana that the case pertains to six students who secured more than 600 and 650 marks but claim that the OMR sheets uploaded by the NTA differ from the answers they had actually marked during the examination.

He also told the court that the students had

emailed the NTA and also visited its office, but received no response.

The bench then agreed to list the matter for hearing.

The NEET-UG 2026 exam, originally held on May 3, was cancelled following a paper leak and was re-conducted on June 21 by the NTA.

SC asks JioStar to approach Delhi HC in TRAI tariff framework dispute

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday asked JioStar India Pvt Ltd to approach the Delhi High Court with its plea that it did not want to amend its pending petitions there challenging parts of the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India’s regulatory framework on television channel pricing.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana asked senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi to move the high court with its plea and disposed of the transfer petition filed by JioStar India Pvt Ltd.

The broadcaster had moved the top court through law firm Karanjawala and Co.

The bench was hearing two pleas concerning the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India’s (TRAI) regulatory regime, including tariff orders, maximum retail price (MRP) caps and discount structures governing cable and DTH distribution.

Rohatgi, appearing for JioStar, argued that the TRAI’s regulations and tariff orders were “intrinsically linked and interconnected” even though they stem from different sources of power.

Drawing a distinction between the two, he said that regulations constitute delegated legislation and, therefore, can only be challenged before a high court.

However, the tariff orders are administrative in nature and fall within the jurisdiction



of the Telecom Disputes Settlement and Appellate Tribunal (TDSAT).

“A tariff order and a regulation were issued simultaneously. One was in the exercise of legislative power and the other in the exercise of administrative power,” he said.

He cited the definition of “subscriber” under the frame-

work and said that the regulations treated a luxury hotel with hundreds of television sets at par with a single-bedroom residential household for pricing purposes.

“We say that if a hotel is charging ₹50,000 per room, there has to be a distinction between commercial exploitation of a signal and a

residential household. You cannot have the same tariff. It is like comparing apples with oranges,” he said.

JioStar had filed petitions before the Delhi High Court in 2014 and 2015 challenging both the regulations and the tariff orders.

Those petitions remained pending because similar issues arising from proceedings before TDSAT were already under consideration before the Supreme Court.

He said the high court had unnecessarily directed amendment of the petitions while imposing costs, despite the broadcaster maintaining that no amendment was required. Rohatgi repeatedly asked, “Why costs?” and said the order indicated that the court had already formed an

opinion that the petitions would otherwise be rejected.

The bench asked the broadcaster to approach the Delhi High Court with a plea.

“It would be better if you go back. In light of paragraphs 4 and 5 of the interim order, move an application before the high court stating that you do not wish to amend your petition,” the CJ said.

The senior lawyer said the broadcaster would withdraw the transfer petition and move an appropriate application before the high court.

“I do not require any amendment. I do not want to amend.. I will withdraw this petition and move an appropriate application before the learned Judge. I do not propose to abandon my case,” he said.

Cheque bounce case: SC says complaint not maintainable if company not made party

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Observing that a company is a ‘juristic person’, the Supreme Court has quashed criminal proceedings against a woman in a cheque bounce case, saying that a complaint is not maintainable against a director or authorised signatory if the company itself is not made a party (an accused) in the case.

A bench of justices Manoj Misra and Vijay Bishnoi set aside an order passed by the Himachal Pradesh High Court, which asked the trial court to implead the company.

The top court took note of the submission made by advocate Ashwani Kumar Dubey, appearing for the accused, that when a company commits an



offence punishable under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments (NI) Act, the complaint against the director is not maintainable without impleading the company as an accused.

Dubey contended that the HC committed a manifest error in declining the prayer to quash the complaint and all consequential proceedings. “We are of the view that the high court

clearly exceeded its jurisdiction by directing the magistrate/ trial court to suo motu arraign the company as an accused.

“In consequence, and having regard to the finding that the complaint suffered from a fatal defect, we have no hesitation in holding that the complaint and all consequential proceedings arising therefrom are liable to be quashed and are hereby quashed,” the bench said.

The top court said a company is a ‘juristic person’ and can maintain an account with the bank.

“Thus, if the cheque concerned is drawn on the account maintained by the company, subject to fulfilment of other ingredients of Section 138 of the NI Act, it would be the company which would commit the offence,” the bench said.

The top court said the complaint suffered from a fatal defect in its failure to implead the company as an accused on whose account the cheque was drawn.

“In such circumstances, no cognisance on that complaint could have been taken in view of the decision in Aneeta Hada (supra). Hence, all further proceedings on the complaint were bad in law,” it said.

In this case, a complaint was filed under Section 138 of the NI Act against the accused alleging that the company owed ₹ 5 lakh to him in lieu of services rendered. The accused, being one of the directors and authorised signatories of the company, issued a ₹5 lakh cheque to the complainant, which was returned unpaid with the remark ‘payment stopped by drawer’.

SC told Asaram doesn’t require hospitalisation



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court was on Tuesday informed that experts from AIIMS have suggested that self-styled godman Asaram does not require hospitalisation for treatment but needs round-the-clock medical assistance.

A bench of justices M M Sundresh and PB Varale was apprised of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) report while hearing Asaram’s plea seeking an interim bail on health grounds.

“The report (of AIIMS) says there is no need for any hospitalisation,” one of the lawyers appearing for the Rajasthan Government said, adding, “He (Asaram) is getting all the medical facilities”.

The lawyer representing Asaram said the report has to be read as a whole.

The bench posted the matter for hearing on August 6. On July 21, the apex court had asked AIIMS to constitute a medical board to assess Asaram’s condition.

The Rajasthan High Court on May 27 upheld the conviction and life sentence awarded to Asaram in a case of rape of a minor in 2013.

On June 30, the apex court sought response from the Rajasthan Government on Asaram’s plea challenging the high court order.

The high court had upheld Asaram’s conviction in the case, but acquitted him of charges related to alleged gangrape and penetrative sexual assault on a child under the erstwhile Indian Penal Code and the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act.

INTERVIEW



“The lack of knowledge is not an issue, but the speed at which knowledge becomes obsolete.” In conversation with *The Pioneer*, Dr Ashok Kumar Mittal, Member of Parliament (Rajya Sabha) and Founder Chancellor of LPU, breaks down the urgent reforms needed to prepare Indian universities for a rapidly changing world.



REIMAGINING HIGHER EDUCATION

What role should universities like LPU play in building the human capital and innovation ecosystem needed for India to become a developed nation by 2047?

Universities should act as agents of nation-building by creating human capital that is competent, innovative, adaptable and ethical. LPU believes in building careers, not just awarding degrees, while fostering the holistic development of every learner. For the past 25 years, this philosophy has driven the University to stay ahead of technological, industrial and societal change. Guided by this vision, LPU introduced Edu-Revolution, a learning model that extends education beyond the classroom through industry immersion, research, innovation, entrepreneurship and multidisciplinary problem-solving. Such an environment encourages independent thinking, innovation and calculated risk-taking. A developed India will require universities to produce not only employable graduates, but also innovators, entrepreneurs and responsible leaders.

The National Education Policy (NEP) has introduced major reforms. In your view, what have been its biggest successes so far, and what more is needed to achieve its goals?

The NEP has transformed the debate from that of accessibility to that of quality, flexibility, and employability. The stress on multidisciplinary education, flexible academics via the Academic Bank of Credits, increased institutional autonomy, digital learning, and closer ties between industries will go a long way in making our higher education system more future-ready.

The next phase, however, must focus on effective implementation. This requires sustained investment in research, faculty development, digital infrastructure, international collaborations, and deeper academia-industry partnerships. Equally important is that the culture of innovation and entrepreneurship within the universities is strengthened, so that institutions grow beyond centres of learning to sources of nation-building, economic growth and societal progress.

How should higher education institutions redesign curricula and learning models to prepare students for an AI-driven economy?

Universities will have to rethink the very design of learning in the age of Artificial Intelligence. Curricula can no longer be fixed or discipline-specific, but must be continuously co-created with industry and evolve with technological advancement. LPU has incorporated AI across varied programmes, from engineering and management to law, agriculture and design, while niche programmes nurture talent for the upcoming domains. Practical skills and conceptual clarity are developed through live projects, hackathons, industry assignments and project

based evaluation instead of traditional examinations, thereby reinforcing learning. This model prepares graduates not just to navigate an AI-powered economy but to drive innovation within it.

How is LPU bridging the gap between academic learning and workplace readiness, and what changes are needed across higher education?

The lack of knowledge is not an issue, but the speed at which knowledge becomes obsolete. At LPU, we have tackled this by making industry a part of the education. Working on the philosophy of precision rather than perfection, we empower our students to develop their own curricula with industry experts as per current industry needs, so our students are learning the skills, technologies, and practices that employers really need. Going forward, higher education must move beyond periodic curriculum revisions to building a culture of continuous co-creation between academia and industry. Universities should become agile learning ecosystems where innovation, adaptability, multidisciplinary thinking, and lifelong learning are embedded into every student's educational journey.

How can Indian universities attract more international students and research collaborations?

Indian universities must move beyond paper-based international partnerships and build global academic ecosystems where internationalisation is embedded in teaching, entrepreneurship, industry engagement and campus life. They should attract international students, faculty and researchers to collaborate and co-create. LPU reflects this vision through partnerships with 550+ universities worldwide and a campus that welcomes exchange students from countries including Spain, Brazil, Malaysia, the Philippines, the United Kingdom and Russia. International students work alongside Indian peers on interdisciplinary projects, while Indian students and faculty benefit from international mobility, collaborative research, faculty exchanges and joint innovation. This two-way model of global engagement will help position India as a preferred destination for higher education and research.

Entrepreneurship has become a key driver of economic growth. How can universities cultivate a culture where students aspire to become job creators rather than job seekers?

Universities can't create entrepreneurs simply by offering them a

single course on how to be one. What we do is create an ecosystem around student life where innovation, experimenting, and problem-solving become part of everyday learning. LPU has done this by providing opportunities for students to get involved with industry projects, startups, research, hackathons, and innovation challenges during their time on campus along with their academic programmes. To date, we've been able to engage over 15,000 students in experiential learning initiatives which have resulted in over 400+ startups launched, with our students generating over ₹20 crores in total from their entrepreneurial endeavours including through freelancing, internships and industry collaborations. When students experience that their ideas can create both value and livelihoods while they are still studying, they naturally begin to see themselves as job creators rather than job seekers.

As both an educationist and a Member of Parliament, how do you envision stronger collaboration between government, academia, and industry to accelerate India's knowledge economy?

Here we are mentioning three major pillars that need to work in unison. The government must create an enabling policy environment, invest in research, and encourage innovation. Universities need to promote critical thinking, multidisciplinary learning, and research excellence, while industry needs to

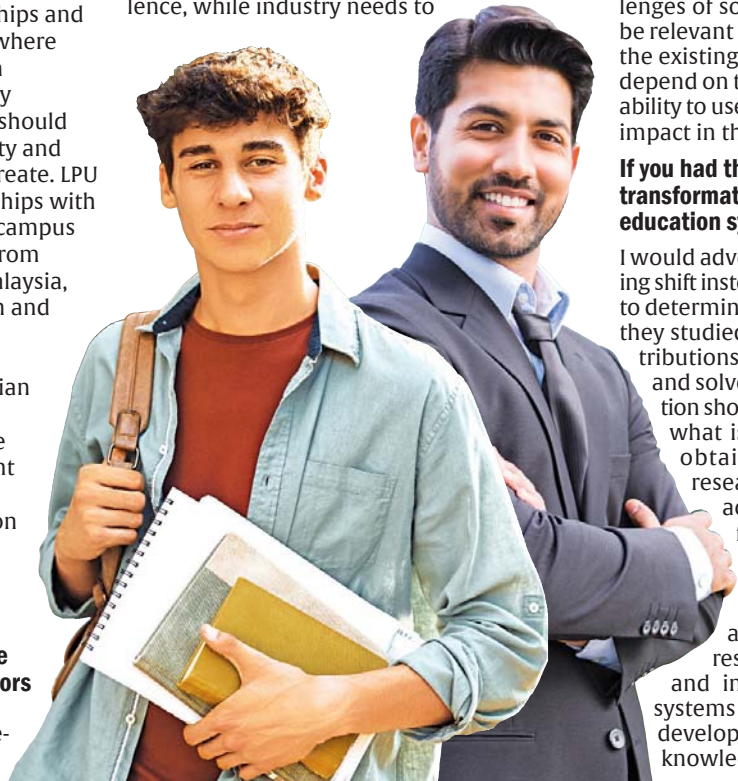
play an active role in curriculum design, skills development, technology transfer, and collaborative research. This kind of model will ensure that education is relevant, research addresses real-world problems, and innovation creates economic and social value. This collaboration will not only improve India's global competitiveness but also accelerate our journey to become a developed nation by 2047.

Indian students today face rapid technological change, intense competition, and evolving career paths. What advice would you give to young people preparing to lead the next phase of India's growth story?

My advice to youngsters is that the future will be for those who tackle problems with the ability to learn and adapt. You should be flexible enough to meet this requirement in the future. Develop the foresight and skills to make the jobs of the future available to the public. When young minds are equipped with the right skills, values, and opportunities, they are capable of competing on the global stage. The fact that LPU graduates have secured international placement packages of up to ₹2.5 crore reflects the limitless potential of Indian youth when provided with the right ecosystem. Keep up with technological advances; however, keep your integrity and morals in check. Stay in tune with the real problems of the country and develop the ability to address the challenges of society to design solutions that will be relevant and will make a change to address the existing problems. The future of India will depend on the youth who have the innovative ability to use their personal success to make an impact in their country.

If you had the opportunity to recommend one transformative reform for India's higher education system, what would it be, and why?

I would advocate for an outcome-based learning shift instead of an input-based shift. We tend to determine students' success based on what they studied. It should be based on their contributions and what they are able to create and solve. What is learned in higher education shouldn't be limited to marks obtained, what is learned after taking exams and obtaining degrees. Innovation and research, as well as entrepreneurial activities and engagements with different industries and positive impacts on society, should be regarded as learning. If this is done, instead of producing graduates, universities will produce responsible leaders, problem solvers, and innovators. Our higher education systems must be aimed at making India a developed and leading global nation for knowledge.



Preparing students for a rupee-led global economy

PROF. MEERA ARANHA AND PROF. SRINIVASA REDDY

Meera Aranha, Adjunct Faculty, and Srinivas Reddy, Associate Professor, Chairperson - Placements and Corporate Engagement, TAPMI, Manipal Academy of Higher Education

When Prime Minister Narendra Modi travelled to Jakarta to sign the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, one notable outcome was a system allowing Indian and Indonesian traders to settle bilateral trade directly in rupees and rupiah. Around the same time, India and Japan advanced discussions toward direct yen-rupee settlements. In a world shaped by geopolitical fragmentation, the global use of the rupee has moved from a long-term aspiration to an immediate policy opportunity.

The case for reducing dependence on the dollar is no longer theoretical. Sanctions on Russia have shown how access to reserves, payment systems, and international finance can be shaped by geopolitics. For most countries, the aim is not to

abandon the dollar but to avoid excessive dependence on any single currency. Can the rupee become a credible currency in a multipolar world?

Over the past three years, the Reserve Bank of India has built the infrastructure for rupee-denominated trade. Since 2022, over 150 Special Rupee Vostro Accounts (SRVA) have been opened in 30 countries, facilitating local-currency trade with partners including the UAE, Indonesia, the Maldives, and Japan. India has also executed its first rupee payment for crude oil imports from the UAE. Although rupee-settled imports grew by 45%, they accounted for less than 2% of total imports. Shifting toward rupee settlement creates an offshore rupee ecosystem, lowers

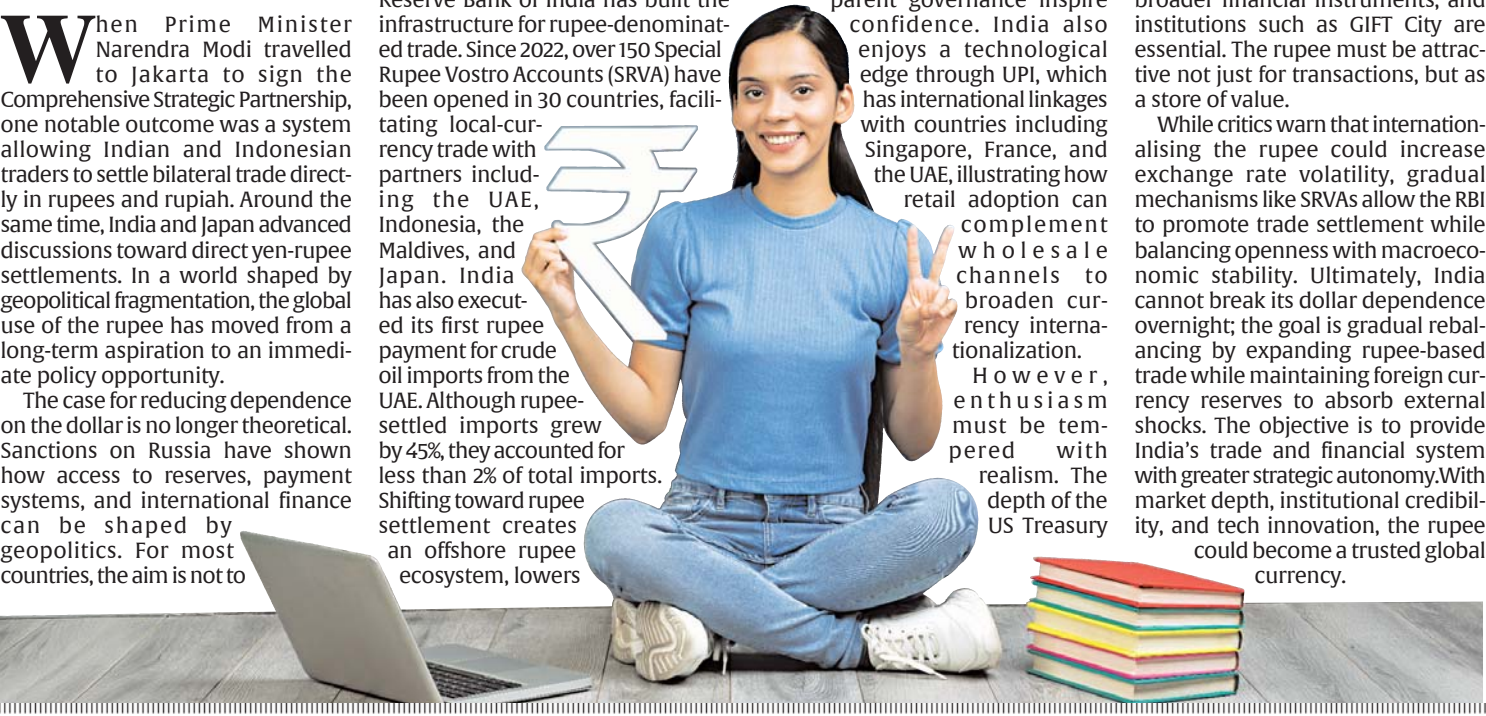
transaction costs, and reduces exposure to external currency shocks.

India's opportunity lies in becoming a credible alternative to the dollar. Its democratic institutions, independent central bank, and transparent governance inspire confidence. India also enjoys a technological edge through UPI, which has international linkages with countries including Singapore, France, and the UAE, illustrating how retail adoption can complement wholesale channels to broaden currency internationalization.

However, enthusiasm must be tempered with realism. The depth of the US Treasury

market, liquidity, and established invoicing conventions create powerful network effects for the dollar. Countries will hold rupees only if they have attractive avenues to deploy these balances. Deeper bond markets, broader financial instruments, and institutions such as GIFT City are essential. The rupee must be attractive not just for transactions, but as a store of value.

While critics warn that internationalising the rupee could increase exchange rate volatility, gradual mechanisms like SRVAs allow the RBI to promote trade settlement while balancing openness with macroeconomic stability. Ultimately, India cannot break its dollar dependence overnight; the goal is gradual rebalancing by expanding rupee-based trade while maintaining foreign currency reserves to absorb external shocks. The objective is to provide India's trade and financial system with greater strategic autonomy. With market depth, institutional credibility, and tech innovation, the rupee could become a trusted global currency.



Are we preparing students for jobs or just preparation?

SUSHMA BHARATH

Education Strategist

A policy report from halfway across the world caught my eye. Released in the UK, titled 'Young people and work', it paints a sobering picture of a growing population of young people classified as NEET - Not in Education, Employment or Training.

My immediate instinct was to contrast this with what I see around me every day in India. We don't have a crisis of voluntary inactivity; we have a culture of intense, almost breathless competition.

One sentence, in particular, made me pause: "For young people especially, the first steps into work are often



the first steps into adult life."

Historically, a first job wasn't just a financial transaction. They were how young people quietly built confidence, learned to handle responsibility, developed resilience, and dis-

covered their independence. Work wasn't just an economic destination; it was a classroom for learning how to function in the world.

The tragedy highlighted by the report is that these crucial first rungs of the ladder have quietly splintered away. The modern labour market increasingly expects readiness before it is willing to teach it. This is precisely where higher education steps into the frame - and where our current strategy is failing.

For years, universities have obsessed over making students more "employable." Yet, when employers talk about Gen Z entering the workplace today, they don't just point to missing technical skills; they talk about young people arriving with profoundly low confidence and an unprecedented need for emotional support.

Britain may have a workforce participation problem, but India has a profound preparation problem. Our youth are caught in an endless loop of more coaching, more certifications, more postgraduate degrees, and a competitive exam system that builds multiple gap years and repeat attempts directly into its design.

Today, it feels as though we have become exceptionally skilled at helping students compete for jobs, while completely ignoring the human development required to do the job actually. The real question is whether we have given them the psychological maturity to know when they are finally ready to step beyond it.

How design education has evolved after NEP 2020

DR. JITIN CHADHA

Pro Chancellor, UDIT (University of Design, Innovation and Technology)

The National Education Policy 2020 gave India an important opportunity to reimagine the role of education. It encouraged multidisciplinary learning, flexibility, creativity, critical thinking and skill-based development. For design education, this was not merely a policy shift; it was a philosophical alignment. Design, after all, has always been much more than aesthetics. It is the ability to observe, interpret, imagine and create solutions for human needs. NEP 2020 recognised that the future of education cannot remain restricted to narrow academic silos.

In earlier days, design education in India was often viewed as a specialised creative stream, chosen by a limited number of students inclined towards art or visual expression. Today, that perception is changing rapidly. Design is emerging as a strategic discipline. Whether we speak of digital products, urban systems, healthcare experiences, climate-responsive solutions, retail environments, social innovation or artificial intelligence interfaces, design is central to how ideas become meaningful and usable. This evolution is especially important as we approach 2027. The world of work is being transformed by automation, artificial intelligence, digital platforms and new consumer behaviours. However, what machines cannot easily replace is human empathy, imagination, ethical judgement and contextual understanding. These are precisely the capacities that good design education nurtures.

The workplace of 2027 will not only require employees who can operate tools. It will need professionals who can ask the right questions, connect diverse ideas, collaborate across disciplines and create solutions that are relevant to real human lives. This is where design education will define the future of work. NEP 2020 has accelerated this shift by encouraging institutions to build curricula that combine theory with practice, creativity with technology and learning with real-world application. The emphasis on multiple entry and exit options, credit flexibility and interdisciplinary learning allows students to shape their academic journeys with greater independence. These are central to preparing students for a world where problems do not arrive neatly divided into subjects.

Design education has always been about producing creative problem-solvers for a changing economy. The designer of the future will work in a studio, a start-up, a policy lab, a technology company, a manufacturing unit, a social enterprise or an innovation team within a large organisation.

Another significant change has been the growing importance of experiential learning. Design cannot be learned through lectures. It must be practised, tested, critiqued and refined. NEP 2020's focus on holistic and



DESIGN EDUCATION OCCUPIES SUCH A CRITICAL PLACE IN INDIA'S FUTURE. IT BRINGS TOGETHER THE INTELLECTUAL, THE PRACTICAL AND THE EMOTIONAL

practical education encourages institutions to move beyond rote learning and assessment by memory, towards "learning by doing". The classroom must become a laboratory of exploration, not merely a space for instruction. The pandemic years also pushed design education to rethink its methods. While design remains a deeply hands-on discipline, the integration of digital learning has expanded access and opened new forms of collaboration. The future will not be purely online or offline. It will be blended, adaptive and connected.

At the same time, design education must respond to India's own realities. We are a young nation with immense creative energy, diverse craft traditions, fast-growing digital adoption and complex developmental challenges. Our design institutions must prepare students not only for global careers, but also for Indian contexts. By 2027, organisations will increasingly value individuals who can combine creativity with responsibility.

Design education is critical to India's future, teaching students to observe, think independently, and create responsibly. The journey after NEP 2020 has shown us that education must prepare learners not just for the first job, but for a lifetime of change. Design education does exactly that. As India moves towards becoming a global knowledge and innovation economy, design will be one of its most powerful enablers. In that future, design education will not remain at the margins. It will stand at the centre of how we learn, work and build the world of tomorrow.

Cargo ship hit off Oman as US-Iran clash over talks

ELENA BECATOROS/
SAMY MAGDY  Cairo

A British maritime monitoring agency said a cargo ship reported being hit by a projectile overnight off the coast of Oman in the Strait of Hormuz, while the United States and Iran made opposing claims about whether they were holding talks.

US President Donald Trump said the two sides are resuming talks to wind down the war. But Iran insisted it only was talking with Oman and the discussion focused on the Strait of Hormuz.

The cargo ship reported being "hit by an unknown projectile" at 2 am local time while it was 37 kilometres (23 miles) northeast of Al Khasab



in Oman, the United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations Centre said.

The UKMTO did not provide further information on the ship, including what flag the vessel was sailing under or whether it was carrying cargo. The ship suffered damage,

according to British maritime security firm Ambrey, which did not elaborate.

The town of Al Khasab sits on the tip of the Arabian Peninsula that juts into the Strait of Hormuz, the crucial waterway at the mouth of the Persian Gulf through

which a fifth of the world's oil and natural gas passed before the war.

The strait has been effectively shut by Iran's attacks on shipping since the start of the war in February, while the US also has imposed a blockade on Iranian ports in the waterway. A military spokesman for the Iranian-backed rebels, Brig Gen Yahya Saree, claimed the drone hit a "sensitive target" at the airport in the southwestern city of Najran. He did not provide evidence.

He said the drone attack was in response to what he called Saudi breaching of Yemen's airspace over the provinces of Saada and Hajjah.

There was no immediate comment from Saudi Arabia.

PAKISTAN INVITES IRANIAN FM ARAGHCHI

Lahore: Pakistan has stepped up its diplomatic engagement with Iran, with Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar inviting his Iranian counterpart Abbas Araghchi to Islamabad "at the earliest" for discussions. The invitation, according to top officials familiar with the outreach, signals Islamabad's determination to remain a key diplomatic bridge between Tehran and Washington.

It came two days after US President Donald Trump called off planned military strikes against Iran following appeals from key regional allies. However, Iran's response to the invitation is not immediately known. "Deputy Prime Minister/Foreign Minister Senator Mohammad Ishaq Dar @MishaqDar50 spoke today with the Foreign Minister of Iran, Seyyed Abbas Araghchi. (PTI)

The Houthis recently announced they were imposing a blockade on Saudi-linked shipping passing through the Bab el-Mandeb Strait that leads to the Red

Sea. The rebels have long been at odds with Saudi Arabia, having fought a war against the kingdom and its allies. Major fighting ended with a truce in 2022. (AP)



Shiite worshippers gathering between the holy shrines of Imam Abbas and Imam Hussein during Arbaeen, which marks the end of the 40-day mourning period following Ashoura in Karbala, Iraq

Millions join Arbaeen pilgrimage in Iraq

QASSIM ABDUL-ZAHRA
 Baghdad

Millions of Shiite Muslims observed the annual Arbaeen pilgrimage on Tuesday in the Iraqi holy city of Karbala, under the shadow of ongoing regional tensions and fears of another round of escalation in the US-Iran war.

Arbaeen is held 40 days after Ashoura, which commemorates the killing of Imam Hussein, grandson of the Prophet Muhammad, and members of his family, at the Battle of Karbala in 680 AD. Karbala Gov Nasseif Jassim al-Khattabi said on Tuesday that more than 22 million people entered the city during the pilgrimage, including about 5 million non-Iraqi visitors as well as Iraqis from different regions of the country.

The event is considered one of the world's largest annual religious gatherings.

Among the highest-profile foreign visitors was Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi, who arrived in the Iraqi city of Najaf on Monday and continued on to Karbala to take part in the pilgrimage. Araghchi's presence was a reminder of the delicate balancing act that Iraq — which has close ties to both Washington and Tehran - has carried out since the beginning of the war. Iraq has found itself in the crosshairs of both sides and has sought to avoid getting pulled further into the conflict.

As usual, Iranian pilgrims arrived in large numbers, but some observers said the number of pilgrims from other countries had shrunk. Aqeel al-Rubaie, 45, a pilgrim from Baghdad who was on his way to Karbala, said Iranian flags were particularly visible along the Najaf-Karbala road. (AP)

Russian, Ukrainian drone strikes kill at least 5

ASSOCIATED PRESS
 Moscow

Ukrainian drone attacks in the region around Moscow killed five people, local officials said Tuesday, while authorities in Ukraine said Russian aerial strikes there also caused at least five civilian deaths.

Since Russia's invasion more than four years ago, Ukraine has developed long-range drones that can hit targets deep inside Russia. In the past year, they have battered oil facilities, major storage depots and other key infrastructure.

Russia's relentless aerial attacks on Ukraine have killed more than 16,000 civilians, with casualties rising steadily each year, according to the United Nations. Meanwhile, escalating attacks by both sides on shipping in the Black Sea has



reawakened fears that global food security could be put at risk. Russia says a Ukrainian drone killed 7 on Black Sea coast

The death toll from a drone strike on Monday in the Russian Black Sea resort of Arkhipo-Osipovka rose to seven, including three children, regional authorities said. On Tuesday morning, Krasnodar regional authorities updated the number of wounded to 58, with 21 of them hospitalised. Footage circu-

lating online showed a drone slamming into a crowded beach, with what sounded like rapid gunfire ringing in the background. Ukraine has not commented on the strike. A Ukrainian drone attack in the Moscow region, which surrounds but doesn't include the Russian capital, killed five people and wounded 10 others wounded on Tuesday morning, the region's governor Andrei Vorobyov said.

Most damage from the attack occurred in the Chekhov municipal district, where several fires erupted at the Novoselki industrial zone, Vorobyov said.

In the latest in a string of attacks attack on Russia's biggest online retailer, Wildberries said Tuesday that its warehouse in the Leningrad region, which lies adjacent to St Petersburg, was on fire.

6 killed in Sri Lanka as heavy rain triggers landslides, floods

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  Colombo

At least six persons were killed and three others injured as heavy rain, landslides and flash floods battered parts of Sri Lanka over the past two days, officials said on Tuesday.

The adverse weather has affected five districts, with incessant downpours triggering landslides, flooding and strong winds, disrupting normal life and forcing nearly 1,900 people into relief centres.

Police said three women, aged 83, 58 and 47, and a 22-year-old man were killed when a mound of earth collapsed onto a house in the Polpitiya-Morahanagama area. In a separate incident, a 53-



year-old man died after falling into the Mahaweli River while crossing a bridge on the Watawala-Gnanandagama road. Police also said a 67-year-old man was killed after a mound of earth collapsed onto a road-side shop in Solangkanda Janaudana village in Nawalapitiya.

EU leaders slam Spain's migration policy after Ceuta

SAM MCNEIL/JOSEPH
WILSON/ COLLEEN BARRY
 Brussels

Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez's migration policies have come under withering criticism as leaders from across the European Union meet Tuesday following last week's rush of migrants to the Spanish territory of Ceuta in North Africa.

The sudden arrival of 50,000 to 60,000 migrants on Thursday and Friday



sparked a humanitarian crisis in Ceuta and reignited the immigration debate in the 27-nation bloc, though most of the migrants soon went back. More than 80 migrants died, including

some who drowned or were trampled in a stampede to cross a breakwater barrier, according to Spanish and Moroccan authorities.

Open letters from 22 EU leaders, and a quick retort from Sanchez, have exposed a roiling debate inside the EU pitting migration hawks against the progressive Spanish leader who has challenged consensus within the bloc on migration as well as NATO spending, Gaza and Israel. (AP)

14 people killed in collision between truck and taxi van, says Uganda police

ASSOCIATED PRESS
 Kampala

A collision between a passenger van operating as a commuter taxi and a truck carrying sand killed at least 14 people in Uganda, police said.

The crash happened Monday night on a highway in Kamunga Trading Centre, an area in Kalungu district. All of those killed were passengers in the van, while four others were injured, police said in a statement. Authorities in the East African nation said they were searching for the truck driver, who fled the scene.



Road accidents are a problem across Africa and common in Uganda. The accidents often are blamed on poorly maintained vehicles, excess speed and poor road conditions. An elemen-

tary school bus returning from an educational trip to a scenic waterfall in July veered off a road and overturned, killing at least 20 children and one adult in eastern Uganda.

Death toll hits 1,707 as Ebola cases rise in eastern Congo

ASSOCIATED PRESS  Bunia

Ebola has killed more than 1,700 people in eastern Congo in the fastest-growing outbreak of the disease, data showed. As of Tuesday, 3,802 cases had been recorded, with 1,707 deaths, according to the latest government update.

It is not clear when the outbreak will reach its peak, Africa CDC Director-General Dr Jean Kaseya said during his second visit to the town of Bunia near the outbreak's epicentre on Tuesday. Kaseya cautioned that nearly 80 per cent of new cases are not coming from contact tracing but instead from community spread. The outbreak, declared on May 15, has been linked to the Bundibugyo virus for which there are no approved vaccines or treatments. Delays in contact tracing, difficulties accessing affected areas, mistrust from communities, and violence by armed groups and some residents have hampered the response, the Africa CDC has said.

The outbreak is mostly concentrated in eastern Congo's remote Ituri province, which accounts for nearly 90 per cent of



cases, but cases have also been confirmed in five other provinces, including in one of the country's largest cities, Kisangani. Neighbouring Uganda declared itself free of Ebola following the discharge of the country's last patient in mid-June. On Monday, healthcare workers in the hard hit town of Mongbwalu issued an ultimatum over unpaid wages saying that "if nothing is done within 24 hours, we will escalate our action."

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Sarvagya Wahi Through SPA Anubhav Wahi, S/o Ashok Kumar Wahi Mutatee of Application No. 158774 under Rohini Residential Scheme, 1981, had submitted FDR No. 03701 dated 27-03-1981 amounting to Rs. 5000/- . It is hereby informed that the aforesaid original FDR has been lost/misplaced. In this regard:- 1. NCR/FIR/Lost Report No. 503869/2026 dated 02/08/2026 has been lodged at Police Station Punjabi Bagh, 2. An Indemnity Bond has also been executed regarding loss of the said FDR. If anybody has any objection/claim regarding the aforesaid FDR or finds the same, he/she may contact the undersigned within 15 days from publication of this notice. Address: House No 39, Road No 54, Punjabi Bagh (W), New Delhi-110026 Mobile No. 8447061582

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Pankaj Jain, son of Late Shri Kanta Prasad Jain, residing at A-203, Sector-47, Noida, District Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, hereby inform the general public that I am the owner of Flat No. T-6/1203-A, Amrapali Crystal Homes, Amrapali Group, G.H.-01/A, Sector-76, Noida, District Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh. The original Builder Buyer Agreement pertaining to the above-mentioned flat has been misplaced/lost. If anyone finds the said original Builder Buyer Agreement, they are requested not to misuse it in any manner against my interest and to inform me immediately. If any person makes any unauthorized or fraudulent use of the said lost document, such person shall be solely responsible for the consequences, and I shall initiate appropriate legal proceedings against them in accordance with the law

**कार्यालय सदरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (विद्युत) विद्युत लण्ड-प्रबन्ध**
उपप्रो राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
ए-1/4, लखनपुर, कानपुर

निविदा सूचना
उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा यूपीसीडी एवं अन्य विभागों में पंजीकृत विद्युत लाईनेंसी एवं अनुमति देकर, फर्मों से निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु मुहर कन्व निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा सम्बन्धी प्रश्न अधोसहसारी के कार्यालय, उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण, ए-1/4, लखनपुर, कानपुर से दिनांक 04.08.2026 से दिनांक 24.08.2026 को 5.00 बजे तक (कार्य दिवसों में) प्राप्त की जा सकती है जो कि दिनांक 25.08.2026 को जवाहरलाल नेहरू कार्यालय में 2.00 बजे कार्य एक जग की जा सकती एवं सभी बिज 03.30 बजे निविदादाताओं के समक्ष अधोसहसारी के कार्यालय में छोड़ी जायेगी। यह निविदा विक्रय एवं खुलने की तिथि को राजकीय अवकाश घोषित होता है तो निविदा विक्रय एवं खुलने की तिथि उससे आगेला कार्य दिवस होता।

क्र.सं	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत (रु. लाख में)	ग्योहर घण्टागि (रु. में)	कार्य पूरा करने की अवधि (दिन)	निविदा का मूल्य
1	Providing facade light with 03 year maintenance at the entrance I.A. Mega Food Park Bahen,	9.95 (with GST)	UPSIDA 10,000.00 OTHERS 20,000.00	1125 Days	1000/- + GST

नोट:- 1. निविदादाता अपनी निविदाओं में समस्त कर सहित दरें अंकित करें। जीएसटीडी अनल से देय होगी। 2. विद्युत कार्य हेतु निविदादाताओं को "विद्युत सुरक्षा विभाग" उपप्रो शासन, लखनऊ में श्रेणी 'क' अनुमोदित लाइसेंस निविदा के साथ संलग्न करना अनिवार्य होगा, अन्यथा निविदा को Consider नहीं किया जायेगा।। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के सदरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (री) श्री कुमवार सिंह के मोबाइल नं० 9717597707 (Email ID- ed1@upsida.co.in) पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है। सदरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (विद्युत) यूपीसीडीआर, विद्युत लण्ड-प्रबन्ध, कानपुर

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that Unit No. MCA R/GF/070 Floor – Ground Floor in Project M3M The Cullinan Avenue situated at Sector-94 was booked by Late Shri Tarun Kumar Sharma S/o Late Shri Shanti Prakash Sharma and Ms. Raj Sharma W/o Late Shri Vinod Sharma R/o 6/242, Geeta Colony, East Delhi, Delhi, India. - 110031 Late Shri Tarun Kumar Sharma (deceased name) passed away on 03.06.2025, leaving behind the following legal heir(s)/Surviving Members:

S. No.	Name	Aadhar No.	Relationship with deceased	Address
1-	Mr. Karan Sharma	2207 8317 9736	Son	Delhi-110031
2-	Ms. Sonam Sharma	6451 1720 6319	Wife	Delhi-110031

Following the demise of the Late Tarun Kumar Sharma (deceased name) the above-mentioned legal heir(s)/Surviving Members has/have requested Lavish Buildmart Pvt Ltd for the transfer of the deceased's rights and interest in the said Unit in favour of Ms. Sonam Sharma. Any person(s) having any claim, objection or right in respect of the said Unit/Flat may submit their objections in writing along with supporting documents to Lavish Buildmart Pvt Ltd at 23rd Floor, Plot No. 1-C, Windsor Grand, Sector-126, Noida, U.P India-201393 and Ms Sonam Sharma (customer name), at the below-mentioned coordinates, within 21 (Twenty one) days from the date of publication of this notice. In the absence of any objections within the stipulated period, Ms Sonam Sharma(customer name)proceed with the transfer of the said Unit no. MCA R/GF/070 in project Lavish Buildmart, Pvt Ltd in his/her/their favour, and no claims shall be entertained thereafter. For any queries, kindly contact: Customer name:- Mr Karan Sharma East Delhi, Delhi, India. - 110031 Email id-inkaran07@outlook.com Phone no.- 8851927321

NORTHERN RAILWAY
INVITATION OF TENDERS
THROUGH E-PROCUREMENT SYSTEM
Tender Notice No. 32/2026-2027 Dated: 04.08.2026
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. Tender N. No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01 19260618	SET OF DRIVE ASSEMBLY COMPONENT	51 SET	29.08.26
02 07260204	CONTROL ARM ASSEMBLY	5015 NOS	08.09.26

NOTE -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details.
2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

2686/26

**Bank of Baroda, Deer Park Branch**
B-7/106A, Safdarjung Enclave, New Delhi – 110029
Email: dbasafd@bankofbaroda.bank.in

PUBLIC NOTICE
This is to inform the general public that BANK OF BARODA, DEER PARK BRANCH, B-7/106A, Safdarjung Enclave, New Delhi – 110029 intends to create an equitable mortgage over the property mentioned below as security for the housing loan proposed to be sanctioned to the proposed purchasers. The property presently stands in the names of Mrs. Neena Bansal W/o Mr. Mohan Bansal, Mrs. Meenu Gupta W/o Mr. Ravi Gupta and Mrs. Manjusha Jain W/o Mr. Sanmaji Jain, who have agreed to sell the property to the proposed purchasers Mr. Piyush Gupta S/o Late Mr. Vishnu Gupta, Mrs. Richa Sharma W/o Mr. Piyush Gupta and Mrs. Madhu Gupta W/o Late Mr. Vishnu Gupta. Any person(s), bank(s), financial institution(s) or authority having any right, title, interest, claim, lien, mortgage, charge or encumbrance whatsoever over the said property is requested to intimate the Bank in writing along with documentary proof within 15 days from the publication of this notice. If no objection/claim is received within the stipulated period, it shall be presumed that the property is free from all encumbrances and the Bank shall proceed with creation of mortgage and disbursement of the loan. **Property Details:** Property No. A-52, Entire Upper Ground Floor, Block-A, Preet Vihar, Delhi – 110092, admeasuring 887 sq. ft. (82.436 sq. m.) together with all rights and appurtenances. Boundaries: North: Road (30' Wide), South: Service Lane, East: Property No. 53, West: Property No. 51 **Branch Details:** Bank of Baroda, Deer Park Branch, B-7/106A, Safdarjung Enclave, New Delhi – 110029 Email: dbasafd@bankofbaroda.bank.in

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1	PWD B&R,KAITHAL	SHRINGHI RISHI TIRATH IN VILLAGE SANGHAN IN KAITHAL DISTT.	CLOSING DATE 10.08.2026	52.96 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896320998 pwd-eeop-kaithal@hry.nic.in
2	HORLICULTURE,DEPARTMENT GHARAUNDA (KARNAL)	SHORT TERM E-TENDER OF REPAIRING OF PROTECTED STRUCTURE AT CEV, GHARAUNDA	05.08.2026 13.08.2026	EMD 1 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9729303303 ddh.cev@gmail.com
3	FOREST DEPARTMENT, CHARKHI DADRI	FIVE TENDER REGARDING FORESTRY WORKS NEW PLANTATION & OTHER WORKS IN FORESTRY DIVISION CHARKHI DADRI	30.07.2026 06.08.2026	746.92 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8901296600 dfodadri@yahoo.com
4	CIVIL SURGEON, AMBALA	SHORT E-TENDER NOTICE FOR APPOINTMENT OF CONCURRENT AUDITOR FOR DISTRICT HEATH AND FAMILY WELFARE SOCIETY AMBALA FOR FY 2025-26	05.08.2026 13.08.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0171-2557473 dhs.csamb@hry.nic.in
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in						RO 47834-I-27-7

**PUNE MUNICIPAL CORPORATION**
(PMC) PUNE 411 005.
Web: - <http://mahatenders.gov.in>
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER BHAVAN DEPARTMENT
CORRIGENDUM



A corrigendum is being issued for the following tenders of the bhavan departments of Pune Municipal Corporation. All the details regarding the tender terms, conditions etc. regarding the said work are available for viewing free of cost on www.mahatenders.gov.in as mentioned in the tender document.

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Changes to the tender Of Date
1	PMC/BHAVAN/19/2026-27	E-tender sale period - From 25/07/2026 (after 2:30 PM) to 18/08/2026 (up to 2:30 PM).
		Tender acceptance period (final date & time) From 25/07/2026 (after 2:30 PM) to 18/08/2026 (up to 2:30 PM).
		Date of opening technical bid envelope From 19/08/2026 (after 3:00 PM).
2	PMC/BHAVAN/20/2026-27	Instead of this, it should be read as follows:
3	PMC/BHAVAN/21/2026-27	E-tender sale period - From 25/07/2026 (after 2:30 PM) to 08/08/2026 (up to 2:30 PM).
		Tender acceptance period (final date & time) From 25/07/2026 (after 2:30 PM) to 08/08/2026 (up to 2:30 PM).
		Date of opening technical bid envelope From 10/08/2026 (after 3:00 PM).
4	PMC/BHAVAN/22/2026-27	

All other content will remain as previously published.

Advt. No. 3/502
Date:- 04.08.2026

SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER BHAVAN DEPARTMENT Pune Municipal Corporation Pune 411005

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Bandhan Bank Q1: Business grows 11% in FY26-27

Bandhan Bank reported a strong performance for the first quarter of FY26-27, with its total business growing 11% year-on-year to over ₹3.2 lakh crore. The Bank's total advances increased 16% to ₹1.56 lakh crore, while total deposits rose 7% to ₹1.65 lakh crore. Retail deposits accounted for nearly 74% of total deposits, and the CASA ratio stood at 29.4%. The Bank reported a net profit of ₹502 crore for the quarter and maintained a strong Capital Adequacy Ratio (CAR) of 18.2%.

Bandhan Bank currently serves around 3.2 crore customers through nearly 6,400 banking outlets across 35 of India's 36 States and Union Territories, supported by a workforce of over 74,500 employees. Speaking on the Bank's performance, MD & CEO, Partha Pratim Sengupta said, "Our Q1 FY2026-27 performance reflects the resilience of Bandhan Bank's franchise, the commitment of our teams, and the trust our stakeholders continue to place in us." (PNS)

Navi Mumbai commences international freighter operations

Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA) on Tuesday announced the commencement of its dedicated international freighter operation with the inaugural freighter flight to Sharjah operated by IndiGo CarGo on August 2. The start of the freighter services reaffirms the airport's emergence as a new cargo gateway for the Mumbai Metropolitan Region and Western India, NMIA said. The flight carried 20 tonnes of cargo comprising general cargo and perishable goods.

The shipment also included bonded transfer cargo received from Mumbai and Ahmedabad, which was transported to NMIA through bonded trucking arrangements, it said.

This operation marks an important step in strengthening NMIA's integrated cargo ecosystem, which has been designed to support domestic, international, express and transit cargo movements. With specialised capabilities for handling perishables, pharmaceuticals, valuables, dangerous goods and other cargo segments, the airport is well positioned to deliver efficient logistics solutions for airlines, freight forwarders, exporters and importers, the private airport operator said. (PTI)

NHPC's director Sanjay Kumar Singh honoured with Hydro Vibhushan award

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Sanjay Kumar Singh, Director (Projects), NHPC, has been conferred the "Hydro Vibhushan" Award at the prestigious "18th India Hydro & PSPs Awards 2026" presented during 18th Hydro Vision Conclave held in New Delhi by the Hydropower Forum of India (HyFi) under the aegis of ENERTIA Foundation and REPA (Renewable Energy Promotion Association). The honour has been bestowed for his Yeomen Contribution to the Hydropower Renewable Sector at Large and leadership excellence in project management and leading

the Challenging works. A civil engineer with over 35 years of experience in the power and infrastructure sector, Sanjay Kumar Singh has been serving as Director (Projects), NHPC since 24 July 2024. Under his leadership, NHPC has achieved significant milestones, including the commissioning of the 800 MW Parbati-II Hydroelectric Project, 300 MW Bikaner Solar Power Project and four units of 250 MW each, of the 2,000 MW Subansiri Lower Hydroelectric Project, besides accelerating progress across several strategically important hydro and renewable energy projects.

The Pioneer

NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | AUGUST 5, 2026

LIC OFS draws ₹36,400 cr institutional bids

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Government's 6.5 per cent stake sale in LIC saw massive interest from institutional investors who put in a whopping ₹36,400 crore worth bids—the highest-ever for any offer for sale (OFS). Four years after its initial public offering (IPO), which had fetched ₹21,000 crore for a 3.5 per cent stake, the government is now selling a further 6.5 per cent stake in LIC via an OFS whose size compares with the upcoming mega IPO offerings of the NSE and Reliance Jio Platforms. The OFS comprises a base offer size of 2.5 per cent, with

a greenshoe option of 4 per cent, taking the total size to 6.5 per cent, comprising 82.22 crore shares of the country's largest insurance company. On Tuesday, institutional investors put in bids for over 94.45 crore shares, at an indicative price of ₹383.84/share. The bids are valued at ₹36,400 crore at the indicative bid price. In a regulatory filing, LIC said the government has decided to exercise the over-subscription option to the extent of about 50.60 equity shares (representing 4 per cent of the total paid-up equity share capital of the corporation). LIC further said that 8.22 crore shares, or 10 per cent of

the offer, will be available for retail investors, who can bid on Wednesday. "A discount of ₹10 per

equity share will be given only to those retail investors and employees bidding at cut-off price," it said.

Govt will factor in farmers' concerns on ethanol blending, says Chouhan

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Government will consider farmers' views on the ethanol blending petrol policy, Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said on Tuesday, after meeting a delegation of the All India Kisan Coordination Committee (AIKCC), which demanded that the benefits of the scheme reach farmers rather than companies and middlemen. Chouhan told the delegation that the Government's vision is to ensure gains from the ethanol programme are shared across the value chain - "from farm to the fuel tank" - but that the largest share of the benefit must go to farmers. The AIKCC delegation was led by its national president and former MP Bhupinder Singh Mann, and included Binod Anand, Gurusahab Singh Mann and Gunwant Patil, among others. Stating that ethanol would strengthen both the country's energy security and farmers' financial well-being, Chouhan said the Government was committed to ensuring no crop or State faces injustice under the programme, according to an official statement. He assured the delegation that the

policy would be reviewed to maintain a balance between the prices and demand for maize, rice, sugarcane and other feedstocks. Decisions would be taken keeping farmers' interests - particularly those of maize growers - as the primary consideration, he said. Chouhan added that scientific studies and technical reports on ethanol would be used to counter "negative narratives", and that a fact-based dialogue would be held with farmers on the issue. The farmers' representatives, while extending their support for the ethanol programme, stressed that its actual benefits must reach farmers rather than being confined to companies or

middlemen. Several leaders pointed to misinformation being spread on social media that ethanol harms vehicles or causes losses to farmers. They urged the Ministry of Agriculture and farmer organisations to work together to clarify which crops stand to benefit from ethanol, and how the shift from water-intensive crops to drought-resistant ones could be facilitated. They also called for presenting an accurate picture of ethanol to the younger generation through various media platforms. The farmer leaders said they would help farm produce move beyond mandis to petrol pumps and the energy market, creating a new avenue for farmers. The AIKCC representatives said they would work to dispel misconceptions about ethanol at the ground level and collaborate with the government to strengthen the policy-making process in farmers' interest. While the meeting's focus was on ethanol, the two sides also discussed other issues, including farmers' income, Minimum Support Price (MSP), markets and the national agricultural policy.

Markets snap 4-day rally amid new closing auction session

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Snapping the four-day gaining streak, benchmark stock indices Sensex and Nifty closed lower on Tuesday following the introduction of a new auction mechanism for shares having futures and options (F&O) contracts. Paring early gains, the 30-share BSE Sensex declined by 210.08 points, or 0.27 per cent, to settle at 78,428.95. During the day, the benchmark hit a high of 79,143.15 and a low of 78,211.87, gyrating 931.28 points. The 50-share NSE Nifty closed lower by 159.40 points, or 0.64 per cent, at 24,614.90 after trading in the negative territory throughout the day. During intraday trade, it edged lower by 346.35 points, or

Index	Open/High	Previous Close	Low	Close
NSE NIFTY	24,703.90	24,774.30	24,427.95	24,614.90
BSE SENSEX	79,143.15	78,639.03	78,211.87	78,428.95

1.39 per cent, to hit a low of 24,427.95. Market benchmarks traded on a mixed note in the early session on Tuesday, a day after the introduction of the new auction mechanism. Sensex

and Nifty on Monday ended with an unusual aberration after stock exchanges introduced the new auction mechanism. The NSE recorded a turnover of ₹1,542.2 crore on the second day of the

closing auction session on Tuesday, while the turnover on the BSE stood at ₹9.35 crore. On Monday, the initial trading turnover was ₹1,276.2 crore for the NSE. The Closing Auction Session (CAS) in the equity cash segment became operational on Monday, introducing a new auction-based mechanism for determining the closing prices of eligible stocks in a move aimed at making the price discovery process more transparent and robust. Generally, movement in both the benchmark indices is in sync. "The introduction of the Closing Auction Session (CAS) for F&O stocks has added a new layer of volatility to benchmark indices, with Tuesday's trade reflecting an early adjustment to the revised market structure.

BUSINESS

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In a post on X, Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM) Secretary Arunish Chawla said the LIC OFS was over-subscribed 3.32 times of its base size by institutional investors. "This enthusiastic participation reflects robust investor confidence and the depth of India's capital markets." On Tuesday, shares of LIC slid 7.86 per cent to close at ₹391 on the BSE. Its market capitalisation stands at ₹4.95 lakh crore. The floor price of ₹382/share was set at a 10 per cent discount over Monday's closing price of ₹424.35 on the BSE. At the floor price, the sale

of over 82.22 crore shares, or a 6.5 per cent stake at the given floor price will fetch about ₹31,000 crore to the disinvestment kitty. The stake sale will help LIC achieve the minimum public shareholding requirement mandated by market regulator Sebi ahead of schedule. Sebi had given LIC time till May 16, 2027, to achieve a minimum of 10 per cent public shareholding. At present, the government holds a 96.5 per cent stake in LIC. It had earlier sold 3.5 per cent through an initial public offering (IPO) in May 2022 at a price band of ₹902-949 per share, raising about ₹21,000 crore.

Goyal likely to attend G20 trade meet next month

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal is expected to visit the United States at the end of September this year for the G-20 Trade Ministerial in Milwaukee, Wisconsin, an official said. The two-day ministerial will begin on September 30. The United States holds the 2026 G20 presidency. The official said the Indian trade minister is expected to hold a series of bilateral meetings with his counterparts on the sidelines of the ministerial to discuss ways to boost two-way commerce and investments. In a statement in May, US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer had said

that at the G20 Trade Ministerial this fall, USTR will lead discussions with the ministers on a wide array of issues, including ending forced labour, updating the Most-Favored Nation (MFN) Principle, denouncing weaponisation of trade in food, and addressing structural excess capacity and production. US President Donald Trump will host the culminating Leaders' Summit on December 14-15 at Trump National Doral in Miami, Florida. The G20, or Group of Twenty, is an international forum that brings together the world's major advanced and emerging economies to discuss and coordinate economic policy.

The Pioneer

Classified

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Ratan Lal Choudhary, Father of- No.16022076H L/Hav Mahaveer Choudhary, R/o- Vill- Bibolao, Ganeti, Dist- Tonk, Rajasthan- 304505, have changed my name from Ratan Lal Choudhary to Ratan Lal Jat, vide affidavit dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Ponam Devi, Mother of- No.15184131P HAV(CLK SD) Vishal Kumar, R/o- Vill- Nayagaon, Po- Nayagaon, Dist- Saran, Bihar- 841217, have changed my name from Ponam Devi to Punam Singh, vide affidavit dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Sukhdeo Thakur, Father of No.17025312A CFN Shankar Kumar Thakur, R/o- Vill- Gundro, PO- Barai, Teh & Dist- Hazaribagh, Jharkhand- 825312, have changed my name from Sukhdeo Thakur to Sukhdev Thakur, vide affidavit dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No.15421491P Nk Sateesh Kumar, R/o- Vill & PO- Singha, Teh- Chandpur, Dist- Bijnor, U.P.- 246725, have changed my mother's name in my service record from Om Vati to Omwati, vide affidavit dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Asoke Kr Garai, Father of No.17000434Y Hav Soumendra Nath Garai, R/o- Kantaria PO- Kshiragram, P.S- Katwa, Dist- Purba Bardhaman, West Bengal- 713143, have changed my name from Asoke Kr Garai to Ashok Garai vide affidavit dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Laxmi Ghosh, Wife of No.17000434Y Hav Soumendra Nath Garai, R/o- Kantaria PO- Kshiragram, P.S- Katwa, Dist- Purba Bardhaman, West Bengal- 713143, have changed my name from Laxmi Ghosh to Laxmi Garai vide affidavit dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Kusma, W/o JC- 473300X Sub Harish Chand, R/o- Vill- Nagla Foujdar, Bahaj, Bharatpur, Rajasthan- 321203, have changed my name from Kusma to Kusham, vide dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Manisha Kumari, D/o- JC-472478F Sub Ramesh Kumar, R/o- Back Side Uddam Singh Civil Hospital, PO/Teh/Dist- Charkhi Dadri, Haryana- 127306, have changed my name from Manisha Kumari to Manisha, vide affidavit dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, hitherto known as Vishakha D/o- Umesh Goel, R/o- WZ - 226, Second Floor, Gali No. 7, Lajwanti Garden, Dist- South West Delhi, Delhi-110046, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Vishakha Goel.

I, Pooja Devi, W/o- No.14834825P NK/MT Parmod Kumar, R/o- Vill- Mahatauli, PO- Kenduki, Dist- Saharanpur, U.P.- 247554, have changed my name from Pooja Devi to Pooja, vide affidavit dated 04/08/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Sudesh Rana S/o Dharam Singh, R/o RZQ-555 Nihar Vihar, Nangloi, New Delhi-110041, have changed my name to Sudesh Kumar Rana.

Preventive healthcare: Bridging last mile in medical attention

DESH RAJ SINGH
■ Jaipur

India's healthcare narrative is usually told through numbers on infrastructure: hospitals built, cards issued, beds added. Schemes such as the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY), the network of Ayushman Arogya Mandirs, and the National Programme for Prevention and Control of Non-Communicable Diseases (NP-NCD) have expanded access at a scale few countries have matched. As the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare informed Parliament in July 2026, more than 44.73 crore Ayushman Cards have been issued, enabling over 12.69 crore cashless hospital admissions. Nearly 1.86 lakh Ayushman Arogya Mandirs now serve as points of first contact closer to where people live.

However, a hospital bed or a health card is of limited use if people are unaware of it, or do not access it in time. This is the harder half of the equation, and it is being tested in a village called Maseet, in Tapukara.

Rural India, more broadly, continues to grapple with a

similar set of constraints: a shortage of doctors and specialists in villages, longer distances to a functioning facility, uneven health literacy, and a tendency to seek treatment only once an illness becomes difficult to ignore. The construction of hospitals addresses one part of this problem; the remainder depends on persuading people of the value of preventive care before a health issue becomes acute.

A region outpacing its health habits

Tapukara lies within the Bhiwadi-Khushkhara-Tapukara Industrial Belt, one of North India's largest manufacturing clusters, comprising more than 5,000 industrial units. It falls within Khairthal-Tijara, a district formed only in 2023, where public institutions are still adapting to the pace of economic growth around them. The region is also part of the wider Mewat area, which has long trailed on several health, nutrition, and education indicators.

Employment opportunities have expanded faster than health-seeking habits have changed — a pattern observed across much of rural India, and not unique to this region. Many families here



continue to consult a doctor only after an illness has progressed, rather than before. State-level data illustrates why this matters. According to the National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5), 54.7% of women in Rajasthan aged 15-49 are anaemic, as are 71.5% of children aged 6-59 months. Hypertension and diabetes are also becoming more prevalent.

A complementary intervention

It is this gap that Project Swasth was designed to address. Launched in July 2026 in Maseet village, the initiative is implemented by the Sharda Welfare Foundation (SWF), with support from the Honda India Foundation (HIF) and in partnership with the

Gram Panchayat, Maseet. Dinesh, the village head of Maseet, said, "For years, people here have been travelling to places like Bhiwadi or Jaipur for routine check-ups or further treatment. Families have long been demanding that such a camp be organised within the village itself."

Thanks to the involvement of the Honda India Foundation and the Sharda Welfare Foundation, that demand has now been addressed.

A comparable pattern is often observed in Indian cities, where the arrival of an established hospital group tends to lift the standard of the surrounding health ecosystem. The first community health camp offered an early indication of the scale of

unmet need. The screening results were notable. Blood pressure checks found elevated readings in 21% of participants, while blood sugar screening flagged another 29%.

Community attitudes toward health

Access alone does not fully account for the low uptake of preventive care in villages such as Maseet; behaviour plays a role as well. In many rural settings, symptoms are managed at home for a period before a doctor is consulted, and routine screening for conditions such as hypertension or diabetes — which often present no symptoms until damage has occurred — is not yet part of everyday practice.

Project Swasth works through the Gram Panchayat and door-to-door outreach to build familiarity with the idea of a routine check-up, rather than one prompted only by the appearance of symptoms.

Facilitating access to entitlements

The project also assists families in accessing benefits to which they are often already entitled but do not use. This includes enrolment and e-KYC support under Ayushman Bharat, along with outreach

for the AyushmanVay Vandana Card, which provides free health coverage of up to ₹5 lakh a year to senior citizens aged 70 and above, regardless of income.

A model beyond one village

For the residents of Tapukara, the intent behind the project is a sustained one — not a single health camp followed by withdrawal, but a partner expected to return, follow up, and assist them in navigating a system that can otherwise appear distant and confusing.

Rishabh Gupta, Managing Director of the Sharda Welfare Foundation said, "What we have seen on the ground is that infrastructure has grown much faster than people's habit of using it. That is the gap we are trying to close, not only in Tapukara but wherever we work. Through Project Swasth, we intend to remain engaged with this region over the long term, rather than conducting a few camps and moving on."

GDA vice chairman inspects RDC area



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Ghaziabad

The vice chairman of the Ghaziabad Development Authority (GDA), accompanied by the secretary, GDA, the Special Duty Officer, and the engineering team, conducted a detailed on-site inspection of the Raj Nagar District Centre (RDC) area on Tuesday.

The purpose of the inspection was to assess the growing issues of traffic congestion, unorganised parking, encroachments, sanitation, street lighting, and other civic amenities, and to issue necessary directions for their effective and long-term resolution. During the inspection, the vice chairman closely reviewed the persistent traffic congestion

and unorganised parking situation in the RDC area. He observed that haphazard parking, vehicles stationed along roadsides, and unregulated activities were causing frequent traffic disruptions, resulting in inconvenience to residents, visitors, and the business community.

He directed the concerned officials to comprehensively reorganise the parking system by ensuring scientific and optimal utilisation of available space.

Concluding the inspection, the vice chairman directed the secretary and other concerned officials to prepare a comprehensive action plan covering all identified issues in the RDC area within one week and to initiate effective implementation immediately thereafter.

Girls again take top honours at Bihar Foundation NICE 2026 round-I

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Patna

National, Zonal and State winners announced as girl students from across India shine in the second round of the National Inter-College Crossword Expedition, organised by Extra-C and the Crossword Federation of India (CWF), with support from the Bihar Foundation and the Central Bank of India.

Adya Singh of St Stephen's College emerged as the National Champion, while Tisha Taneja of IIT Madras and Arnav V Raju of IIT Delhi secured the second and third positions respective-



Adya Singh and Tisha Taneja

ly. The competition witnessed an exceptional display of vocabulary,

reasoning and analytical skills by participants from diverse academic institutions, according to a press release.

Girls once again dominated the championship, with Adya Singh of and Tisha Taneja of IIT Delhi claiming the top two slots and female participants securing several Zonal and State honours.

The championship attracted entries from students pursuing engineering, medicine, law, management, humanities and science.

Congratulating the winners, the organisers appreciated the remarkable standard of participation and the enthu-

siastic response received from colleges and universities across the country.

With participation continuing to grow every year, Bihar Foundation NICE has established itself as one of India's premier inter-college intellectual competitions, providing students with a unique national platform.

PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY
e-TENDER CALL NOTICE
No.EM/WS/TECH-13/2026/1109,
Date: 21.07.2026
e-TCN No.EM/WS/16/2026
Name of the work: "Design, Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of One (01) no. of column type Telescopic Gangway at north old Jetty along with Comprehensive Operation & Maintenance for a period of Five Years". Estimated cost: Rs.15,62,60,000/- excluding GST. Last date & time of submission of bid: **dt. 01.09.2026 upto 18:00 hrs.** Refer our website for details <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>.
Sd/- Executive Engineer (M), Workshop Division-I
Paradip Port Authority
PPA/PR/19/2026-2027 dtd. 03.08.2026

INDAG RUBBER LIMITED
(CIN: L74899DL1978PLC009038)
Regd. Office: 11, Community Centre, Saket, New Delhi - 110017.
Ph. No. : 011-26963172/73; E-mail Id: info@indagrubber.com;
Website: www.indagrubber.com
SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALIZATION OF PHYSICAL SECURITIES
Pursuant to SEBI's Circular No. HO/38/13/11/2026-MIRSD-POD/I/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, shareholders are hereby informed that SEBI has opened a special window for transfer and dematerialization ("demat") of physical securities that were sold or purchased prior to April 1, 2019.
The special window, which has been opened from February 5, 2026, shall remain open for a period of one year until February 4, 2027.
This facility shall also be available for transfer requests that were submitted earlier but were rejected, returned, or not processed due to deficiency(ies) in documentation, procedural issues, or any other reason.
Shareholders may further note that securities transferred under this special window shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee only in dematerialized form and shall be subject to a lock-in period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. During the said lock-in period, such securities shall not be transferred, lien-marked or pledged.
Shareholders are requested to lodge such cases with the Registrar to an Issue and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) on or before February 4, 2027, at the following address:
M/s. Skyline Financial Services Pvt. Ltd.
D-153 A, 1st Floor, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-I, New Delhi-110020
Email Id: admin@skylinertta.com

For Indag Rubber Limited
Sd/-
Sonal Garg
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
(ACS 24598)

Date: August 04, 2026
Place: New Delhi

GNIDA meets industry representatives

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Noida

In a bid to resolve pressing civic and operational challenges faced by local industries, senior officials of the Greater Noida Industrial Development Authority (GNIDA) held a high-level coordination meeting with industrial representatives at the Authority's boardroom on Monday.



Chaired by Additional Chief Executive Officer (ACEO) Saumya Srivastava alongside ACEO Sumit Yadav, the

meeting was convened following directives from GNIDA chief executive officer NG Ravi Kumar. They also demanded a single-window portal to streamline the issuance of No-Objection Certificates (NOCs) and other regulatory clearances.

Addressing spatial and community needs, IBA President Amit Upadhyay called for establishing Sector

Ecotech 3 as a model industrial sector and proposed constructing Common Facility Centres (CFCs) across all industrial pockets. Taking immediate note of the demands, ACEO Saumya Srivastava instructed the project, water, sewage, electrical engineering, health, and urban planning departments to resolve the grievances on priority.

Guru Nanak Dev University, Amritsar
Expression of Interest (Eoi) Notice
The Department of G.N.D.U., Amritsar invites Sealed (Eoi) for the following:

Sr. No.	Expression of Interest (Eoi)	Closing Date & time
1.	Allotment for e-lobby (near Administrative Block)	19.08.2026
2.	Allotment for Administrative Block Canteen	19.08.2026

For more details log on to <https://digital.gndu.ac.in>
2426/12/2026-27/13905 Dated CHD - 04/08/2026

सम्राट विक्रमादित्य विश्वविद्यालय, उज्जैन
संस्था स्तर काउंसलिंग (CLC) 2026-27
Diploma/B.Tech./M.Tech./MBA/MCA

क्रमांक/2026/
उपरोक्त पाठ्यक्रमों में रिक सीटों पर प्रवेश हेतु निम्न तालिका समय-सारणी अनुसार (CLC) आयोजित की जावेगी।

दिनांक : 03.08.2026

क्र.	पाठ्यक्रम	समय सारणी	स्थान
01	वी.टेक. ब्रांच सिविल, मेकेनिकल, इलेक्ट्रीकल, इलेक्ट्रानिक्स एण्ड कम्प्यूटर साइंस, इलेक्ट्रानिक्स एण्ड कम्युनिकेशन, एग्रीकल्चर इंजी. कम्प्यूटर साइंस इंजी. (एआई एण्ड एमएल) कम्प्यूटर साइंस एण्ड बिजनेस सिस्टम, डेयरी टेक्नोलॉजी	ऑनलाइन रजिस्ट्रेशन दिनांक 04.08.2026 से 14.08.2026 तक रात्रि 11:45 बजे (तीन चरणों में) रिक रह गई सीटों के लिए व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 07.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति) एवं रिकियां रह जाने पर व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 11.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति), रिकियां रह जाने पर व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 14.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति)	स्कूल ऑफ इंजीनियरिंग एण्ड टेक्नोलॉजी स.वि.वि. उज्जैन
02	बी.टेक. लेट्रल ऐन्ट्री द्वितीय वर्ष ब्रांच सिविल, मेकेनिकल, इलेक्ट्रीकल, इलेक्ट्रानिक्स एण्ड कम्प्यूटर साइंस, इलेक्ट्रानिक्स एण्ड कम्युनिकेशन, एग्रीकल्चर इंजी.	ऑनलाइन रजिस्ट्रेशन दिनांक 07.08.2026 से 14.08.2026 तक दोपहर 12.30 रिक रह गई सीटों के लिए व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 11.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति) एवं रिकियां रह जाने पर व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 14.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति)	स्कूल ऑफ इंजीनियरिंग एण्ड टेक्नोलॉजी स.वि.वि. उज्जैन
03	एम.टेक. प्रथम वर्ष ब्रांच स्ट्रक्चरल, थर्मल इंजी., पॉवर सिस्टम एण्ड आटोमेशन, डिजिटल कम्युनिकेशन आई.ओ.टी. एण्ड सेन्सर सिस्टम, कंस्ट्रक्शन प्लानिंग मैनेजमेंट, एनर्जी टेक्नोलॉजी, आर्टीफिशियल इंटेलिजेंस एण्ड डाटा साइंस, क्लाउड कम्प्यूटिंग, एनवायरमेंटल इंजी.	ऑनलाइन रजिस्ट्रेशन दिनांक 02.08.2026 से 14.08.2026 तक दोपहर 12.30 रिक रह गई सीटों के लिए व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 06.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति) रिक रह गई सीटों के लिए व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 11.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति) एवं रिकियां रह जाने पर व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 14.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति)	स्कूल ऑफ इंजीनियरिंग एण्ड टेक्नोलॉजी स.वि.वि. उज्जैन
04	एम.टेक. ब्रांच (कामकाजी पेशेवर) स्ट्रक्चरल इंजी, थर्मल इंजी., पॉवर सिस्टम एण्ड आटोमेशन	ऑनलाइन रजिस्ट्रेशन दिनांक 01.08.2026 से 14.08.2026 तक दोपहर 12.30 रिक रह गई सीटों के लिए व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 08.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति) रिक रह गई सीटों के लिए व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 14.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति)	स्कूल ऑफ इंजीनियरिंग एण्ड टेक्नोलॉजी स.वि.वि. उज्जैन
05	डिप्लोमा इंजीनियरिंग प्रथम वर्ष ब्रांच सिविल, मेकेनिकल, इलेक्ट्रीकल, इलेक्ट्रानिक्स एण्ड कम्युनिकेशन, कम्प्यूटर साइंस इंजी.	ऑनलाइन रजिस्ट्रेशन दिनांक 04.07.2026 से 14.08.2026 तक दोपहर 12.30 रिक रह गई सीटों के लिए व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 06.07.2026 से 12.08.2026 तक प्रत्येक सोमवार, बुधवार, एवं शूक्रवार को (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति) एवं रिकियां रह जाने पर व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 14.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से शाम 06:30 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति)	स्कूल ऑफ इंजीनियरिंग एण्ड टेक्नोलॉजी स.वि.वि. उज्जैन
06	एम.बी.ए. प्रथम वर्ष (MBA)	ऑनलाइन रजिस्ट्रेशन दिनांक 08.08.2026 से 14.08.2026 तक दोपहर 12:30 बजे (दो चरणों में) रिक रह गई सीटों के लिये व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 12.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से दोपहर 01:00 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति) एवं रिकियां रहने पर व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग 14.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से दोपहर 01:00 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति)	पं. जवाहरलाल नेहरू इंस्टीट्यूट ऑफ बिजनेस मैनेजमेंट स.वि.वि. उज्जैन (सर्किट हाउस के ठीक सामने देवास रोड, उज्जैन)
07	एम.सी.ए. प्रथम वर्ष (MCA)	ऑनलाइन रजिस्ट्रेशन दिनांक 02.08.2026 से 14.08.2026 तक दोपहर 12:30 बजे (तीन चरणों में) रिक रह गई सीटों के लिये व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग दिनांक 06.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से दोपहर 01:00 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति) एवं रिकियां रहने पर व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग 11.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से दोपहर 01:00 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति) एवं रिकियां रहने पर व्यक्तिगत रिपोर्टिंग 14.08.2026 (प्रातः 10:30 से दोपहर 01:00 बजे तक अभ्यर्थी उपस्थिति)	इंस्टीट्यूट ऑफ कम्प्यूटर साइंस स.वि. वि. उज्जैन (सर्किट हाउस के ठीक सामने देवास रोड, उज्जैन)

काउंसलिंग वेबसाइट www.dtemponline.gov.in पर संस्था/ब्रांचवार रिक सीटों की जानकारी उपलब्ध रहेगी। उपरोक्त पाठ्यक्रमों में प्रवेश के इच्छुक छात्र-छात्रा ऑनलाइन पंजीयन करवाकर संबंधित संस्थान में उपस्थित रहें। विद्यार्थी उपरोक्त दिनांक पर समस्त मूल दस्तावेजों 10वीं, 12वीं एवं स्नातक कक्षाओं की समस्त अंकसूचियों, आय/जाति/मूलनिवासी/EWS/TFW पात्रता दस्तावेजों के साथ ऑनलाइन पंजीयन पावती, स्थानांतरण प्रमाण पत्र (टी.सी.), माईग्रेशन एवं दस्तावेजों की 02 छाया प्रतियों के सेट एवं 03 पासपोर्ट साईज फोटो, साथ ही निर्धारित शुल्क लेकर संस्था में उपस्थित रहें। प्रवेश प्रक्रिया डी.टी.ई. के नियमानुसार होगी। की.टेक./एम.टेक. में प्रवेश हेतु 9993741159, 9770797977, 9827836188, 8839593759, 8770122362, 98932951344, 8319453662, 7222926136 एम.सी.ए. में प्रवेश हेतु 7804835484, 9340585815 एम.बी.ए. में प्रवेश हेतु 9425458648, 9893073609, 7879062375, 9425012255, 9425035344 जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु अभ्यर्थी संपर्क कर सकते हैं। डीटीई निर्देशानुसार ग्रेड प्राप्त अभ्यर्थी अपने संबंधित बोर्ड/विश्वविद्यालय का ग्रेड प्रतिष्ठित कनवर्शन दस्तावेज भी आवश्यक रूप से अटलाइड/प्रस्तुत करें।

म.प्र. माध्यम/127322/2026

कुलसचिव

DAILY SUDOKU

25

3872

712

91

7

79

6

74

175

94

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

HOW TO SOLVE IT
Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9×9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3×3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.

SOLUTION (4.8.26)

6	9	2	1	7	5	8	4	3
3	4	8	6	2	9	7	1	5
5	7	1	4	8	3	2	9	6
7	2	3	9	1	8	6	5	4
9	5	4	3	6	2	1	8	7
1	8	6	5	4	7	3	2	9
2	6	5	8	3	4	9	7	1
4	1	7	2	9	6	5	3	8
8	3	9	7	5	1	4	6	2

DOUBLE CROSSWORD
WEDNESDAY | AUGUST 5, 2026

12

9

10

13

17

20

24

27

30

ACROSS

1 Pick up something exclusive (5)

6 Little bit of ground for the dog? (5)

9 People unlikely to have given a guinea to the Victoria and Albert! (7)

10 Put in a record sum of money, maybe (5)

11 Like a rugby goal, it can be dropped (5)

12 Chekhov's uncle (5)

13 Not just treatment (3,4)

15 Refugee's unpleasant air (3)

17 Actually more than a little brook (4)

18 Swimmer holding a movie character in irrational devotion (6)

19 Resting place of a little boy, about four

DOWN

2 A discussion on the first of February in a bureau (6)

3 Try too hard to make rings round some clever Dick (6)

4 Standard apparently reduced (3)

5 That's right - a bit of a wide boy (5)

6 A prison drama to keep the kids from going astray? (4,3)

7 Land, as the part of Iago (4)

8 Accustomed to change at first, it may survive in the desert (6)

12 In force, but only just? (5)

13 Do a stretch up the river? (5)

14 Grown in error (5)

20 Right

21 Rattle-trap

22 A-music!clets

23 Lie detector

25 Extra cover

26 Taking down

28 Material

6 Possession

7 Past-or

8 Comp-Lete

10 Filing

35 Chime

39 Mark

BRIEFLY

Vidhatri ready to battle in 11th leg of Hero WPGT



Led by Vidhatri Urs, the winner of the previous leg of the Hero Women's Pro Golf Tour, each and every winner this season will be present at Clover Greens for the event's 11th Leg in Hosur, starting on Wednesday.

The field includes 53 players, including eight amateurs, as the field sizes have consistently gone past 50 in recent weeks. The addition of top amateurs each week has added to the spice as the amateurs have shown that they are ready to take on the best pros in the country on the domestic front.

Vidhatri's win in the 10th Leg, which came after a long gap, also showed that she is back in the frame and ready to take centre stage once again.

Vani Kapoor, Tvesa Malik, Ridhima Dilawari and Amandeep Drall, all seasoned pros, will vie for the honours against some of the new stars like Jasmine Shekar, Mannat Brar, Vidhatri, Anvitha Narender and Heena Kang. One former Hero Order of Merit winner, Sneha Singh, who has been inconsistent of late, will also be hoping to find the rhythm that made her one of the strongest players on the domestic scene.

The same is the case with Neha Tripathi, who was once a formidable force on the Tour, but has the ability to beat the best. Two young amateurs to watch out for could be Ananthi Vivek and Ceerat Kang, whose sister, Heena, is also in the field. Another pair of sisters in the field are Lavanya and Riya Jadon.

Garaga-Roy enter 2nd round men's doubles at Korea masters



Unseeded Indian pair of Krishna Prasad Garaga and Pruthvi Krishnamurthy Roy stunned sixth seeded Thai pair of Chaloeompon Charoenkitamorn and Worrapol Thongsa-Nga in straight games to enter men's doubles second round at the Korea Masters Super 300 badminton tournament here on Tuesday.

The Indian duo took just 42 minutes to get the better of their fancied rivals 21-16 21-18. They will next play the winner of the match between Singapore's Junsuke Kubo and Jia Hao Howin Wong and Korea's Young Hyuk Kim and Tae Yang Shin.

But the other Indian men's doubles combination of Achutaditya Rao Doddavarapu and Arjun Reddy Pochana crashed out in the opening round, losing 3-21 10-21 against second pair of Sol Gyu Choi of Korea and Malaysia's V Shem Goh. It was also curtains for Priya Konjengbam and Shruti Minshra from women's doubles as they were shown the door by second seeds Ririna Hiramoto and Kokona Ishikawa of Japan 15-21 13-21.

Another Indian, Tushar Suveer beat Shaurya Gullaiya of Canada in the opening round of men's singles qualifiers 21-15 21-12 before losing to Shogo Ogawa of Japan 10-21 17-21 in the next round.

MMA exponent Yaqoob gets grand reception after beating world champion Georgiev



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Srinagar

Rising mixed martial arts exponent Owais Yaqoob, who defeated Bulgarian Delyan Georgiev last week, returned to his native village in Pulwama district of Jammu and Kashmir to a rousing welcome on Tuesday. Yaqoob said he will celebrate his victory without losing focus as he is up for another test in Istanbul later this month.

"I have returned home to my people, and I am feeling a very good energy. My focus never wavered. I always celebrate my victories, but we always celebrate in a way that ensures our focus never shifts. Our focus remains on the fact that we are still hungry

and we need to do more," Yaqoob said at his residence in Murrnan village.

He thanked the countrymen for supporting him all through.

"First of all, thank you to all of India. The whole of India celebrated with us today, and everyone supported us and showed up. More than 1.6 million people watched the fight live from India for the first time, and the fight was going on at night, yet everyone was watching. This is a huge achievement for me," he said. The 28-year-old, who has trained with Russian MMA fighters, said while winning the fight is great the bigger achievement is that the people are supporting and loving him.

CWG: Boxing, para stars return to grand welcome

HIMANK NEGI/SANSKRITI GAUBA
■ New Delhi

India's Common wealth Games medallists barely had time to celebrate their success before shifting their focus to next month's Asian Games as they returned to a rousing welcome in the national capital in the early hours of Tuesday.

Even as the athletes walked out of the airport to a rousing welcome, they spoke in one voice about the road ahead, saying there was little time to bask in their Glasgow success with the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya fast approaching.

"Hearing the national anthem on such a big stage is a feeling I will always cherish. But my focus has already shifted to the Asian Games, where I want to win another gold," boxer Priya Ghanghas told PTI moments after walking out of the arrivals gate of the IGI Airport.

Priya was not alone in turning her attention to the Asian Games after Indian boxers capped a memorable Commonwealth Games campaign with a 10-medal haul.

The women's team led the charge with six medals, while the men contributed four, as Indian boxing once again underlined its growing stature on the international stage. The para athletics contingent, too, scripted history with a

record seven-medal haul as India climbed to fourth in the overall medal standings.

As the athletes emerged from the terminal around 4 a.m., dhol beats and patriotic tunes filled the air. Family members welcomed the medallists with flower garlands as supporters queued up for photographs.

"It feels like I'm living a dream," said Sakshi Chaudhary, who became the first boxer to defeat England's Ruby White in an international competition.

"Every night I visualised winning gold, hearing the national anthem and returning home to such a welcome. It feels like that dream has come true. The next target is the Asian Games, and I want to maintain this level there as well."

For Jaismine Lamboria, the gold medal was the reward for overcoming an illness that had severely disrupted her preparations.

"I trained for only three weeks before the Games after recovering from illness. Once I stepped into the ring, I forgot everything else and focused only on giving my best for India," she said.

Jaismine added that the upcoming Asian Games and every tournament thereafter would be stepping stones towards her ultimate goal of winning an Olympic medal in



Gold medalist Arundhati Choudhary, right, being welcomed on her arrival after the Glasgow Commonwealth Games, at IGI Airport in New Delhi on Tuesday

Los Angeles in 2028.

Boxer Sachin Siwach credited months of hard work and correcting technical flaws for India's successful campaign. "The coaches identified our mistakes, and we worked hard on every weakness," he said. "That hard work is paying off now. The next target is the Asian Games, and winning consistently gives every athlete the confidence to perform even better."

Boxer Narender Berwal said the medal haul was the result of meticulous planning and teamwork rather than individual brilliance.

"We study videos of every opponent and prepare our

strategy accordingly," he said. If Plan A works, we stick with it. If not, we adapt. The Asian Games will be a different challenge because we'll face stronger opponents from countries like Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan, but we'll be ready."

Silver medallist pugilist Jadumani Singh admitted the final defeat still hurt despite an otherwise impressive campaign.

"I gave everything I had, but the final didn't go my way," he said.

"There is a little disappointment because I wanted the gold, but that will only motivate me to work harder. I'll sit

with my coaches, improve where I fell short and come back stronger at the Asian Games." Boxer Arundhati Choudhary, winner of gold in women's 70kg, said defeating the defending champion had significantly boosted her confidence.

"That victory reinforced my belief in my abilities. Since my weight category is not part of the Asian Games, my full focus is now on the World Cup. I believe this result will help me perform even better in future competitions."

The celebrations were equally memorable for India's para athletics medallists, who produced the country's finest-ever Commonwealth Games campaign with seven medals.

Gold medallist in men's 100m T47 category, Dilip Mahadu Gavit said adapting to the cold Glasgow conditions was as challenging as competing in an unfamiliar event. "It was my first time competing in the 100m at the Commonwealth Games, and I'm happy to have set a Games record," he said.

"The weather made things difficult, but we had to adapt. My ultimate goal is to win Paralympic gold and raise the Indian flag on the highest stage." Sharmila Dhankhar, winner of the gold in women's shot put F57 category, said winning a CWG medal

had strengthened her belief ahead of the upcoming major events. "It is a proud feeling to win a medal for the country," she said.

"This performance has given me a lot of confidence." Men's F57 shot put gold medallist Soman Rana said the medals belonged as much to the support staff as the athletes. "We only go out and compete, but there is a huge support system working behind us," he said.

Women's F57 shot put bronze medallist Shilpa K. Shyla described winning her maiden Commonwealth Games medal as one of the proudest moments of her career. "Representing India and winning my first Commonwealth Games medal is a special feeling," she said. "There is still a lot to improve technically, and my long-term goal is to win Olympic gold for India."

Gold-winning judokas Harsh Singh and Asmita Dey who arrived early in the morning also received a rousing welcome.

"Never thought I would receive a welcome like this. I am feeling really good after meeting everyone here," Harsh said upon arrival.

"This is first time that I am receiving such a welcome so it feels great," said Asmita, a sub-inspector with Uttar Pradesh Police.

Prioritise women boxers, better bet for 2028 Olympic medal: Akhil

POONAM MEHRA ■ New Delhi

India's women pugilists are a stronger bet for an Olympic medal than their male counterparts and should be prioritised in the overall planning for the 2028 Los Angeles Games, says boxer-turned-police officer Akhil Kumar, lauding their record-shattering Commonwealth Games performance.

In a telephonic interview to PTI, Akhil, who was the only Indian boxer to strike gold at the 2006 Commonwealth Games, said he



was quite impressed with the country's performance in Glasgow where it finished with its best ever tally of seven gold medals in boxing,

six of them coming from women.

Women's boxing came into the CWG only in 2014 and featured just three categories — 51kg, 60kg and 75kg — to start with. This was two years after it entered the Olympics programme in the same three divisions. MC Mary Kom (2012, London) and Lovlina Borgohain (2021, Tokyo) have won Olympic medals for India in women's boxing.

"They (the women boxers) are clearly delivering better results. The weight categories are also increasing, they deserve to be prioritised?

Among the current crop of male boxers, I don't really think there is anyone who can be an Olympic medallist at this stage. If there is a drastic improvement going forward, which I hope there is, I will change my view," the Haryana Police ACP said.

"At this point, it's the women boxers who have the advantage. We have adapted to the expansion of the sport quite well and given how it has grown, I guess India is better positioned to deliver more than one Olympic medal in

women's boxing in 2028," he added.

The CWG programme in Glasgow featured seven weight categories for women, one more than last time. The men's event also comprised seven categories, achieving gender parity for the first time.

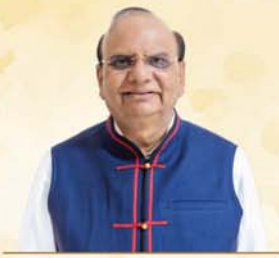
The weight divisions were also the ones that would be at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics. The Indian women won medals in all seven categories, six gold and a silver. The men, on the other hand, managed two gold, and a silver.



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Neeraj to face Pathirage at Lausanne

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

Two-time Olympic medallist Neeraj Chopra will compete in the Lausanne Diamond League on August 21 against a star-studded men's javelin field featuring recently-crowned Commonwealth Games champion and world leader Rumesh Pathirage of Sri Lanka among others.

The event will, in fact, have five participants from the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow that ended on Sunday. Chopra, who won silver in Glasgow with a season-best throw of 85.83m in his second meet after an injury layoff, will face Olympic champion Arshad Nadeem



of Pakistan, reigning world champion Keshorn Walcott of Trinidad and Tobago, former world champion Anderson Peters of Grenada and former Olympic champion Thomas Rohler of Germany apart from Pathirage. The field will also

include Tokyo Olympic silver-medallist Jakub Vadlejch of the Czech Republic, Germany's Julian Weber, Switzerland's Simon Wieland and American Curtis Thompson, the world No. 2 this season.

"The five javelin superstars, who have won the last four editions of the Olympic Games and World Championships, will be present at Athletissima on August 21 for a competition of extraordinary quality," the organisers said.

The Lausanne meet will be Chopra's third competition since returning from a lower-back injury that sidelined him in September last year. The 28-year-old opened his season with an 85.69m effort to finish fourth at the Doha Diamond League in June before improving to 85.83m to claim silver at the Commonwealth Games.

"Although we always want the National anthem to play,

I did my season's best and the comeback is going okay. There are other competitions as well. I am happy," Chopra had said after his silver in Glasgow. Chopra had finished runner-up at the Lausanne Diamond League in 2024 with a career fourth-best throw of 89.49m after winning the title in 2022 with an 89.08m effort.

Pathirage heads to Lausanne in red-hot form after winning the Commonwealth Games title with 89.75m. The Sri Lankan has a personal best of 92.62m, achieved at the Golden Gala Pietro Mennea in Roma in June this year, making him the only thrower to breach the 90m mark this season.

Diksha stays in top-10 of merit list despite AIG Women's Open missed cut

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ London

Despite missing the cut at the AIG Women's Open, Diksha Dagar is the top Indian on the LET Order of Merit, occupying the sixth slot. The two-time LET winner is placed eighth in the Race to Costa del Sol standings, underlining the consistency she has shown throughout the 2026 season, which has included multiple top-10 finishes. The Hero-supported Diksha will once again spearhead Indian challenge as the Ladies European Tour resumes with the PIF London Championship at Centurion Club later this week.

Diksha will be aiming to



consolidate her position among the Tour's leading players and strengthen her bid for another top-10 finish.

India will have a strong presence at Centurion Club with four other players in the field. Rookie Avani Prashanth has enjoyed an encouraging debut season on the LET and

is currently 45th on the Order of Merit.

Pranavi Urs, also backed by Hero, is close behind in 48th, while five-time LET winner Aditi Ashok occupies 58th after a mixed campaign. Hitaashee Bakshi is continuing to gain experience in her first full LET season, and is placed 127th. South Africa's Casandra Alexander is the Race to Costa del Sol leader, while Singapore's Shannon Tan, the 2025 LET Order of Merit champion, will also be looking to contend for the title. For Diksha, the week presents another opportunity to reinforce her status as India's leading performer on the LET this season. (PTI)

Jadeja's attacking mindset has made him complete red-ball bowler: Pujara



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

Former India batter Cheteshwar Pujara believes Ravindra Jadeja has grown as a Test cricketer after making the transition from a defensive bowler to someone who is constantly hunting for wickets in recent years.

Jadeja has evolved into one of India's premier match-winners in the longest format, complementing his impeccable accuracy with a far more attacking approach.

Apart from taking wickets, he has also made some vital contributions with the bat, establishing himself as one of the world's finest all-rounders in red-ball cricket.

"Earlier, when Ravindra Jadeja used to bowl, his mindset was not to give away too many runs, especially in red-ball cricket. If there was a little help in the wicket, then he would try to take wickets. But if the wicket was not conducive to bowlers, his focus was on restricting the runs," Pujara said on JioStar ahead of India's Test series



against Sri Lanka beginning August 15.

Jadeja has 348 wickets in 89 Tests at an impressive average of 25.12. "...he has understood his own strengths and is bowling accordingly. In every game, he is trying to land the ball in the line of the stumps and get the batter out," Pujara explained. Pujara said Jadeja's biggest improvement has been the change in his mindset, with the veteran now looking to dismiss batters with every delivery rather than merely containing the scoring rate.

Pujara said the shift in Jadeja's approach has enabled him to think proactively as a bowler and use variations more effectively. "Earlier, his mindset was a little more defensive, but now he is delivering every ball with the purpose of taking a wicket. "So, you think a little more about your game. You use the crease a little better, try to go wider, and adjust your length according to the batter. That mental shift is very important for the game" he added.

Had to win gold, kept telling myself I'd return to India with it: Asmita Dey

SUMAN RAY ■ New Delhi

Asmita Dey, who became the first Indian judoka to win a Commonwealth Games gold medal, said she always believed she would script history for the country and that unwavering self-belief proved to be the defining factor in her triumph.

"Even before I boarded the flight to Glasgow, I had only one thing in my mind - I had to win the gold medal. I kept telling myself that I would return to India with the gold," Asmita told PTI on the sidelines of the felicitation ceremony for the judo medallists at Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya's residence here on Tuesday.

Recalling her memorable campaign, Asmita admitted

there was a brief moment in the final when she feared the gold might slip away, but timely encouragement from her coach Yashpal Solanki helped her regain control.

"The competition was tough because my opponent in the final was from Canada. She was ranked just below me, so we were almost at the same level. When she scored against me, for a couple of seconds I thought I might lose.

"But my coach, Yashpal Solanki sir, kept reminding me that the gold was ours and that I had to win it. That gave me confidence. I became more aggressive, levelled the match and then it went into the Golden Score. I scored first in the Golden Score and won the gold



medal," she said.

Asked about the biggest strength behind her success in a highly technical sport, Asmita said mental toughness, rather than physical ability, made the difference.

"I believe that no matter how much we train, if you

look at the players in my weight category in India, many of us undergo almost the same training. The real difference lies in the mindset.

"It is about who is mentally stronger, who can handle pressure better during competition, and who has greater

Nabi's ability to get batters out while defending is his biggest asset: Pathan

KUSHAN SARKAR ■ New Delhi

Auqib Nabi's knack for forcing top batters into errors while they are defending, rather than relying on raw pace, could be his biggest strength as the Jammu and Kashmir pacer prepares for international cricket, feels former India all-rounder Irfan Pathan.

Nabi's long-awaited India call-up came on Monday when the selectors named him as injured Jasprit Bumrah's replacement in the upcoming two-Test series in Sri Lanka beginning August 15. Pathan, who first spotted Nabi during trials in Srinagar in 2018 and later mentored Jammu and Kashmir's young cricketers, believes the pacer's natural action, wrist



position and ability to move the ball make him effective without express pace.

"The optimum pace to get the ball moving is around 135 kph. If you can get it to swing, that too late, then you are good," Pathan told PTI in an interview.

"And with the rhythm and

with the kind of action he has, we can touch 133-135 kph on a regular basis. That's what I believe," he added.

For Pathan, however, pace is only one part of the equation. The bigger quality is whether a bowler can make top-class batters defend and still find a way to get them

out. "Does the bowler have the ability to get the batters, the top-quality batters, out while defending? This is the other quality you seek," he said. Pathan has seen Nabi produce that kind of bowling against high-quality batters in domestic cricket, including in the Ranji Trophy final when they pipped Karnataka on first innings lead to clinch a historic maiden title earlier this year.

"We have seen that in the Ranji Trophy final, he troubled KL Rahul, he didn't even get a wicket. In that too, he defended normally and dismissed the batsman," he said. The former India pacer also saw Nabi create similar problems for batters in Mumbai. "In Mumbai, I saw the match, Shreyas and our

current players, he was dismissing them the same way. So, on different pitches, the top-quality batsmen defend and get dismissed. That means he has the ability," Pathan said.

Test cricket, however, will provide a bigger examination, particularly on flat pitches where bowlers need something extra to create chances. "Obviously, when you play Test cricket, the challenge becomes even more. Because sometimes, you get the flattest pitch in the world," he said.

"And then obviously, you need to have some extra. In that extra ability, can he use the angle? Can he call the wicket-keeper up? Eventually, it's all about the performances. Can you

perform?" Pathan added.

Pathan, who claimed 301 international wickets, said a bowler does not necessarily need express pace if he possesses the skill to deceive batters. "I've been able to take 301 international wickets. I was not bowling 150kph," he said.

"My ability was to get the batsman out LBW before they think that ball will not come in," Pathan added.

He believes Nabi's inclusion can provide a major boost to his confidence, even if he has to wait for his opportunity. "For Auqib to be in the squad right now, even though he was not the first choice, he came as a replacement of Jasprit Bumrah, it will still give him a lot of confidence. (PTI)

West Indies fight back in 2nd Test against Pakistan

ASSOCIATED PRESS
■ Port of Spain (Trinidad)

Pakistan captain Babar Azam was denied his first Test century in four years as West Indies fought back in the second and final cricket Test on Tuesday. Babar, who last scored a Test century in December 2022 against New Zealand at Karachi, was run out for 88 by Brandon King's stunning direct throw from short cover before Pakistan's middle order collapsed and reached 333-6 at lunch on Day 3.

Pakistan still trails by 11 runs with Abdullah Shafique holding the fort at 132 not out and tailender Sajid Khan unbeaten on 16.

King picked up a lower



back injury and had to be stretchered off after he fell awkwardly as his sharp throw ran out Babar at the striker's end when Shafique refused to go for a tight single and Babar couldn't recover his ground after running halfway to the wicket.

West Indies dried up runs

through some disciplined bowling from Jomel Warrican and Jayden Seales after Pakistan resumed at 266-2. Babar and Shafique, who rotated strike well on Day 2, stretched their partnership to 183 before West Indies claimed three wickets for five runs.

Warrican was splendid

with both the old ball and the second new ball as the left-arm spinner had debutant Awaiz Zafar clean bowled for 1 when the batter came out of his crease for a big shot but completely missed the line of the ball.

Shamar Joseph then trapped Salman Ali Agha plumb leg before wicket and Warrican claimed his third wicket of the innings after West Indies took the second new ball when Mohammad Rizwan was bowled for 18.

Shafique patiently held one end up, but West Indies allowed him to add only 25 runs to his overnight score of 107.

West Indies leads the two-match series after a 90-run victory in the first Test.

Will wipe off few players: Gopichand on badminton's new scoring system

AMIT KUMAR DAS
■ New Delhi

Pullela Gopichand still remembers the disruption caused by badminton's scoring overhaul during his playing career and as the sport gears up to embrace another "tactical shift", the India coach believes a few players will be "wiped off". The 15x3 system (three games of 15 points each) will replace the current 21x3 format (three games of 21 points each) next year. The BWF said the shorter format would help in managing player workload in a crowded calendar.

Gopichand recalled how he had won the All England title



in 2001 under the traditional 15-point format before badminton briefly switched to the 7x5 scoring system.

The experiment was abandoned within a year, with the sport reverting to the traditional 15-point scores for men and 11-point scores for women at that time. "When I won the All England, a few months later they moved from 15 to 7. It took

me time because I was one of those players who was a stroke player. I wanted time to get adjusted. It took me a year to come back," Gopichand said in response to a PTI query during an interaction here ahead of the World Championships.

"And then by the time I was kind of settling in, they brought us back to the long form and it was a death blow. Because you train, you detrain, and your endurance drops. Then to go back and play 15 was impossible. These definitely make a big impact. A few players, it will wipe off, a few players might benefit."

Drawing parallels with the

15x3 system approved by the Badminton World Federation (BWF), Gopichand said the shorter format would place greater premium on speed, power and mental strength, particularly during the closing stages of the games.

"You scoring points will be important, but you not giving away points will be even more important. The speed and the power and the focus need to be top notch. The mind will play much more," he said.

According to the national coach, doubles players are likely to feel the biggest impact as shorter games will make every phase of the contest more critical. (PTI)

I would love to coach England one day: Former England captain Stokes

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ London

Former England captain Ben Stokes has expressed his desire to coach the national team in future, insisting that he has the required experience to be successful in the position. The 35-year-old all-rounder retired from international cricket in June during England's Test series against New Zealand, drawing curtains to a career that included



the country's 2019 World Cup triumph and his match-winning Ashes innings at Headingley the same year.

Stokes led England's Test side from 2022 before moving away. "I'm doing my Level 3

coaching now while I'm still playing, because I want, when the day comes that I'm not playing any more, I'd love to be able to have all that stuff signed off and done," Stokes was quoted as saying on the podcast "For The Love Of Cricket".

"I want to be a coach. I know what I want to do in terms of staying within the game, which is to be a coach. And would I love to be a coach of England one day? Absolutely."